



Shri D.K. Shivakumar
Hon'ble Chief Minister



Shri Siddaramaiah
Hon'ble Former Chief Minister



Dr. G. Parameshwara
Hon'ble Deputy Chief Minister

D. K. SHIVAKUMAR
CHIEF MINISTER



VIDHANA SOUDHA
BENGALURU - 560001

Namaskara,

It has been a hundred days since I was given the opportunity to serve the people of Karnataka. These hundred days have deepened my appreciation of the enormous responsibility we carry in building a better future for crores of Kannadigas.

Shri Siddaramaiah avaru has given Karnataka a strong foundation of social justice, reminding us that governance must stand with those who need it most, and this is a commitment I share and carry forward. The five guarantees have brought meaningful support and security to families across the state. But governance cannot stop with what has already been delivered. It must respond to what people need next.

In these first hundred days, we have begun that work: **7.5% reservation for government-school students** in professional courses, **free student bus passes**, **Rs.29,679 crores** cleared investments with potential to create around **66,000 jobs**, **10,000 Bharat Jodo Yuva Sanghas** for sports, culture and nation building, India's first government-sponsored **AI university**, **AI education from Class 6** onwards, cloud seeding, **Udyoga Nidhi** to create **1 lakh new jobs** in the 10 most backward districts, filling of **72,000 government posts** initiated, and a dedicated **"Praja Seve" department** for grievance redressal under my direct supervision.

These are important steps, but this is only the beginning. I know your expectations are immense, as they should be. Your expectations are a reminder of your aspirations from the Congress government, and you have every right to demand this of us.

We are a government that listens and learns. When necessary, we have the courage to reconsider a decision or change course. That is the strength of a government that listens.

Our goal is a **Drudha Karnataka**: economically strong, socially empowered, technologically advanced, and deeply rooted in its values.

The road ahead will not be easy. Our farmers, particularly those facing drought, remind us how much more needs to be done. The next 500 days demand greater determination and effort. But I have faith in Karnataka's ability to meet these challenges. Karnataka does not wait for opportunities, **it creates them.**

That is the Karnataka I believe in. That is the **Kannadiga Spirit.**

With that faith, my Cabinet and I make you a simple promise: We will keep showing up. **We will keep working. And for as long as I breathe, serving Karnataka and Kannadigas will remain my Sankalpa.**

Always in your service,

D. K. Shivakumar
Praja Sevaka



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SHATHAKADA PATHA
PRAGATHIYA RATHA

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U.S. MILITARY SAYS IT DESTROYED FIVE IRANIAN OIL TANKERS FOLLOWING ATTACKS ON ITS NAVY

Tankers targeted in new wave of attacks

Iran claims it has hit 10 ships near Hormuz; oil tops \$100 a barrel

Reuters
Cairo, Washington, Dubai, September 9

IRAN SAID Wednesday it had attacked 10 ships near the Strait of Hormuz after the US sank five Iran oil tankers, in biggest declared wave of tit-for-tat attacks on shipping by both sides since start of the six-month-old war.

Iran also said it had fired ballistic missiles at a base used by US forces in Jordan.

Oil prices topped \$100 a barrel on Wednesday for the first time in six weeks amid deepened concerns over supply from the region.

The Revolutionary Guards said they would sharply escalate their response to any further attacks, and if the enemy struck two or three Iranian targets, Iran would respond by hitting 20.

Iran would soon release maps of a new, much larger off-limits zone at sea that would extend as far as the Arabian Gulf off Chabahar on the far reaches

of Iran's coast near Pakistan, the Guards said.

Recent days have also seen an escalation in fighting between Saudi Arabia and the Houthis in Yemen, a second theatre of war that threatens global energy supplies from West Asia.

The Americans said they destroyed five Iranian oil tankers overnight, releasing video of ships ablaze before they sank. The US military's Central Command called its attacks a response to Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps targeting a US Navy warship twice with over the previous two days.

Washington has announced a new policy of attacking Iranian tankers in retaliation for fire that threatens its warships. Iran says it is using new, more capable missiles to attack US ships.

"Iran continues to try to hit US naval ships, and for every time they do that or try to do that, they're going to lose tankers," US Secretary of State Marco Rubio told reporters during a visit to Colombia.

IAEA board passes resolution reporting Iran to Security Council

Vienna: The UN nuclear watchdog's 35-nation board of governors has passed a resolution reporting Iran to the UN Security Council (UNSC) for the first time in 20 years for breaching its non-proliferation obligations, diplomats said on Wednesday.

The resolution follows upon a previous one passed June 12 last year that found Iran in "non-compliance" with obligations.

Reporting it to UNSC for breach required another resolution.

While the Security Council is unlikely to take concrete action against Iran since its allies Russia and China are permanent, veto-wielding members, the move is an escalation in a diplomatic standoff between Iran and Western powers, and Iran warned on Monday it would retaliate if the resolution passed.

REUTERS

Pak orders medical institutions to expel Afghan students, halt new admissions

Lahore: Pakistan has ordered medical institutions to expel Afghan students and halt fresh admissions amid deteriorating ties between Islamabad and Kabul, a senior government official said Wednesday.

In a directive issued to medical and dental institutions, the Pakistan Medical and Dental Council has barred them from granting admission or placement to Afghan students during the current academic session, a senior health ministry official said. Afghan students already enrolled in medical and dental programmes have been directed to return to Afghanistan, he said. The official said the decision was taken in view of deteriorating relations between Pakistan and Afghanistan and applied only to Afghan nationals and not students from other countries.

The Foreign Office, however, indicated that Afghan students with valid travel and residency documents could continue to seek extension of their visas under existing rules.

Foreign Office spokesperson Sajjad Haider Khan told *Dawn* newspaper, under Pakistan's Illegal Foreigner Repatriation Plan, the stay of any foreign national without a valid passport and visa was illegal.

PTI

‘Have a little bit of decency’: Philippines minister to China

Associated Press
Bangkok, September 9

CHINA ON Wednesday accused the Philippines of "stirring up trouble" after harsh words from Philippine Defence Minister Gilberto Teodoro Jr over Beijing's increasingly aggressive pursuit of maritime claims in the South China Sea.

Teodoro was addressing a defence forum in South Korea on Tuesday, stressing the need to uphold a 2016 ruling by an arbitration panel that China's

claims had no legal basis, when a person came on stage and handed him a note that Teodoro said came from China.

Reading from the note, the minister said it said "China neither accepts nor recognises" the arbitration ruling. "Of course," he added, looking up to the audience, "because you lost." "Have a little bit of decency, have a little bit of shame," Teodoro continued, saying that the note represented disrespect both for the forum and international law.



Philippines Defence Minister Gilberto Teodoro Jr

Chinese representatives took part in Seoul Defence Dialogue forum but were not featured as panelists or speakers. It was not clear who the note came from.

Asked in Beijing about the unusual incident, China's Foreign Ministry spokesperson Mao



Children sit with their father in front of houses damaged by floods along the bank of Trishuli River in Nuwakot district, Nepal. AP

Toll reaches 1,365; Nepal House sets up panel to assess economic impact of floods

Kathmandu: A seven-member parliamentary sub-committee was set up on Wednesday to assess the impact of the devastating flash flood on Nepal's economy and examine issues related to climate finance, officials said.

The panel was formed at a meeting of the Finance Committee of the House of Representatives (HoR) held at Singhadurbar, according to officials in the Parliament Secretariat.

Lawmaker Sushila Khadka of the ruling Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP) will coordinate the sub-committee, which has been tasked with studying the econ-

omic impact of the floods on the country as well as issues concerning climate change and climate finance. Finance Committee Chairman Krishna Hari Budhathoki said the sub-committee has been asked to submit its report by September 18 after conducting the study.

The other members of the panel are Narendra Kumar Kerung of Nepali Congress, Parashu Ram Tamang of Communist Party of Nepal (Chauim), Pushpa Raj Kandel of CPN-UML, and RSP lawmakers Lima Adhikari, Pushpa Chaudhary and Sushant Vaidik. At least

1,365 people have been killed and over 5,000 remain missing, according to officials.

The formation of the parliamentary panel comes as Nepal assesses the wider economic fallout from the disaster and the need for financial resources to rebuild infrastructure damaged by extreme weather events.

It also comes amidst a diplomatic push to seek climate-related compensation from greenhouse emitters for the devastation caused by the flash floods, with Kathmandu asserting they contribute "negligible" greenhouse gas emissions.

PTI

bused to ground zero.

The debris hung so thickly in the air around the fallen towers that it looked like it was snowing, he said. "It was a beautiful sunny Tuesday, and then you're in this kind of apocalyptic atmosphere," Brody said. "It was a little overwhelming, to say the least."

In the days after the attack, Ten House served as both command centre and safe space for weary first responders, he said. As the years passed, its crew had a front-row seat to the area's rebirth. Robert Favata joined Ladder 10 in 2008, fresh out of the academy.

In those early years, he worked beside a giant hole

teeming with construction activity. Now 46, he looks out at a transformed landscape.

A pair of waterfall pools sit in the footprint of the old towers, ringed by parapets etched with the names of nearly 3,000 victims.

Below ground, the 9/11 Museum houses mangled steel beams, a destroyed fire truck and other artifacts.

"When I got here, there was nothing," Favata says. "I never thought they were gonna finish." Today, an endless stream of visitors stop at firehouse.

Argano can be found most days perched near the station's open bay doors, patiently answering questions, shaking

Trump gave \$45,000 cash gifts to close aide Natalie Harp, others

Reuters
Washington, September 9

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump gave tens of thousands of dollars in cash gifts last year to executive assistant Natalie Harp and three other close aides working in the West Wing, according to financial disclosures released by the White House.

The payments raised ethics concerns because federal employees are barred by statute from receiving compensation beyond government salaries.

Harp, communications adviser Margo Martin and deputy director of Oval Office operations Chamberlain Harris received \$45,000, described in their disclosures as "Cash Gift for Holidays."

The payments were equivalent to roughly one-third of the aides' federal salaries of \$150,000 per year, according to the White House annual personnel report to Congress.

Walt Nauta, another aide who works as the director of Oval Office operations, received \$20,000 in cash, the dis-



Natalie Harp

closures show. His annual compensation is \$175,000.

The *Washington Post* first reported the gifts on Tuesday.

White House spokesman Davis Ingle said the gifts complied with ethics rules.

"The President has a longstanding practice of giving Christmas gifts to people in his orbit, including at times employees and aides, both in government and in his time in the private sector," Ingle said in a statement on Wednesday.

"The gifts at issue here have nothing to do with any of these individuals' official government duties, and therefore are entirely permissible under relevant legal and ethical standards," Ingle added.

Zelenskyy calls for more international pressure on Putin for civilian deaths

Associated Press
Kyiv, September 9

UKRAINIAN PRESIDENT Volodymyr Zelenskyy chided the international community Wednesday for not taking a tougher stance against Russia over its escalating bombardment of civilian areas of Ukraine.

Zelenskyy urged countries to step up the pressure. "Unfortunately, there has been too little response from the international community to these strikes, which are taking people's lives practically every day," he said on social media. "But a response is needed — Moscow must not go into the winter believing that it can get away with missile and drone terror without consequences," he said.

The United Nations said last month that increasing Russian

Zelenskyy's plane was 'almost hit' by drone: Norway PM

Oslo: The plane carrying Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy to Oslo for the funeral of the King of Norway was "almost hit" by a drone when taking off from Moldova Tuesday, Norwegian PM Jonas Gahr Støre told public broadcaster *NRK* Wednesday.

"His plane was almost hit by a drone as it was about to take off from Moldova...," Støre said.

REUTERS

aerial attacks killed or wounded more Ukrainian civilians in July than in any month since March 2022, with 437 killed and more than 2,600 wounded.

• BRIEFLY

UNITED KINGDOM

ATC chief rules out cyberattack in disruptions

THE UK'S National Air Traffic Services on Wednesday ruled out a cyberattack having caused the massive disruption across airports in the country. "We will be doing a very thorough and full investigation. We have at this point ruled out a cyberattack," NATS CEO Martin Rolfe told the *BBC*. "I don't believe we have ever seen an incident happen more than once. This will be something we haven't seen in over 50 years of operation..." he said. NATS claimed the problem occurred in its flight processing system, reiterating it was not the same fault as those that caused outages in 2023 and 2025. **PTI**

SYRIA

14 killed after explosions at arms warehouse

AT LEAST 14 people were killed, and 11 others were wounded on Wednesday in an explosion at a weapons warehouse in northwestern Syria, according to state media citing the Health Ministry. The cause of the blast near the town of Sarmada, in Idlib province, was not immediately clear. Such incidents are a common occurrence in the country, which has been battered by over a decade of war. The warehouse was used to store weapons and munitions left over from the country's surprising and civil war from 2011 until 2024, the state-run SANA news agency said, citing the Defence Ministry, without providing further details. **AP**

• IN THE DAYS AFTER THE ATTACK, ‘TEN HOUSE’ SERVED AS BOTH COMMAND CENTRE & SAFE SPACE FOR WEARY FIRST RESPONDERS; NOW IT’S A DE FACTO PART OF THE 9/11 MEMORIAL

25 yrs on, a firefighter is still on duty at NYC firehouse that was first to respond on 9/11

Philip Marcelo
New York, September 9

SAL ARGANO got lucky. When the World Trade Center was struck by hijacked jets on September 11, 2001, the New York City firefighter was in Brooklyn, on loan to another station, rather than at his usual post at the small Manhattan firehouse just across an intersection from twin towers.

He rushed downtown to find his firehouse badly damaged but still standing. Six of its members, he'd later learn, were among the 343 New York City firefighters killed in the World Trade Center's collapse.

"If I wasn't sent out on rota-

tion there would have been a good chance I would not be here today," Argano says. "I think about that all the time."

Almost 25 years later, Argano, now 65, is still on duty at the firehouse — the last of the firefighters assigned there in 2001 who still works there.

Today, the crews at the firehouse respond to emergency calls but also serve as a de facto part of the 9/11 memorial, visited by crowds of tourists daily. Some visitors come specifically to see the large bronze relief along the side of the building listing the names of the firefighters killed on 9/11.

Others pause to take selfies as they pass by on their way to

the National 9/11 Memorial plaza across the street, drawn by the sight of Engine 10 and Ladder 10, the gleaming trucks sitting in the garage that give the station its nickname: Ten House.

"This is definitely one of those companies where if you don't want to ingratiate yourself to the public, it's definitely not the right place," said Capt. Terence Brody, who commands Ladder 10 and has worked at the station since 2016. "People around the world know this firehouse. They're going to come by and say hello."

Brody, now 55, was still in the fire academy on 9/11. Cadets grabbed their gear and were



Firefighter Sal Argano at the FDNY Ten House' near Ground Zero in New York. AP

THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 10, 2026



The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 22 PAGES

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● **AGRICULTURE MINISTER** Shivraj Singh Chouhan will hold a high-level consultation with farm bodies on proposed seed law.

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'Threats to US workers': Trump admn suspends green card filings by Cognizant

Sagar Kulkarni
Washington, September 9

THE UNITED States has suspended Cognizant's permanent labour certification filings, considered as the first step for acquiring a green card, amid the Donald Trump administration's campaign against alleged visa fraud.

The US Department of Labour Inspector General Anthony D'Esposito announced on Tuesday that he had suspended the permanent labour certification filings by Cognizant, founded in Chennai, and Cloudera. "Threats to American workers will not be tolerated," D'Esposito said.

He said that the investigation into the two companies was conducted in coordination with the White House Fraud Task Force and other officials. "Fighting fraud is a team sport. @Sonderling47 and I are for real. @Cognizant's PERM filings are suspended. @DOL.OIG is on the hunt," D'Esposito said.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

FOUR-PILLAR THEME: RESILIENCE, INNOVATION, COOPERATION, SUSTAINABILITY

West Asia on boil, sherpas try to bridge divide within BRICS

Ahead of summit, Modi to hold talks with Pezeshkian, Putin tomorrow

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 9

WITH THE war in West Asia flaring up following the exchange of strikes between the US and Iran, the BRICS Sherpas, the most senior negotiators from the 11 member countries of the grouping, are burning the midnight oil to try and



Bharat Mandapam, the BRICS Summit venue, illuminated in New Delhi on Wednesday. ANI

hammer out a joint declaration for the New Delhi summit of the leaders on September 12-13. The key point of discord, it

INSIDE **PAGE 4**
25,000 COPS, 11 HOTELS, 35 ROUTES: HOW DELHI IS PREPARING FOR BRICS SUMMIT

is learnt, is the formulation over the war in West Asia given that Iran, the UAE and Saudi Arabia are expected to be at the summit table.

While Russian President Vladimir Putin's attendance has been confirmed, officials are also preparing for the participation of Chinese President Xi Jinping, Iranian President

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



NATION **PAGE 7**

POSSESSING BOOKS IS NO CRIME: J&K HC QUASHES SCHOLAR'S DETENTION UNDER PSA

How dare Greater Noida issue notice to student over protest, will seek explanation: CJI

Lawyer flags 'contempt' of SC's Sept 1 order, says 'experiment' being tried on students

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, September 9

QUESTIONING HOW could a Greater Noida executive magistrate issue notice to a student over his alleged participation in the Cockroach Janta Party-led protests even after the Supreme Court direction that no action should be taken against student protesters, Chief Justice

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

'I don't have any criminal history... want to know why notice was issued'

Drishti Jain
Noida, September 9

THE NOTICE may have been revoked, but Akshat Tripathi, 20, a Second Year BA LLB student at the Gautam Buddha University in Noida, said he wanted to know the "reasons and the basis" on which it was issued in the first place.

"I do not have any criminal history. They have levelled all false allegations — allegations that cannot be substantiated. Even if they have cancelled it, I



Akshat Tripathi is a BA LLB student at the Gautam Buddha University in Noida

want to know the reasons and the basis on which the notice

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Pilot rules out CM face in Punjab, says Rahul to lead Cong campaign

Manoj CG
New Delhi, September 9

AMID INFIGHTING in the faction-ridden Punjab Congress, the All India Congress Committee (AICC) leadership has replaced Bhupesh Baghel with Sachin Pilot as the new in-charge of Punjab. The task of the 49-year-old AICC general secretary is cut out now. In an interview with *The Indian Express*, Pilot speaks on a range of



issues related to the Congress affairs in Punjab and the party's roadmap for the upcoming Assembly elections. Excerpts:

The Punjab elections are just months away and the Congress leadership has now given you charge of the party in the state. How challenging is your task?

Five-six states are going to polls. And Punjab is a very

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



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Defence Minister Rajnath Singh meets Sri Lanka President Anura Kumara Dissanayake, in Colombo on Wednesday. ANI

Freedom of navigation should remain pivotal priorities for India and Sri Lanka: Rajnath

Press Trust of India
Colombo, September 9

DURING HIS visit to Sri Lanka, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, while addressing a public event on Wednesday said that secure sea lanes, freedom of navigation, respect for international law and unhindered maritime trade should remain pivotal priorities as they are crucial for the growth and prosperity of the Indian Ocean Region.

The public event was held after he had an “extremely productive” meeting with Sri Lankan President Anura Kumara Dissanayake during which they reaffirmed that as civilisational twins, close neighbours and maritime partners, India and Sri Lanka would continue to work jointly to ensure the safety, security, peace and prosperity of the region. Singh arrived in Colombo on Tuesday for a three-day visit, becoming the first Indian defence minister to visit Sri Lanka in 38 years.

Speaking on ‘India-Sri Lanka Maritime Cooperation in the Indian Ocean Region- Civilisational Partners with intertwined destinies’ in Colombo, Singh said that Indian and Sri Lankan ports can become engines of shared economic growth and the drivers for the future prosperity of the region.

He said that freedom of navigation and ensuring open trade routes are crucial for the growth and prosperity of the region. “Therefore, secure sea lanes, freedom of navigation, respect for international law, unhindered maritime trade and commerce should remain our pivotal priorities,” he said. “It is essential that we work together towards shaping a favourable, secure maritime environment, remaining ready to

address emerging maritime challenges in the first instance, before they become a serious threat to our developmental interests and the bright future of our region”.

He added that Sri Lanka occupies a salient strategic location in the Indian Ocean Region, overlooking a vast ocean characterised by crisscrossing busy trade routes. “These routes are not only the arteries for global trade, but also determine the trajectory of our growth and development as well as the safety and security of our region,” he said.

Sri Lanka, like India, is central to any strategic discourse on maritime security in the Indian Ocean Region, he said. “...India-Sri Lanka Maritime Cooperation is thus not only mutually beneficial but quintessential to our collective safety and security”.

As the Indian Ocean is entering into a period of profound strategic and economic transformation, the countries must synergise their efforts and build upon collective competencies to tackle the challenges, he said. “Our ports can become engines of shared economic growth, while our maritime industries can become the drivers for the future prosperity...”

On the fishermen issue, “We need to... strengthen our systems to avoid fisheries disputes, handle them with due care...as this is a livelihood issue, while at the same time ensure maritime law enforcement” he said.

He said they need to develop new paradigms for a stronger maritime partnership. “This is the basis of MAHASAGAR, Prime Minister Modi’s vision for the Indian Ocean Region. ‘Mutual’ and ‘Holistic’ are key words in this concept, underscoring the importance of synergy, cooperation and collaboration”.

Toys, fruits, diet chart

global smuggling ring may be involved since the animals are not native to Odisha.

Later that evening, the five were brought to Nandankanan Zoological Park near Bhubaneswar. Pradeep Mirase, the zoo’s deputy director, said the animals — three males and two females — underwent health check-ups and were taken to a quarantine centre.

“Three animal keepers and a special veterinary team have been assigned to take care of them, and we are also monitoring them through CCTV. As one of them had a fever, authorities administered medication. They are stable now. Our focus is to stabilise them, following which we would conduct some tests,” Mirase told *The Indian Express*. Ensuring the right nourishment for the new guests is another priority for zoo authorities. A special diet chart has been prepared in consultation with Mysore Zoo, home to three orangutans and with valuable experience caring for these species.

“They are being fed every two hours as per a diet chart. As two of them are very young, the animal keepers are feeding them mashed potatoes and mashed apples. The others are eating bananas and apples. We are also feeding them milk,” said a senior zoo official.

Humans and orangutans share approximately 97 per cent of their DNA, and the animals are responding well to the care being provided by the animal keepers, the official said.

To keep them engaged in the quarantine facility, zoo officials have arranged toys and slings. And since orangutans are social animals, zoo officials said they appear to enjoy staying together as a group.

Officials are working closely with the Wildlife Institute of India to keep the animals comfortable. As per protocol, the animals will be kept in quarantine

for nearly 30 days, during which their health will be monitored, and they will be assessed for any underlying diseases.

The zoo’s deputy director said they suspect the animals are from Borneo, an island in Southeast Asia. “To determine their exact species and evaluate phenotypic characters like physical and observable traits, more analysis is required,” said Mirase.

Scientists generally rely on a combination of visual dichotomous keys, morphological measurements and modern genetic analysis to determine the exact species. “If it’s required, it will be done at a later stage, after due approval from the authorities concerned,” he said.

Asked if the animals will be kept at Nandankanan after the quarantine period ends, Mirase said no decision had been taken so far. “Once they stabilise, we will seek approval from the central zoo authorities to keep them here. If allowed, we will do the enrichment for them and hope they will acclimatise to the conditions here,” he said.

Nandankanan Zoo had an orangutan named Binny, which died in February 2019 at the age of 41 from respiratory issues. It was, at the time, the country’s only orangutan and had been brought from Pune in 2003. Prior to Pune, it was in Singapore. Orangutans live for an average of up to 40 years in the wild, while they can reach 50 to 55 years in captivity, according to forest officials.

Meanwhile, the Special Task Force of the Odisha police is revisiting old orangutan smuggling cases as it intensifies its probe to determine whether an organised trafficking racket is involved.

“We are analysing similar cases and contacting teams that looked into them. We are currently gathering data and carrying out local inquiries,” DIG K V Singh told *The Indian Express*.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

West Asia on boil

• AT BHARAT MANDAPAM

SEPTEMBER 12

2 pm: Arrival of leaders.

2.35 pm: Session for BRICS member countries on ‘Inclusive Global Governance and Strengthening Multilateralism’.

4.25 pm: Leaders of BRICS member countries visit Bharat Innovates exhibition.

5.05 pm: Family photo of leaders of BRICS member countries.

5.10 pm: Joint tree plantation by

BRICS leaders.

7.30 pm: Dinner hosted by Prime Minister Modi.

SEPTEMBER 13

9.55 am: Arrival of leaders and ministers of BRICS partner countries and outreach invitees.

10.35 am: Family photo.

10.50 am: Session on ‘Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability: Shaping the Future for Inclusive Global Growth’.

Masoud Pezeshkian, South African President Cyril Ramaphosa and Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto. Brazil’s President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva is not going to be at this gathering since he attended the AI summit in New Delhi in February this year, and will send a top government representative. Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s bilateral meetings with Putin and Pezeshkian on Friday have been confirmed by officials.

With the UAE and Iran, new members of the BRICS since 2024, part of the negotiations, Indian officials, along with the Russians, Brazilians and Egyptians, are working to bridge the gap between the warring parties. Ever since the start of the war on February 28 when the US and Israel attacked Iran, Tehran has targeted US bases in the Gulf region including in the UAE. This has had the Emiratis and the Iranians at loggerheads over the last six months.

Sources told *The Indian Express* that Indian officials are trying to hold separate meetings with officials of the UAE and Iran, and bring them on the same page for Delhi declaration. “We would like to have a BRICS’ Delhi declaration, which is a consensus document, in all the paragraphs. Efforts are underway to achieve that outcome. We are optimistic we can accomplish that,” a senior Indian official said.

In May this year, when Foreign Ministers of the BRICS met in New Delhi, Russia’s Sergey Lavrov told the UAE and Iranian ministers to hold direct talks. At that time, India was unable to bridge the diplomatic gap within the BRICS and could not come up with a joint statement after the two-day meeting of the Foreign Ministers.

Instead, Delhi had issued a chair statement and an outcome document, trying to reflect the divergences between Iran and the UAE over the war. The statement had underlined “differing views among some members” over the West Asia situation, and that BRICS members had expressed their “respective national positions”.

With the crisis in the key Strait of Hormuz affecting economies and sending energy prices soaring, Delhi is keen that it reflects in the joint declaration after arriving at a common position and language.

Officials in Delhi are confident that the summit agenda is robust, dealing with the burning issues of the time — from food security to climate change, energy security to the economic impact. According to the Ministry of External Affairs, the summit will begin Saturday with a closed-door session for BRICS member countries themed ‘Inclusive Global Governance and Strengthening Multilateralism’.

Following the session, leaders will tour the ‘Bharat Innovates Exhibition’, assemble for a family photo, followed by a joint tree-planting ceremony.

The first day’s engagements will conclude with a dinner hosted by Modi. On Sunday, leaders from BRICS member states, partner nations and outreach invitees will gather for the open session, titled ‘Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability: Shaping the Future for Inclusive Global Growth’.

According to officials, India’s BRICS chairship is guided by the theme ‘Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability’, reflecting its vision of a people-centric approach rooted in the spirit of “humanity first”.

In addition to these areas, leaders will exchange views on strengthening intra-BRICS cooperation on common priorities and share

Green card

referring to Keith Sonderling, Acting Secretary, Department of Labour.

“Alongside @WHIFraudTF, we’re following facts, fraud and finances. Handcuffs await,” D’Esposito said.

PERM, or Program Electronic Review Management, is the process through which US employers seek approval from the Department of Labour to sponsor foreign workers for permanent residency.

As part of the process, employers generally must demonstrate that no qualified and available US workers exist for

the position and that hiring a foreign worker will not adversely affect the wages or working conditions of American workers. In July, the Trump administration launched a probe into alleged fraud involving H-1B and PERM employment visa programmes.

Cognizant was founded in Chennai in 1994 and now has its headquarters in Teaneck, New Jersey.

(ENS adds: Cognizant is one of the world’s largest IT services companies, with a particularly large presence in India. The company employed about 356,700 people globally as of June 2026. Its latest country-wise disclosure shows

Sachin Pilot

important state, but just for my party, but also for the country. Punjab has contributed historically, culturally, socially. In the last four and a half years, what the Punjab government has done is that it has basically protected, patronised and promoted Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) leadership in Delhi and Punjab, as opposed to working to serve the people of Punjab. That’s a very known fact in Punjab and in the country. So, I believe that we are the best alternative to serve the people. I met Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra Tuesday. We are now working towards building up a very positive narrative for the upcoming Assembly elections.

Why do you think the Congress leadership made this change just ahead of the elections?

I think changes in the organisation happen continuously. Mr Baghel was in charge for a year and a half. And he did a splendid job. I think he worked really hard, travelling the length and breadth of Punjab and holding meetings at all levels.... So I think it is a routine change of portfolios for different state in-charges. But I think the con-

tinuity in the party’s agenda, policies, and agitations, remains and continues unabated.

The discourse in the Punjab Congress in the last few months — after the party high command constituted the Ajay Maken committee, which met leaders from across the state — has been all about whether there should be a change in its leadership. There is a factional feud brewing. There were posters against Baghel that he was favouring a leader. How will you deal with such a divided Congress house?

I was given this job just a couple of days ago. And I have been in touch with almost all Punjab leaders. I have, in fact, met quite a few of them in Delhi. And I have been assured by everyone that they will work unitedly, collectively and with the single focus of bringing the Congress back to power. There may be a difference in how to approach certain situations. That is quite common in a very large party. After the feedback that I have got from almost all the state leaders, I am confident that everyone is very positively disposed towards working together

E. EXPLAINED

Shifting geopolitics

Hosting the BRICS summit at a time of rapidly changing geopolitics gives India the room to push for a multipolar order in which the Global South’s priorities and concerns are addressed. Balancing ties between its Western allies and the grouping’s non-Western members will require some tightrope walking.

perspectives on global and regional matters of mutual importance, according to the MEA.

India’s chairship is centred on the four pillars of the theme: Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability. Under the Resilience Pillar, the chairship focuses on strengthening collective resilience in areas such as health, agriculture, food, energy, disaster risk reduction and supply chains. Under the Innovation Pillar, it seeks to promote cooperation in the field of startups, MSMEs, science, technology, entrepreneurship, research and development, Digital Public Infrastructure and Artificial Intelligence.

Under the Cooperation Pillar, the chairship places emphasis on strengthening multilateralism, advancing reforms of global governance institutions and fostering practical cooperation on developmental issues across the tracks. Under the Sustainability Pillar, the chairship focuses on promoting clean and renewable energy, climate action and adaptation, nature-based solutions and sustainable consumption.

Among the outcomes expected during the summit will be smart grids and energy storage, urban infrastructure and MSME cooperation portal.

Officials said this year’s BRICS will be very different from the past summits India hosted: 2012 summit took place in a luxury hotel in Delhi, 2016 summit took place in a hotel in Goa, and 2021 summit took place virtually because of the Covid pandemic. This is also India’s turn to host the expanded BRICS grouping. Originally comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa, it expanded in 2024 to include Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, the UAE and Saudi Arabia, with Indonesia joining in 2025.

Belarus, Bolivia, Kazakhstan, Cuba, Malaysia, Nigeria, Thailand, Uganda, Uzbekistan and Vietnam became BRICS partner countries last year.

that over 250,000 employees, or nearly three-fourths of its workforce, were based in India at the end of 2025. The company reported \$21.1 billion in revenue in 2025, up 7% from previous year, and works with large firms across sectors such as financial services, healthcare, manufacturing and communications. Its scale in India makes any restriction on its ability to sponsor workers for US permanent residency particularly consequential for its Indian workforce.)

As of June 30, Cognizant got approvals for 3,510 H-1B visa petitions, compared to 9,413 in 2020, as per data shared by USCIS. PTI

to bring the campaign to fruition. And to let people install a Congress government in Punjab as soon as possible.

Rahul Gandhi ji is planning to come to Punjab quite soon. I am working out the details with the leadership in Punjab as to how to format that programme. Rahul ji, Priyanka ji, Kharge ji will be leading the campaign. And all of us will be supporting their efforts to reach out to the voters.

Rahul was planning a yatra in Punjab. Have its dates been finalised?

We are working out the details. He (Rahul) will obviously be the face of the campaign. He will launch the campaign. He’ll start and be there from now until election day. The exact details of how to make a programme, we are still chalking that out. I have also requested Kharge sir and Priyanka ji to contribute to the campaign. And as early as possible, we like to have the people of Punjab want to see what the Congress has to offer to the state. It’s not about just one political campaign or rally. It’s about what alternative governance models we can offer to the people of Punjab.

When the last time the Congress came to power in Punjab, in 2017, the party had projected a CM face

Notice to student

of India Surya Kant said Wednesday that the court would seek an explanation from the authorities.

“We are surprised. How did the magistrate dare to issue a notice when we have already annulled, and we have directed that on the already registered (FIRs), no action will be taken,” the CJI said after Senior Advocate Biswajeet Bhattacharya flagged a newspaper report about the notice.

The lawyer told the bench, also comprising Justice Joymaya Bagchi and Justice V Mohana, that the executive magistrate had issued notice to Akshat Tripathi, a second-year student of Gautam Buddha University in Noida. Tripathi was asked why he should not be bound down to a personal bond of Rs 5 lakh to ensure he would keep the peace. The notice was later revoked.

Describing the notice as an “experiment” being tried on students, Bhattacharya said it would have an “all-India implication”. He contended that the action of the authorities was “prima facie contempt”.

“Authorities of Noida, Uttar Pradesh cannot create contempt, and create a fear psychosis among students of India on whom lie the future hopes of our country,” he said.

Expressing surprise over the issue of notice, the CJI referred to the Supreme Court’s September 1 order quashing all cases against students who participated in the CJP-led protests against exam paper leaks.

“No penal action against any

student: It was a very clear-cut order. The language is very plain. Even a layman can understand. The executive magistrate or district magistrate... cannot violate that order,” he said.

When the bench asked Bhattacharya if he was aware that the notice had been revoked, he replied that he learned of it only from media reports. “The order was on September 1. The entire world knew. How could they commit contempt of that order?” he said.

“Correct. You are absolutely right. There is no question of taking action against our youth, no question of taking action against students. We have passed a clear order. We would have immediately taken cognisance of this, but you said they have withdrawn,” the CJI said.

Bhattacharya said, “It is contempt first and withdrawal second... Contempt can’t be purged. Contempt of the majesty of this court. This is the highest court of this country.”

Justice Bagchi said, “That is why place (the facts) on record.”

The CJI said, “You just place these facts on record. We will ask (for) an explanation from the district magistrate. Let him explain.”

Tripathi too approached the Supreme Court during the day, challenging the notice. In his plea, he said was a member of the UP committee of the SFI and that the notice issued by the “Executive Magistrate-Third, Greater Noida, Commissionerate Gautam Buddh Nagar...

‘Don’t have criminal history’

was issued. How can this suddenly come to an officer’s mind after two months of the protest,” he told *The Indian Express*. “We will fight to the end,” he said.

Tripathi, a resident of Allahabad, is the secretary of the Students’ Federation of India (SFI) unit in Gautam Buddha University.

A police report accused Tripathi of “spreading anti-government, misleading statements among other university students and provoking them”, saying this could “disrupt public peace”. Citing this report, the Greater Noida Executive Magistrate, who served the notice, noted that “there is a strong possibility of the opposite party breaching the peace”.

Countering this, Tripathi said that while he had participated in the protest at Jantar Mantar on July 20 and also got injured in the lathicharge, he had not been to his university since May 25. “How can they blame me for instigating people when I have not visited my university since May 25,” he said, adding that he left the hostel after the university declared holidays for two months in May-end.

“After the vacations got over, our classes were held online for a month since the administration said there was maintenance work going on in our college building. The notice says I provoked students, how is that possible? For almost the whole of

July, I was interning at the Allahabad High Court,” he said.

Tripathi said offline classes only resumed this week, on September 7. He reached the Capital on Wednesday morning, and filed a writ petition in the Supreme Court. “No such material has been disclosed to the petitioner, in violation of the requirement that a person proceeded against under such provisions be informed of the substance of the information against him so as to enable an effective show of cause,” he said in his petition.

According to Tripathi, he received the notice on his WhatsApp around 8 pm on September 4. The notice sought a personal bond of Rs 5 lakh for maintaining peace, and summoned him to Surajpur, in Greater Noida, the next day itself, he said.

On September 5, Tripathi wrote back to the magistrate stating that he had not been provided any direct and verifiable basis for the allegations against him. “It is not appropriate to take such action against an individual based solely on suspicion,” he said in his reply.

In an official statement on Wednesday, the Noida police said: “The notice was issued in connection with the protest demonstration, in the context of Sections 126 and 135 of the BNSS, requiring him to execute a bond for maintaining peace and public order. As soon as the matter came to the notice of senior officials, the flawed issued notice

(Capt Amarinder Singh, now with BJP). The Congress generally does not project a CM face before elections, but Punjab was an exception. Will you do it this time as well?

The normal practice for the Congress has been very, very rarely, if at all, has there been ever a (CM face) projection. And I think that is something that is in the past. But the normal practice has been that the party fights unitedly. And today, with how Mr Gandhi has now actually become the voice of the young people, youngsters, students and people, all those who feel dissatisfied with the BJP government. He is leading the campaign in all the states that we go to polls. It will be a joint campaign. I don’t think we are doing this (projecting a CM face) in any state. The entire team will fight the election. Once you get the majority, then we will take all who gets what role and responsibility. But as of now, we fight unitedly. The traditional practice has been to work and to go to the election as a team. And that’s what we’ll do this time (in Punjab).

You just had a meeting with Rahul Gandhi. So what is the sense on the Punjab leadership issue? Will Amrinder Singh Raja Warring continue as the

state Congress president till elections despite facing challenge from Charanjit Singh Channi? Is that settled now?

I don’t think all these things are discussed. I just wanted to thank Mr Gandhi for giving me this assignment in Punjab. As of now, we have all the committees formed, manifesto committee, campaign committee. We have working presidents and the team is working in full force. I was given a charge just two days ago. And from what I can understand right now, there’s been no discussion with me about any such change that you just asked me about.

What are the issues that the Congress would identify in Punjab to take on the AAP government?

The AAP government came with such a massive majority. People’s expectations are very high. In the last four and a half years, all the news that came out of Punjab was about some corruption, some allegations, some arrests, some ministers’ misbehaviour. And even today, there was a dying declaration against the finance minister. A person died by suicide. So I think what they have done basically is further mismanagement. There’s been fiscal bankruptcy.

The Punjab government is spending resources in image

called upon” him “to show cause as to why he should not be bound down under Sections 126/135 BNSS by executing a personal bond of Rs 5,00,000 with two sureties of like amount, for allegedly ‘instigating’ fellow students of his university to join a proposed dharna of the Cockroach Janta Party”.

He said he did not fall into the exception carved out for 2,873 individuals with antecedents of grave and heinous offences against whom the Supreme Court had allowed police to file FIRs.

Tripathi said the notice issued three days after the September 1 order, and without disclosing any specific overt act, time, statement or in stance of imminent violence was “founded on vague, unsubstantiated and mala fide allegations of ‘spreading anti-government misleading talks’ and ‘instigating’ students to join a proposed, and admittedly peaceful, dharna”.

“Such action, being preventive in the harshest sense... and directed solely against a student for encouraging peaceful assembly and protected speech, offends Articles 14, 19(1)(a), 19(1)(b) and 21 of the Constitution of India, and further sits in direct conflict with the binding directions” in the September 1 order, he said.

The notice, Tripathi said, “fixed the very next day, i.e. 05.09.2026, for appearance, affording” him “barely a day’s notice to engage counsel, arrange sureties of an extraordinary quantum, and prepare a defence, in violation of the principles of natural justice and the requirement of a reasonable opportunity envisaged even under a preventive/security proceeding”.

was cancelled on September 5, 2026”. It said departmental proceedings against personnel involved in the issuance of the notice had already been initiated.

Sections 126 and 135 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) are preventive legal provisions used by executive magistrates to maintain public peace and order.

The police statement said the Gautam Buddha Nagar District Magistrate was not involved in the matter. “Since police commissionerate system is in force in Gautam Buddha Nagar, the notice in question was issued by the Office of Magistrate III, Gautam Buddha Nagar,” it said.

Recalling the July protest, Tripathi said he, along with 15 others, boarded a train from Allahabad to Delhi on the morning of July 19, a day before the march to Parliament called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP).

“I had to convince my parents to let me go... they were scared for my safety... I assured them that I would be safe, but when I was injured during the protest, they got worried,” he said.

“Many of my close friends were among those who sat for the NEET-UG paper which got scrapped. Some had taken a gap year and got high scores. I wanted to support all the NEET aspirants... Somebody should take accountability, and I wanted to ensure that through my support,” he said.

“After I got the notice, my parents fear for my safety, but they have confidence in me. The SFI has stood by me since the first day,” he said.

building rather than governance and delivery on the ground. And so we will go up with a very positive agenda, despite highlighting the shortcomings of the government. We want to focus on the agrarian crisis, how to reindustrialise Punjab and bring back that glory. Punjab is so entrepreneurial all over the world. But why should Punjab not get the best in terms of investments and job creation? I think Punjab is and people of Punjab deserve that.

If the BJP and Shiromani Akali Dal join hands again, will that be an additional challenge for the Congress?

The Akali Dal is a very depleted force now. The BJP had an alliance with the Akali Dal when Badal sahab (Parkash Badal) was alive. And they were voted out of power. So it is immaterial whether they join hands with the BJP or fight independently. Our fight will be with the AAP. It does not matter how much anyone tries to make it a multi-cornered contest, it is going to be a Congress versus AAP fight. The BJP is trying desperately to gain a foothold, the Akali Dal is looking for a way out after getting routed in the Assembly and Lok Sabha polls. Their desperation may drive them to talk and engage with each other, but people will not accept them as an alternative.

Red Fort blast accused used AI to learn how to build IED, says NIA chargesheet

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 9

A KEY accused in the November 10, 2025 blast outside Red Fort used artificial intelligence (AI) to learn how to build an Improvised Explosive Device (IED), and ordered components for the bomb on Flipkart, the National Investigation Agency (NIA) has claimed in its chargesheet filed in the case.

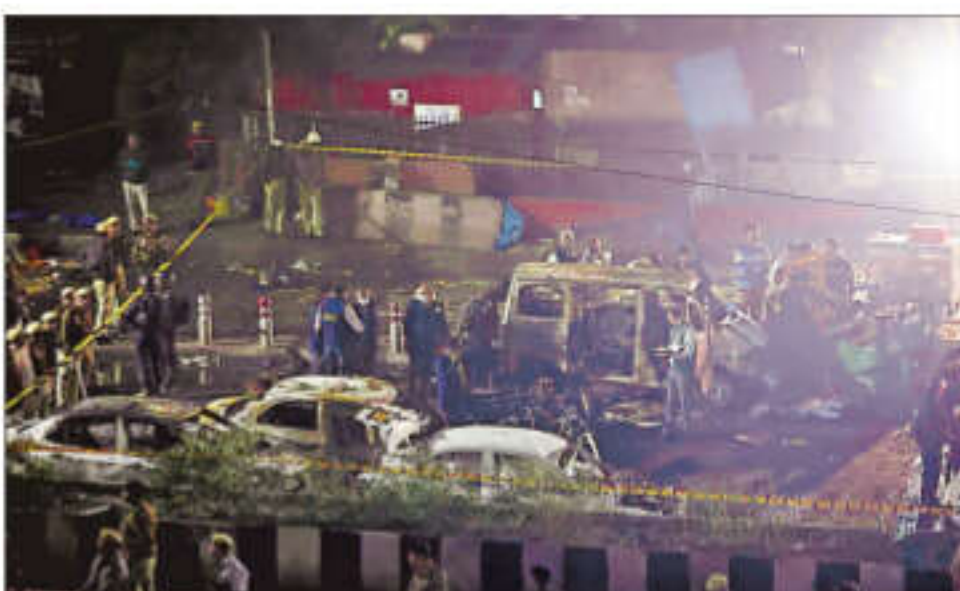
“...(Accused Jasir Bilal Wani) searched instructional videos on YouTube, ‘How to make a rocket’, ‘How to make a rocket with sugar’, ‘How to make a rocket with sugar and potassium nitrate’ and took assistance from the Chat GPT application for finding the instructions for constructing a rocket IED,” the chargesheet says.

The NIA has also claimed that the accused preferred to use Signal over WhatsApp and Telegram for planning, indoctrination, and operational secrecy, even though the free and open-source encrypted messaging service had been “invented by Kafirs”. They allegedly named their Signal groups “Shooley”, “Gabbarsinghi1975”, and “kavadyatra”.

“...Efforts should be made not to use these applications (WhatsApp and Telegram) at all for Jihadi purposes and to avoid them as much as possible. Insha Allah (Allah willing), it will benefit Jihad. Second thing, my brothers, is that the ‘Signal app’ was invented by ‘Kafirs’, but our experts consider it relatively safe, and it is also being experienced,” another accused, Irfan Ahmad Wagay, said in a chat, according to the NIA.

“For fabricating...[the] IEDs,...A-3 (Wani) procured several necessary ingredients through [the online store] Flipkart, registered on his mobile number 9541813661, with effect from 15.12.2023 to 24.01.2024. The funds for procuring the items...were provided to A-3 by A-1, and A-3 received all items in cash at the time of delivery,” the chargesheet says.

A-1 refers to Umar Un Nabi, the doctor from Pulwama in



At the site of the blast in November last year. FILE

Kashmir who taught at Al Falah University in Faridabad, and who has been identified as the man driving the Hyundai i20 that exploded outside Red Fort, killing 13 people.

According to the NIA, the alleged bomber stored urine in polybags to extract urea for use in explosives.

“The lady of the house had observed that A-1 was keeping Urine packed in a polybag...in the room where [he] was staying. He did not go outside to dispose it off. ...A foul smell was emanating from the room, regarding which she complained to A-8. It is worthwhile to observe here that an innovative method for preparing explosive substances using Urea Nitrate has been elaborated in a PDF material seized from the pen drives of A-6 and A-1, seized respectively at the instances of A-6 and A-9, wherein an alternative method for the source of urea is mentioned, extracting urea from urine,” the chargesheet says.

A court in Delhi took cognizance of the chargesheet in the last week of August.

According to the NIA, “the deceased accused (Umar Nabi) was well aware of the general area Red Fort and had visited the location multiple times earlier.” The agency has listed 12 alleged visits to the area by Umar Nabi between December 2023 and May 2025.

“...The accused considered the Red Fort to be symbolic of the Indian State, and the handwritten notes seized from A-1’s

NOIDA WORKERS’ PROTEST

Court relief to DU student charged with NSA to be challenged: Solicitor General

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 9

THE ALLAHABAD High Court ruling that quashed National Security Act (NSA) charges against Delhi University (DU) graduate Aakriti Chaudhary in connection with the Noida workers’ protest will be challenged, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta told the Supreme Court on Wednesday.

Mehta made the statement while clarifying a separate case involving a Gautam Buddha University student who had received a notice from an executive magistrate over a protest by the Cockroach Janta Party.

The issue of notice had been raised before the Supreme Court bench headed by Chief

Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant in the morning. Mehta clarified that the notice was issued by an executive magistrate and not the district magistrate and that after the court’s comments in the morning, the latter was flooded with queries.

The CJI then referred to another student case – that of Chaudhary, who had participated in the Noida workers’ agitation and was detained under the NSA. He noted that the Allahabad High Court had quashed her detention and awarded compensation.

Intervening, Mehta said, “That we are challenging”. He did not specify who the petitioner would be.

Chaudhary, a law student and DU graduate from Durga-



Aakriti Chaudhary

pur in West Bengal, was initially picked up on April 11 in connection with the Noida workers’ protests. The Uttar Pradesh government invoked the NSA against her on May 13.

On September 2, a bench of Justices Atul Sreedharan

and Achal Sachdev of the Allahabad High Court quashed her detention. The HC was hearing the Habeas Corpus plea of Chaudhary.

A 15-page order, released on Monday, described the invocation of the NSA against her as “arbitrary and vague”.

The court described the decision by the Gautam Buddha Nagar district magistrate to invoke the NSA as “worthy of derision” and directed that its “displeasure” with the officials involved be recorded in their service records.

It also held District Magistrate Medha Roopam “guilty of violating her oath of allegiance, making this a fit case for the imposition of compensation to the petitioner”.

The court granted Rs 5 lakh as compensation to the petitioner, to be “recovered from the salary of the District Magistrate... who has passed this order of detention without application of mind and from all such other officers who may have been responsible, right down to the SHO of the Police Station, who had prepared the initial report warranting the detention of the petitioner under the provisions of the NSA”.

The court warned that unchecked abuse of power by Uttar Pradesh Police and officials risked reducing the state to an “Orwellian Dystopia”, which describes a society characterised by government control, mass surveillance and the manipulation of truth and language.

Raghav Chadha filed Form 6 on August 26, approved after due procedure: Delhi CEO office

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 9

THE OFFICE of the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) on Wednesday said that BJP Rajya Sabha MP Raghav Chadha had filed Form 6 seeking inclusion in the electoral roll of Rajinder Nagar constituency on August 26 and his application was approved on September 2 after due procedure.

This came a day after the AAP alleged that Chadha, who left the party to join the BJP in April, had got himself enrolled illegally as a voter in Delhi after being struck off the draft Special Intensive Revision (SIR) roll last month in Punjab, where he had been a voter since at least 2024.

“As per record available, Raghav Chadha, MP (Rajya Sabha) applied for inclusion of his name in Form 6 in AC-39 (Rajinder Nagar) on August 26,” the office of Delhi CEO said.

Form 6 is the application



Raghav Chadha

form used in India to apply for a new voter identity card or to request the inclusion of a citizen’s name in electoral roll.

Chadha’s application, bearing number U05039D6N2608261200000, was approved by the Electoral Registration Officer after completion of the mandatory seven-day notice period, the CEO office said.

“The Form was approved by the Electoral Registration Officer... after completion of man-

The CEO office said Chadha's application was approved by the Electoral Registration Officer after completion of the mandatory 7-day notice period

datory notice period of 07 days,” the office further said, adding that the application was processed as per the procedure laid down by the Election Commission.

The AAP, however, claimed that the MP’s name had been added “through the back door”.

Anurag Dhandra, AAP’s national media in-charge demanded that Chadha’s Form 6 be made public and that people be allowed to file objections against it in the same manner

as for any ordinary elector.

Dhandra claimed Chadha’s name did not appear in any Form 6 received in Rajinder Nagar between September 1 and 7. He also questioned how Chadha’s name appeared as the 747th entry when the draft roll contained 746 voters and the final roll had not yet been published.

The CEO office said that under EC provisions, any eligible person whose name does not exist in the electoral roll can apply for inclusion through Form 6 along with the prescribed supporting documents. It also cited the EC’s May 14 guidelines on the SIR, which provide that additions made during the SIR period would be assigned serial numbers in continuation after the last entry of the draft roll.

“It is clarified that final electoral roll is published after completion of revision period and after disposing of all claims and

objections. However, as soon as any Form is approved ..., the name starts reflecting in the database in continuation of last serial number of draft roll,” the CEO office said.

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Dr. Amitabh Chowdhury
19.12.1969 - 10.09.2003

"In the rising of the sun and in its going down, we remember you, in the blowing of the wind and in the chill of winter, we remember you, in the rustling of leaves and in the beauty of autumn, we remember you. In all that we do, we remember you."

DR. AMITABH CHOWDHURY
MEDICINAL TREAT
& Members of the family

After AAP’s Jain, 5 accused get bail in STP tender ‘scam’ case

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 9

A DELHI court on Wednesday granted regular bail to five accused in the alleged multi-crore sewage treatment plant (STP) tender scam investigated by the Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB), questioning the circumstances of their arrests and the need for their continued custody. Last week, AAP leader Satyendar Jain was also granted bail in the case.

Those granted bail on Wednesday were former Delhi Jal Board (DJB) CEO Udit Prakash Rai, DJB’s former contractual consultant Ankit Srivastava; AN Enterprises proprietor Nagendra Yadav; Euroteck Environment Private Limited owner Raj Kumar Kurra and Srijanhar proprietor Pankaj Verma. All had been arrested

on August 18.

In his order, Special Judge Dig Vinay Singh of the Rouse Avenue Court said Rai, who was posted as a government servant in Mizoram, could not have been expected to travel to Delhi at short notice to join the investigation.

“...at such short notice he cannot be expected to fly to Delhi. In such circumstances, if he sought 10 days’ time to enable him to join the investigation, the claim of non-cooperation is unreasonable,” the court said.

Calling his “sudden arrest” “questionable”, the judge added that “this is not a case” where Rai had refused or avoided joining the investigation.

Questioning the allegation that money transferred through banking channels was a kickback, the court said, “One wonders why a person seeking kickbacks would do so through banking channels. If that amount was a kickback, why would he repay it, that too with interest?”

On the allegation that Rai had not cooperated with the probe, the court said, “Cooperation does not mean an accused dancing to the tunes of an Investigating Officer by offering self-incriminating material on a platter.”

The accused had argued that there was an unexplained 27-month delay in their arrests since the registration of the FIR and that there had been no meaningful progress in the probe before their arrest. They also questioned the need for police custody, saying there was no instance of tampering with evidence or influencing witnesses.

**STATE BANK OF INDIA**
LOCAL HEAD OFFICE, PATNA - 800001

NOTICE FOR OUR VALUABLE CUSTOMERS
We advise that United Forum of Bank Unions (UFBU) has served a notice of nationwide bank strike from the midnight of 10th September- 2026 to the midnight of 11th September- 2026.
While the management of the Bank is making all efforts to provide skeleton services at branches/offices during the strike period, customers may experience inconvenience in the event normal operations are affected.
Our valued customers are therefore requested to plan and complete their banking transactions well in advance of the strike date to avoid inconvenience. Customers are also advised to make use of ATMs for their cash requirements and prefer Internet Banking, YONO, UPI and other digital banking channels for their transactions.
The Bank sincerely regrets the inconvenience that may be caused to our customers due to the proposed strike.
State Level Bankers' Committee /
State Bank of India
Local Head Office, Patna

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AIIMS/Rajkot/Admin/Recruitment/NF/2026-27/5182 **Date : 28/07/2026**

Advertisement
Recruitment of Group "A" Non-Faculty Posts on Deputation Basis at AIIMS Rajkot
Offline applications are invited from eligible candidates for filling up of various Group 'A' Non-Faculty posts on deputation basis in AIIMS Rajkot, given as under

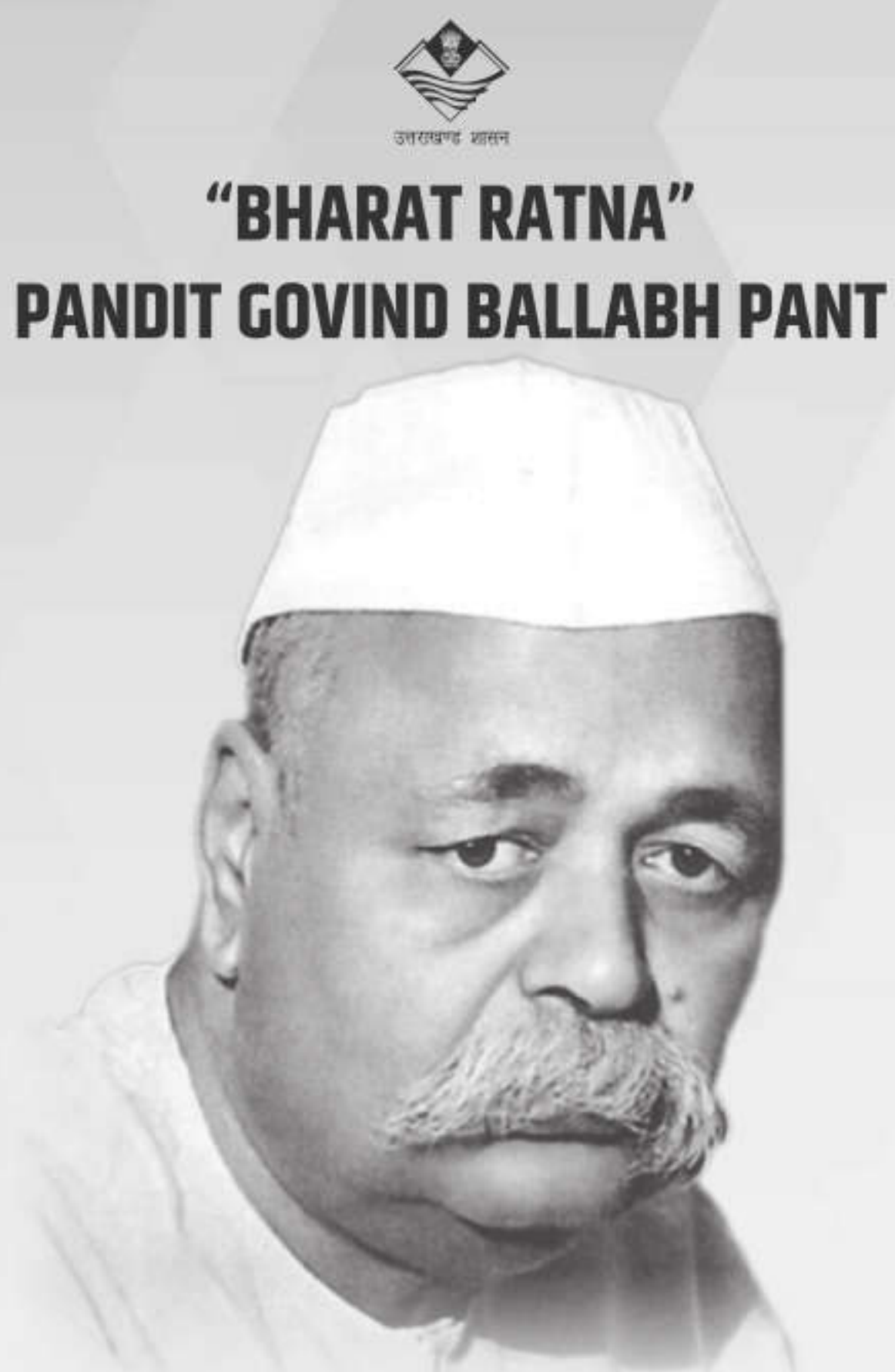
S. No.	Name of the Post	Pay Level (7th CPC)	Vacancy
1.	Medical Superintendent	Level 14	1
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3.	Registrar	Level 12	1
4.	Executive Engineer (Civil)	Level 11	1
5.	Executive Engineer (Electrical)	Level 11	1
6.	Senior Accounts Officer	Level 11	1

For Detailed advertisement, eligibility criteria and necessary information, candidates are advised to visit Institute's website : www.aiimsrajkot.edu.in

PUBLIC NOTICE
NOTICE IS HEREBY GIVEN to the applicant/holder who sought the allotment of a commercial unit in the Project 'Capital Central Market', situated at Sector-79, Faridabad, Haryana, and had deposited only earnest money, with no further amount paid.
Despite repeated telephonic communications and reminders, the Applicant has failed to execute the requisite documents, complete the formal allotment process, and clear the outstanding dues. Such failure constitutes a material breach of the terms and conditions applicable to the allotment.
The Company had already published a Public Notice dated 11.08.2026 and sent a written communication in this regard. However, none of the persons mentioned herein came forward to approach the Company or collect their respective amounts/refunds.
Hence, once again Notice is hereby given to the applicant/holder (mentioned herein) that the allotment in the Project 'CAPITAL CENTRAL MARKET' situated at Sector -79, Faridabad, Haryana, registered under RERA No: HRERA-PKL-FBD-303-2022, stand CANCELLED & TERMINATE with immediate effect.
The cancellation is due to non-payment of outstanding dues despite multiple Demand/reminder letters and Cancellation Notice dated 07.08.2026 and 04.09.2026.
Accordingly, the following persons are hereby granted a final and last opportunity to approach the Company and collect their respective refund cheques/demand drafts within 07 days from the date of publication of this notice.

S.No.	Name	S.No.	Name
1.	D.K.Bhatia	14.	Rakesh
2.	Manik Gulati	15.	Thakor Jigar Balbant
3.	Vivek Kumar Singh	16.	Aditya Kanhiya Bhatt
4.	Rohit Ranjan	17.	A Bansal/Gitesh
5.	Poonam Sharma	18.	Asif Yussfzi
6.	Pankaj Tiwari	19.	Anjali Nagpal
7.	Raman Deep	20.	Thakor Sonali Jigar
8.	Anitma Upadhyay	21.	Deepak Kumar
9.	Ram Prasad	22.	Kavish Arora
10.	Ayush Saxena	23.	Lalit Kalra
11.	Anubhav Saxena	24.	Dileep Kumar Sharma
12.	Anuradha Saxena	25.	Vinod/ Isha Pahuja
13.	Dileep Kumar Sharma		

In case any of the aforesaid persons fail to approach the Company and collect the respective refund amount within the stipulated period of 07 days, the Company shall not be responsible or liable for any claim in respect of the said amount thereafter.
By Order of the Management
Hansafon Buildcon Pvt. Ltd.



“BHARAT RATNA”
PANDIT GOVIND BALLABH PANT

(10th September 1887 – 7th March 1961)

HEARTFELT TRIBUTE FROM THE PEOPLE OF UTTARAKHAND
to
THE GREAT FREEDOM FIGHTER
and efficient Administrator
on the occasion of his
Birth Anniversary

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Worker dead as oxygen cylinder explodes in Delhi

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 9

A 35-YEAR-OLD worker was killed and four others were injured after a commercial oxygen cylinder exploded while it was being unloaded at a godown in Okhla Phase-I on Wednesday, police said.

The owner of the commercial godown was detained later in the day. The incident took place at D-23, Okhla Phase-I.

According to a preliminary inquiry, a mini truck (Tata 407) had brought the cylinders from Ghaziabad. The vehicle was registered in the name of SM Traders. The firm manager, in his preliminary police statement, said one of the oxygen cylinders fell onto the road during unloading and exploded.

The victim, Mohit Singh from Jaipur, was a helper with SM Traders. The injured — Umesh, Arvind, Manoj and Pankaj — were taken to AIIMS.

Advertisement No. 95/2026
Government of India
Public Enterprises Selection Board invites online applications for the post of
Director (Technical)
in
Eastern Coalfields Limited (ECL)
Last date of submission of online application by the applicant is by 15:00 hours on
29th September, 2026
Last date of forwarding of applications by the Nodal officers on online system of PESB is by 17:00 hours
8th October, 2026
For details login to website <https://www.pesb.gov.in>
Link for registration of nodal officers/competent authorities is available on PESB website.

WANTED
Aadishakti Dhandai Mata Shikshan Prasarak Sanstha's
Late Annasaheb R. D. Deore Arts & Science College
Mhasadi, Tal-Sakri, Dist-Dhule - 424303
(Affiliated to KBCNMU, Jalgaon)
Applications are invited from eligible candidates for the following Granted Full-Time posts of Assistant Professor in the subjects mentioned below:

Sr.	Subject	No. of Post	Category
1	Defence Studies	01	ST-1
2	Zoology	01	NT(B)-1

Permission as per NOC No.: JDHE/Jalgaon/NOC/2026/00003 Dated- 24/8/2026
The details of requisite educational qualifications, terms, conditions and pay scales (as per UGC and Govt. of Maharashtra) for the post of Assistant Professor are available at the university and college websites- www.nmu.ac.in, www.admmps.ac.in
Qualified candidates shall apply with certified copies of documents and application should reach by Offline / Online mode to – **The President/Principal, Aadishakti Dhandai Mata Shikshan Prasarak Sanstha's, Late Annasaheb R. D. Deore Arts & Science College, Mhasadi, Tal-Sakri, Dist-Dhule (MS)-424303 / E-mail- principaladmmps1998@gmail.com** on the above address within 15 days of publication of this advertisement.
Secretary **President**

SATYA NIKETAN BUILDING COLLAPSE

PG operator arrested, ‘came to spot after collapse, left fearing he would be beaten’

He was traced to a friend’s house in Burari; started the PG business in 2022, say police

Pragnesh & Alok Singh
New Delhi, September 9

THIRTY-ONE-YEAR-OLD SUDHANSHU, who ran the ‘Hostel Daze’ chain of PG accommodations at South West Delhi’s Satya Niketan, was among those who rushed to the five-storey building after it came crashing down on Sun-

day. But when students, mostly from Delhi University (DU), at the spot began recognising him, he left, fearing he would be beaten, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Three days later, police on Wednesday traced him to a friend’s house in Burari and arrested him. A graduate from DU’s Hans Raj College, police said Sudhanshu had started the PG business in 2022, primarily catering to students studying at his alma mater.

According to the police, after completing his graduation in 2019, Sudhanshu searched for a job but could not find one. He and his friend from college, Shubham Tyagi, subsequently decided to start the PG accom-



Sudhanshu in police custody. PTI

modation business.

“Since 2022, Sudhanshu, along with Shubham Tyagi, started operating PG accommodations in Satya Niketan under the name Hostel Daze. At present, he runs seven PGs

in the vicinity. Four floors of the building were taken on lease by him and Shubham last August in lieu of Rs 1.05 lakh per month,” said DCP Amit Goel.

Sources in the police said the rent charged by these PGs ranged from around Rs 13,000 to Rs 15,000 per person, depending on the kind of accommodation and facilities offered.

Sudhanshu was in charge of installing the 16-bed facility with amenities, looking after maintenance, and overseeing the repair and construction work needed at the 50-year-old building that collapsed. He was the main person prospective tenants met when they came looking for rooms, sources in the police said.

They added that Sudhanshu took the building on rent as it was being offered at a lesser price than the usual market price, primarily due to its poor condition.

Sudhanshu, police further said, was also allegedly in charge of getting the rent agreement signed, which mentioned that the PG owners are not responsible for any casualty or death of students residing there.

The rental agreement, accessed by The Indian Express, appears to absolve the owners of responsibility for risks to students’ lives. It also gives the management the power to ask students to vacate their rooms at its discretion, without citing a legitimate reason.

Police said Sudhanshu is being questioned to ascertain details of his whereabouts on the day of incident, and how he managed the property.

Sudhanshu is the fifth person to be arrested in connection with the collapse that killed seven people.

The owner of the building, Hari Ram, his son Mahesh, wife Urmila, and labour contractor Saroj were arrested earlier in the case.

“The owners allegedly knew that the building wouldn’t be able to bear the weight of four additional floors. And yet, they decided to give the construction a go-ahead and lease it out to a PG company,” a senior officer said.



Workers prepare to demolish a building near the site of the collapse in Satya Niketan in New Delhi on Wednesday. GAJENDRA YADAV

● PIL SEEKS HOSTELS FOR STUDENTS

● The Delhi High Court Wednesday issued notice to the Centre, Delhi government and DU on a PIL by National Students’ Union of India president seeking directions to authorities to formulate and implement a time-bound hostel development policy.

● The PIL sought that DU be directed to provide hostel facilities in each of its colleges.

● The PIL flagged that the Satya Niketan building collapse “serves as a grave warning regarding the risks faced by thousands of students who are dependent upon privately operated accommodation in different parts of Delhi because their respective colleges do not have adequate hostel facilities”.

● The PIL sought construction or expansion of hostel facilities “where sufficient land is available within a college campus” and where colleges “face genuine land constraints, the authorities may develop common/cluster hostels at suitable locations catering to students of neighbouring University colleges”.

● The court will hear the matter next on September 25. ENS

MCD razes 58 buildings, orders issued for 31 more

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, September 9

THE MUNICIPAL Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Wednesday carried out 34 demolition actions, sealed 17 properties, ordered four demolitions and issued 22 show-cause notices for unauthorised construction and 27 for sealing, as it intensified its crackdown on illegal construction and dangerous buildings across Delhi following the building collapse in Satya Niketan.

The action was carried out across all 12 zones as part of the civic body’s ongoing enforcement drive against unauthorised construction, misuse of properties and violations of the Master Plan of Delhi and building bye-laws.

Since the Satya Niketan building collapse on Sunday, the MCD has demolished 58 buildings, sealed 24 properties, ordered 31 demolitions and issued 57 show-cause notices for unauthorised construction and 33 for sealing.

At six, Narela Zone recorded the highest number of demolition actions on Wednesday, followed by South and Central zones with five each. Keshavpuram Zone and Shahdara (North) recorded three demolition ac-



An MCD official conducts a door-to-door survey of PG accommodations in Satya Niketan on Wednesday. GAJENDRA YADAV

tions each, while Shahdara (South) recorded two. The West Zone saw two demolition actions, including one at Deep Enclave in Part II of Vikas Nagar.

In the City-SP zone, the MCD demolished portions of properties at Kucha Chelan and Bazar Sitaram, including unauthorised construction. Action was also taken against properties declared dangerous in Vikas Nagar and Sector 17, Dwarka.

In Keshavpuram, the MCD demolished four RCC (reinforced cement concrete) roof slab panels on the third floor and one panel on the first floor of a property in Rana Pratap Bagh. At Sardar Nagar in Model

Town, three RCC slab panels were demolished.

Further, MCD sealed 17 properties on Wednesday. Four were sealed in Civil Lines, including Vardhman Mall, over violations related to misuse and unauthorised construction. Four properties in Prem Nagar and Kala Mahal in the City-SP zone were also sealed.

Between June 1 and September 9, MCD has demolished 1,053 properties, sealed 491, served show-cause notices to 2,316 and ordered 757 demolitions.

Meanwhile, the civic body is conducting a city-wide survey of paying guest (PG) accommodations to create a database and

● Days after hostel building collapse

PG surveys	Demolition action (Sept 9)
39 Visibly Repairable – Needs Minor Repairs	Narela 6
9 Visibly Repairable – Needs Major Repairs	South 5
3 (1 has been demolished): Visibly Vulnerable / Dangerous	Central 5
	Keshavpuram 3
	Shahdara (North) 3

MCD DEMOLITION ACTION REPORT (SEP 7-9)					
Date	Demolitions	Properties sealed	UC show-cause notices	Sealing show-cause notices	Demolition orders
Sep 7	7	2	26	4	12
Sep 8	17	5	9	2	15
Sep 9	34	17	22	27	4
TOTAL	58	24	57	33	31

identify buildings requiring further safety or enforcement action.

According to an official statement, 1,252 PG buildings housing nearly 24,000 occupants have been surveyed so far. The survey, set to be completed by September 10, has identified 39 buildings requiring minor repairs, nine requiring major repairs and three as dangerous. One of the three dangerous buildings has already been de-

molished.

The MCD is prioritising buildings considered vulnerable, particularly those with more than five storeys with RCC-framed structures or four storeys with load-bearing brick walls. The buildings are being categorised as “Visibly Safe”, “Visibly Repairable – Needs Minor Repairs”, “Visibly Repairable – Needs Major Repairs” and “Visibly Vulnerable/Dangerous”.

will begin arriving, will be placed under full security cover of the Delhi Police and other security agencies. Each hotel has been assigned a security team led by NSG officials.

Officials, meanwhile, said Russia and China are expected to have the largest motorcades among the visiting delegations.

All venues, hotels and dignitaries’ cavalcades have been given special code words for use by security officials commanding their respective areas. A multi-layered security grid has been put in place, with anti-

● Skywatch



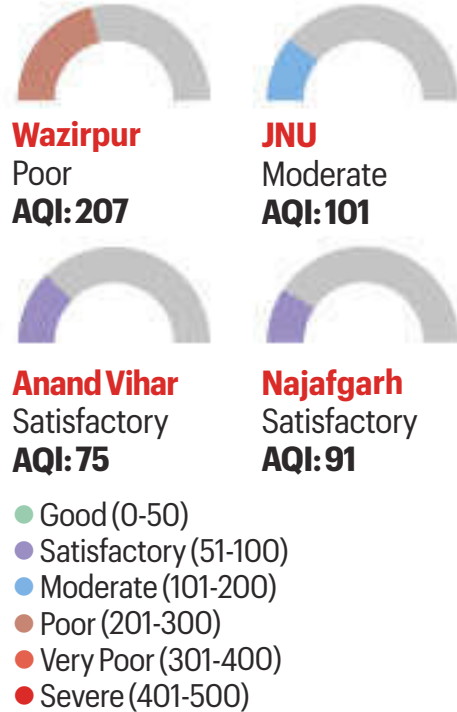
Forecast:
September 10, 2026
Party cloudy sky. No rain.

MAX: 34-36
2.5°C above normal

MIN: 25-27
1.4°C above normal

• **Sunrise:** 6:04 AM (September 11)
• **Sunset:** 6:32 PM (September 10)
• **Moonrise:** 6:02 AM (September 11)
• **Moonset:** 6:02 PM (September 10)

● AQI Tracker



Days after former Chief Secretary died by suicide, colleagues remember him fondly

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, September 9

THE DEATH of former Delhi chief secretary Rakesh Mehta, who died by suicide on September 6, has shaken the politicians and bureaucrats. Mehta, a former IAS officer, who was said to have shared a close bond with late Delhi Chief Minister Sheila Dixit, pioneered privatisation across several sectors.

The 1975-batch AGMUT cadre officer, Mehta served as the chief secretary from 2007 until his retirement in 2011. This was a crucial period, with the Assembly elections being held in 2008 and the Commonwealth Games in 2010. In 2012, Mehta was appointed as the state election commissioner, responsible for conducting the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) elections. Mehta also served as the MCD commissioner from April 2002 to November 2005.

BJP MLA and Delhi Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta, who has been a member of the MCD’s 18-member standing committee during Mehta’s tenure — as the leader of opposition — says he closely interacted and worked with him between May 2002 and November 2005. “He was one of the most dynamic MCD commissioners ... the conviction with which he worked, the changes he brought to MCD. He played a key role in the establishment of the MCD Civic Centre. The land where it is built, was encroached. He ensured that was removed and the plan for the building took off, with him helming its execution. He ensured that the centre is sustainable, where it was generating revenue for MCD while also being an asset,” says Gupta.

“He also had a reputation as an upright officer and carried a lot of weight in the courts. He was seen as a responsible officer. He would also come forward if an officer was hesitant to sign a file, and say: ‘*Lao, mujhe do, main sign kar dunga*’ (Give it to me, I will sign it),” Gupta says, also calling him “extremely soft-spoken and patient”.

Mehta also played a significant role in shutting down the Idgah slaughterhouse, and ensuring that the Ghazipur slaughterhouse was up and running, as per directions issued by the Supreme Court.

BJP MLA Arvinder Singh Lovely, who served in Dixit’s Cabinet from 2003 to 2013, including in the Transport depart-



Rakesh Mehta

ment when Mehta was serving as the Delhi Transport Corporation chairman, remembers him as a “fine officer, very innovative, open to new ideas”. He says Mehta was always a step ahead, attempting digitisation in governance in the earlier years of the third millennium.

“When he was chief secretary, he was responsible for converting DTC buses into CNG ones pursuant to court orders. It was around a 5,000-bus fleet back then, which would otherwise run on diesel. Mehta also introduced low-floor buses to Delhi’s fleet,” Lovely says.

For retired IAS officer Ramesh Negi, who worked with Mehta while the latter was the MCD commissioner as well as the principal secretary, recalls how “hands-on”, “field-oriented”, “risk-taker” Mehta was. Mehta’s initiatives and measures brought in a framework of efficiency, providing citizens with better services while also cutting down on wasteful spending, Negi adds.

“Normally bureaucrats are cautious and traditional in their methods. He was visionary, always experimenting with new ideas. His ability to take risks was how he brought so many reforms,” says Negi.

Negi, who was the MCD additional commissioner when Mehta was the commissioner, says Mehta brought in IT service providers in the civic body’s citizen centres for facilitating records such as birth and death certificates, and property tax records.

Mehta also played a pivotal role in introducing the unit area method for calculating property tax and in privatisation of transport of solid waste.

Congress’s Haroon Yusuf, who held charge of the Power department in Dixit’s Cabinet from 2003 to 2008, recalls Mehta’s “proactive role” in laying the groundwork when electricity distribution was privatised in the Capital. “Instead of asking juniors to prepare notes, he would prepare the whole Cabinet note himself. He never lost his calm.”

● MULTI-LAYERED SECURITY GRID HAS BEEN PUT IN PLACE, WITH ANTI-AIRCRAFT GUNS, ANTI-DRONE SYSTEMS, SNIPERS AND ANTI-SABOTAGE TEAMS DEPLOYED AT STRATEGIC LOCATIONS

25,000 cops, 35 routes, 11 hotels: How Capital is securing the BRICS Summit

Alok Singh & Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, September 9

AS MANY as 25,000 security personnel, more than 100 National Security Guard (NSG) commandos, anti-drone systems and repeated mock drills: Delhi is mounting a massive security operation for the 18th BRICS Summit beginning September 11.

Guests and heads of state from 11 member countries and 10 partner countries are expected to participate in the two-day summit.

Officials said arrangements drawn up by the security unit of the Delhi Police in coordination with national and international security agencies are on a scale comparable to those put in

place for the 2023 G20 Summit.

The security

■ Around 30 officers of the Deputy Commissioner of Police (DCP)-rank have been deployed from the main venue, Bharat Mandapam — where the meetings of the heads of state will take place — to hotels across the city where dignitaries will stay.

■ At least 10 DCPs have been deployed at and around Bharat Mandapam.

■ At least 100 NSG commandos, along with Delhi Police SWAT personnel, have been tasked with securing the venue and hotels.

According to a police officer, rehearsals for the movement of cavalcades from the airport to the hotels and the venue, and



Outside Bharat Mandapam on Wednesday. Security has been stepped up in the Capital ahead of the summit. AMIT MEHRA

back, have already been conducted multiple times.

Mock drills under the supervision of the NSG, in the likelihood of an emergency situation, have also been

conducted at the venue and hotels around five times in the past 10 days.

According to a source, the Delhi Traffic Police has finalised routes for dignitaries travel-

ling to Bharat Mandapam.

■ Around 25,000 personnel, apart from local police, will ensure a peaceful and hassle-free event. More than 10,000 personnel, drawn from paramilitary forces, including the CRPF, ITBP, BSF and RAF, will remain on standby for any requirement.

■ Two command rooms have been set up at Bharat Mandapam and the Delhi Police Headquarters to oversee the whole security event and the movement of the cavalcades.

From September 11, 11 major hotels, where the dignitaries



will begin arriving, will be placed under full security cover of the Delhi Police and other security agencies.

Each hotel has been assigned a security team led by NSG officials. Officials, meanwhile, said Russia and China are

expected to have the largest motorcades among the visiting delegations.

All venues, hotels and dignitaries’ cavalcades have been given special code words for use by security officials commanding their respective areas. A multi-layered security grid has been put in place, with anti-

aircraft guns, anti-drone systems, snipers and anti-sabotage teams deployed at strategic locations across central Delhi.

“The security grid has been divided into sectors, with each sector placed under the charge of a Deputy Commissioner of Police or an Additional Deputy Commissioner of Police,” a source, meanwhile, said.

Roads shut, weekend holiday

Roads leading to Lutyens’ Delhi will remain largely shut on Saturday and Sunday; police personnel will be deployed on these roads to prevent movement of unauthorised people.

BNSF Section 163 (prohibition of gathering of people) has already been imposed in central and Lutyens’ Delhi, but on

Saturday and Sunday, it will be enforced across Delhi.

The government has declared a holiday on Friday and Saturday; courts will also remain closed. Major markets such as Connaught Place and Chandni Chowk, as well as prominent monuments, will remain open, as dignitaries or their family members may visit them. Special police teams will be provided for their security, officials said.

The traffic police has identified nearly 35 routes that are likely to be affected during the summit-related events. The routes are being monitored through CCTV cameras and guarded by security personnel to prevent. The traffic police have also advised diversions on 22 routes.



TRAFFIC ADVISORY



Welcome

International Heads of State, Dignitaries and Global Delegates

BRICS Summit-2026

11 - 13 Sept., 2026 Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi



Diversion Points: 22 **Controlled Roads: 35+** **Elaborate vehicular regulations in force**

To ensure seamless movement for VIP convoys and minimize public inconvenience, dedicated traffic regulations and diversions will be in effect, primarily across the New Delhi District and surrounding corridors



ROADS TO AVOID CONTROLLED AREA

Motorists should not plan routes through the following roads for the duration of the Summit. A detailed map is issued alongside the official notice.

Mathura Road (Subramaniam Bharti Marg T-Pt - Lodhi Rd Flyover)	Brig. Hoshiyar Singh Marg
Tees January Marg	Shanti Path
Janpath	Sher Shah Suri Marg
Satya Marg	Dr. Zakir Hussain Marg
Prithvi Raj Road	Tilak Marg
Firoze Shah Road	San Martin Marg
Ashoka Road	Rajesh Pilot Marg
Tughlak Road	Akbar Road
Neela Gumbad	Sardar Patel Marg
Panchsheel Marg	APJ Abdul Kalam Road
Subramaniam Bharti Marg	Kautilya Marg
Mother Teresa Crescent	Bhagwan Das Road
Teen Murti Marg	Kemal Atatürk Marg
Africa Avenue (Bhikaji Cama Place - Yashwant Place)	Kartavya Path
'C' Hexagon	Purana Quila Road
	Safdarjung Road
	Nyaya Marg



SUGGESTED ROUTES RAILWAY STATIONS

NEW DELHI RAILWAY STATION

Route A: ISBT Kashmiri Gate → Boulevard Road → Rani Jhansi Marg → DBG Road → Panchkuian Road → Outer Circle, Connaught Place
Route B: Ashram Chowk → Ring Road → Raj Ghat → JLN Marg
Route C: Vande Matram Marg → Dr. Ambedkar Marg → Panchkuian Road → Outer Circle, Connaught Place



OLD DELHI RAILWAY STATION

Route A: ISBT Kashmiri Gate → Ring Road → Hanuman Mandir → S.P. Mukherjee Marg
Route B: Ashram Chowk → Ring Road → Raj Ghat → Ring Road → Hanuman Mandir → S.P. Mukherjee Marg
Route C: Vande Matram Marg → Dr. Ambedkar Marg

→ Rani Jhansi Marg → Rani Jhansi Flyover → Boulevard Road → Lothiyan Marg

HAZRAT NIZAMUDDIN RAILWAY STATION

Route A: AIIMS → Ring Road → Ashram Chowk → Mathura Road
Route B: ISBT Kashmiri Gate → Ring Road → Raj Ghat → Ring Road → Ashram Chowk → Mathura Road



SUGGESTED ROUTES AIRPORT

METRO STRONGLY RECOMMENDED: Motorists are advised to travel to Airport Terminals via Metro services in view of traffic regulations.

FROM GURUGRAM

• T3 / T4 / T2: NH-48 → Rao Gajraj Singh Marg → Old Delhi Gurugram Road → UER II → Service Road → T3 Terminal Road
 • T1: NH-48 → under Mahipalpur Flyover → T-3 Road
 • T1: NH-48 → Mahipalpur Flyover → NH-48 → Ulaanbaatar Marg → T-1 Road

FROM DWARKA

• T3/T4/T2/T1: Sector-22, Dwarka Road → UER II (New Tunnel to T3)

FROM NEW DELHI & SOUTH DELHI

• T3: Ring Road → AIIMS Chowk → Moti Bagh Chowk → RTR Marg → Under Shankar Vihar Flyover → Sanjay T-Point → Service Road → NH-48 → Under Mahipalpur Flyover Rangpuri → T-3 Road.
 • T3 / T4 / T2 / T1: AIIMS Chowk → Ring Road → Moti Bagh Chowk → RTR Marg → Shankar Vihar Flyover → Ulaanbaatar Marg

FROM WEST DELHI

• T3 / T4 / T2 / T1: Punjabi Bagh Chowk → Ring Road → Raja Garden Chowk → Najafgarh Road → Pankha Road → Dabri → Dwarka Road → Road No. 224, Dabri-Gurugram Road → Sector-22, Dwarka Road → UER-II → Service Road NH-48 → T3 Terminal Road.

FROM NORTH & EAST DELHI

• T3/T4/T2/T1: ISBT Kashmiri Gate → Rani Jhansi Flyover → Rohtak Road → Punjabi Bagh Chowk → Raja Garden Chowk → Najafgarh Road → Pankha Road → Dabri → Dwarka Road → Road No. 224, Dabri-Gurugram Road → Sector-22, Dwarka Road → UER-II → Service Road NH-48 → T3 Terminal Road



TRANSPORT SERVICES

• **BUS:** Necessary diversions may be given during VVIP movements.
 • **METRO:** Available for commuters at all stations without disruption.
 • **TSRs / TAXIS:** No roadside parking except designated areas; diversions possible during VVIP movement.

05



DIVERSION POINTS



ALTERNATE ROUTES



OUTSIDE CONTROLLED AREA

01 DR DINESH NANDINI DALMIA CHOWK (W-POINT)	NOT ALLOWED: Mathura Road, Tilak Marg DIVERTED VIA: BSZ Marg → IP Marg - East/South Delhi DIVERTED VIA: BSZ Marg → Delhi Gate - Centre/North/West Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Sikandara Road - New Delhi/CP	07 ROUND ABOUT, RML HOSPITAL	NOT ALLOWED: Towards Mother Teresa Crescent & Talkatora Road DIVERTED VIA: Sheikh Mujibur Rehman Marg - Centre/South/West/North Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Baba Kharak Singh Marg - CP /West/North/Centre/East Delhi	15 LODHI ROAD / MAHARISHI RAMAN MARG	NOT ALLOWED: Maharishi Raman Marg DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Road - South/East/West/ Centre/North/New Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Bhisim Pitamah Marg - South Delhi
02 RAM CHARAN AGGARWAL CHOWK (A-POINT)	NOT ALLOWED: Commercial vehicles beyond this chowk to W-Point DIVERTED VIA: IP Marg - East/South Delhi DIVERTED VIA: DDU Marg - New Delhi/CP DIVERTED VIA: BSZ Marg → Delhi Gate - Centre /North/West Delhi	08 VANDE MATRAM MARG / SIMON BOLLIVAR MARG	NOT ALLOWED: Simon Bollivar Marg DIVERTED VIA: Vande Matram Marg → Dhaura Kuan - South Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Vande Matram Marg → Karol Bagh - New Delhi/East/North/West/Centre Delhi	16 LODHI ROAD / ARCH BISHOP MACARIUS MARG UNDER LODHI FLYOVER	NOT ALLOWED: Arch Bishop Macarius Marg DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Road - South/East/ West/Centre/North/New Delhi NOT ALLOWED: Mathura Road towards Bharat Mandapam DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Road → Neela Gumbad - South/East Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Barapullah Flyover - East Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Road → Madarsa / Lala Lajpat Rai Marg - South/West/Centre/North/New Delhi
03 MIR DARD CHOWK	NOT ALLOWED: Maharaja Ranjit Singh Marg DIVERTED VIA: Mir Dard Marg → Abdul Gaffar Marg → DDU Marg - New Delhi/Centre/North/ West Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Mir Dard Marg → Kotla Marg → BSZ Marg/DDU Marg - North/Centre/East/ West/South Delhi	09 DHAULA KUAN FLYOVER	NOT ALLOWED: Sardar Patel Marg DIVERTED VIA: Ring Road (both sides) - South/ New Delhi/East Delhi & Centre/West/East Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Vande Matram Marg - New Delhi/ North/Centre/East Delhi DIVERTED VIA: NH 48/Gurgaon Road - IGI Airport & Gurugram	18 NEELA GUMBAD	NOT ALLOWED: Towards Oberoi Flyover / Dr. Zakir Hussain Marg DIVERTED VIA: Mathura Road → Ashram Chowk - South/East/Centre/North Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Road - South/West/Centre/ North/New Delhi
04 KASTURBA GANDHI MARG / OUTER CIRCLE CP	NOT ALLOWED: Towards C Hexagon, Outer Circle CP DIVERTED VIA: Outer Circle → All other arterial roads except Janpath - New Delhi/South Delhi	10 MOTI BAGH FLYOVER	NOT ALLOWED: Shanti Path DIVERTED VIA: Ring Road (both sides) - South/ New Delhi/East Delhi & Centre/West/East Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Rao Tula Ram Marg - South West Delhi, IGI Airport & Gurugram	19 UNDER OBEROI FLYOVER	NOT ALLOWED: Mathura Road DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Flyover through U-turn underpass opp. DPS Mathura Road - South/East/ West/Centre/North/New Delhi PERMITTED: Vehicles bound for Oberoi Hotel and Golf Link
05 JANPATH/ CONNAUGHT PLACE	NOT ALLOWED: Towards C Hexagon from Outer Circle CP DIVERTED VIA: Outer Circle → All other arterial roads except Kasturba Gandhi Marg- New Delhi/ South Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Kali Bari, Shaheed Bhagat Singh, Panchkuiyan, Minto & Barakhamba Roads - Centre/North/West/East Delhi	11 ROUND ABOUT, BRIG. HOSHIAR SINGH MARG	NOT ALLOWED: Africa Avenue towards Yashwant Place DIVERTED VIA: Brig. Hoshiar Singh Marg - New Delhi/South/East District DIVERTED VIA: Africa Avenue → Bhikaji Cama Flyover - South/East/Centre/North/West Delhi	20 U-TURN OPPOSITE DPS, MATHURA ROAD	NOT ALLOWED: Towards Bharat Mandapam DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Flyover through U-turn underpass opp. DPS Mathura Road - South/ East/West/Centre/North/New Delhi
06 PATEL CHOWK	NOT ALLOWED: Towards Windsor Place & RBI on Sansad Marg DIVERTED VIA: Ashoka Rd → GPO - New Delhi/ South/West/Centre Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Sansad Marg → CP- Centre/ North/West/East Delhi	12 MADARSA T-POINT	NOT ALLOWED: Towards Aurobindo Marg DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Road - South/East Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Aurobindo Marg → Safdarjung Fly over - South/New Delhi/West/Centre/North Delhi	21 RING ROAD / BHAIRON ROAD	NOT ALLOWED: Towards Bhairon Marg DIVERTED VIA: Ring Road Sarai Kale Khan - South/East/New Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Ring Road Rajghat - Centre/ North/East/West Delhi
		13 LODHI ROAD / AMRITA SHERGIL MARG	NOT ALLOWED: Amrita Shergil Marg DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Road - South/East/West/ Centre/North/New Delhi	22 MANDI HOUSE	NOT ALLOWED: Feroz Shah Road, Bhagwan Das Road, Copernicus Marg DIVERTED VIA: Barakhamba Road - New Delhi/ Centre/North/West/South Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Sikandra Marg - East/North/ West/South/Centre Delhi
		14 LODHI ROAD/ MAX MUELLER MARG	NOT ALLOWED: Max Mueller Marg DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Road - South/East/West/ Centre/North/New Delhi		



06 IMPORTANT INSTRUCTIONS & PUBLIC ADVISORY

Priority Corridors & Exemptions

• **Emergency & Medical Vehicles:** Priority, obstruction-free passage maintained 24/7 across Delhi.
 • **Essential Services & Utilities:** Uninterrupted access granted for essential supplies and utility operations in all zones.

Travel Planning & Public Mobility

• **Transit Hubs:** Allow extra travel time when heading to Airports, Railway Stations and ISBTs.
 • **Public Transport & Routes:** Opt for public transport and follow designated alternative routes and diversion points.
 • **Commercial Traffic:** Non-destined commercial vehicles are prohibited from entering Delhi.

Traffic Rules & Parking

• **Designated Parking:** Park only in authorized areas; roadside parking within 200 meters of Controlled Roads is strictly prohibited.
 • **Road Discipline:** Follow the instructions of deployed traffic personnel and obey all traffic rules patiently.

Public Safety & Updates

• **Security Vigilance:** Report any unidentified objects or suspicious activity to the nearest police officer immediately.
 • **Real-Time Information:** Stay updated via official Delhi Police social media channels and traffic portals.



Public cooperation is solicited to ensure smooth transit and safety for all.



SCAN QR CODE for TRAFFIC ADVISORY BRICS Summit-2026



Navsari Office

DURING HIS visit to Gujarat on Tuesday, one of the events that Prime Minister Narendra Modi attended was the inauguration of BJP's district office, 'Namo Kamalam', at Navsari, a segment represented by Jal Shakti Minister C R Patil. This is perhaps the first time that the Prime Minister inaugurated a district-level party office. The BJP has been prioritising construction of brick-and-mortar offices across the country. The newly constructed building at Navsari has all the state-of-the-art facilities, including conference rooms and latest gadgets.

Selfless Service

SOME SENIOR Congress leaders in the AICC are 'very impressed' with Indian Youth Congress (IYC) and National Students' Union of India (NSUI) workers for their involvement in the rescue work at the site of the recent building collapse in South Delhi. Soon after the news of the building collapse spread on Sunday, some Youth Congress and NSUI workers reached the site to take part in the rescue work. According to sources, a senior AICC leader is contemplating to call these youth and student workers to thank them for their selfless service. Youth Congress is led by Uday Bhanu Chib, while Vinod Jakhar heads the NSUI.

No politics, says Satheesan after ED's nudge for case against Vijayan

Thiruvananthapuram: The Kerala government will decide on the ED's letter asking state police to register an FIR against former chief minister Pinarayi Vijayan, among others, CM V Satheesan said on Wednesday, following a Cabinet meeting. The ED has asked the Kerala police to register a case against Vijayan, now LoP in the Assembly, his daughter T Veena, son-in-law Mohammed Riyas and others under the PMLA in a money laundering case allegedly involving Veena's IT firm Exalogic Solutions. "There is no politics; the government will legally examine the report. A decision will be taken accordingly. Law will take its course... We have to scrutinise the seriousness of the allegations made by the ED. We cannot reject it merely because ED has sent it," Satheesan said. ENS

Nilekani, family likely to be served SIR notice

Express News Service
Bengaluru, September 9

THE ENTIRE family of Infosys co-founder and entrepreneur Nandan Nilekani has featured in the discrepancy list published by the Election Commission of India (ECI) as part of the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Karnataka.

Nilekani, 71, his wife Rohini Nilekani, 67, and their children Janhvi Nandan Nilekani, 38, and Nihar Nilekani, 36, are expected to be served notices during the ongoing document verification phase of the SIR. As per the discrepancy list accessed by *The Indian Express*, Nilekani and his family members have been classified as "Unmapped with last SIR". The classification applies to voters who were not part of the 2002 electoral rolls, officials said. The Nilekani family features in the draft electoral roll for the BTM Layout constituency and

Nabin targets Rahul's youth events, says no resonance

Lists out events scheduled to mark PM's birthday on Sept 17, completion of 25 yrs in public office on Oct 7

Liz Mathew

New Delhi, September 9

WITH RAHUL Gandhi's 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' campaign getting political attention at a time when the government is under criticism for the paper leak and alleged exam irregularities, BJP national president Nitin Nabin on Wednesday said the influence of the Congress leader's events would not go beyond the party and its workers.

Nabin said had there been "any substance" in the voice the Opposition is raising for the youth, they "would have done something" for them "when they had the opportunity." "Those who have given the term 'goonj', how much depth do they have in their own voice," Nabin said at his first press conference since taking charge as the BJP national president in January. "Those who are misleading the nation's youth, had there been any real substance to their voices, would have done something for the nation's youth when they had the opportunity."

According to the BJP president, the country's youth are "moving forward towards self-reliance" under Narendra Modi's leadership. "Therefore, I do not believe that the impact of their



BJP national president Nitin Nabin announces the Seva Sankalp Abhiyan at the party office in Delhi on Wednesday. AMIT MEHRA

'goonj' will extend beyond their own party workers. The youth of the country and the general public stand with PM Modi," he said.

Responding to a question over the tragic collapse of a five-storey paying guest (PG) accommodation near Delhi University's South Campus, Nabin said both the party and the government will see that the students who travel outside their native places for studies and employment get a safe and secure environment. "I would like to assure the students that the government will address the issues and concerns they have raised. In the coming times, we want to ensure a safe and secure atmosphere for the students who go out for studies as well as employment. The Delhi government is tackling the challenges. We will have a holistic approach in resolving the issues that are faced by the students," he said.

With both the BJP and the government still struggling to muster adequate number to push the 131st Constitution

Amendment Bill to increase the number of seats in the Lok Sabha, linked to the implementation of women's reservation law passed in 2023 and the delimitation, he rejected the Opposition's suggestion to delink the implementation of the law from the delimitation exercise.

"Our commitment to women's reservation law is clear and we want to empower women... But we will not back the narrow approaches that some have suggested. We want to see that participation of women happens in a larger way."

At the BJP headquarters, Nabin announced BJP's month-long Seva Sankalp Abhiyan to celebrate PM Narendra Modi's birthday on September 17 to mark his 25 years in public life, with a series of programmes focused on youth outreach and public participation. He said the PM's birthday will be observed as 'Seva Diwas' and blood donation camps will be organised across the country. Among the programmes scheduled will be

'Ashirwad Ke Diye' on September 17 evening, under which families of the government scheme beneficiaries will light lamps as a gesture of gratitude to the PM.

On October 7, when Modi completes 25 years in public office, a collective pledge for 'Viksit Bharat 2047' will be taken in district headquarters and around 1,000 locations across India. Same day, 'Seva Jyoti Kalash Yatra' programmes with 'padayatra', motorcycle and cycle rallies in all district headquarters, and under the 'Seva Mera Yogan' people will be encouraged to contribute at least 25 minutes of 'shramdaan' across 25 themes.

"Modi's journey began as an ordinary worker and today, as the country's pradhan sevak, he has advanced his endeavours. This has been possible only through his clear vision, unwavering determination and consistent efforts to bring qualitative changes in social life and to bring about transformations in life," the BJP chief said. Under 'Seva Ki Kahani', beneficiaries will be given a platform to share stories of how government schemes changed their lives, he said.

The BJP will also organise two youth-led 'Seva Yatras' between Modi's 'janambhoomi' Vadnagar and his 'karmabhoomi' Varanasi. Ten teams comprising around 1,000 youths will travel from Vadnagar to Varanasi and another 10 from Varanasi to Vadnagar. The 20-day yatra will pass through 10 states and include interactions with villagers, farmers, Anganwadi workers, youth clubs and students, Nabin said.



BRS working president K T Rama Rao addresses the media at Lok Bhavan in Hyderabad on Wednesday. PTI

Dalit 'purification' row deepens Telangana's Assembly battle; 21 BRS MLAs suspended

Nikhila Henry

Hyderabad, September 9

THE TELANGANA Assembly witnessed heated exchanges between the BRS and the Congress for the third consecutive day, leading to the suspension of 21 BRS MLAs — including the pink party's senior leaders K T Rama Rao and T Harish Rao — for the rest of the Monsoon session.

The stormy scenes followed an alleged "purification" ritual that Congress alleges was performed by BRS workers after a Dalit protest in Siddipet was held on September 8. Speaker Gadadam Prasad Kumar suspended the MLAs after Minister D Sridhar Babu moved a motion over disruptions in the Monsoon session for three straight days.

The other MLAs suspended are Anil Yadav, G Jagadish Reddy, Gangula Kamalakara, Kaushik Reddy, Madhavaram Krishna Rao, Kova Lakshmi, K Manik Rao, Chintia Prabhakar, K Prabhakar Reddy, M Rajashekhar Reddy, P Rajeswar Reddy, Sabita Indra Reddy, Kalvakuntla Sanjay, Talasani Srinivas Yadav, D Sudheer Reddy, V Sunitha Laxma Reddy, K Venkatesh, Vijayudu and KP Vivekananda.

The BRS has a total of 27 legislators in the Assembly.

The House commenced with BRS leaders demanding "justice" for Leader of Opposition K Chandrasekhar Rao, against whom Congress MLA Veerlapally Shankar had allegedly made disparaging remarks. The MLA had wished for "KCR's demise" in a public statement, the BRS leaders alleged, and de-

manded his suspension.

Meanwhile, the Treasury benches alleged that BRS workers conducted a "purification" ritual in Siddipet after Dalit Congress leaders staged a 'Dappu' (drum) protest there. Siddipet is where KCR's Erravalli farmhouse — a major political hub for the party — is located. Deputy Chief Minister Mallu Bhatti Vikramarka and Minister D Sridhar Babu called the alleged ritual an "insult [to] Dalit workers".

"On the first day of the Assembly, BRS MLC Tata Madhusudan [known popularly as Tata Madhu] insulted the Speaker, a Dalit. On the second day, BRS leaders held purification rituals in Siddipet. How long will you carry on with the anti-Dalit politics?" Vikramarka said, adding that the Congress stands for "self-respect of Dalits and other backward sections in the state".

The confrontation continued for over an hour, with both the Treasury and Opposition benches remaining firm on their demands. The suspended BRS leadership met Telangana Governor Shiv Pratap Shukla in the afternoon. In a press briefing after the meeting, KTR accused the Congress government of "trying to divert attention from real issues plaguing the state". "All the images released by the Congress today were AI-generated. We will lodge a police complaint regarding the same. If the police do not register the complaint, we will look at other avenues to lodge the complaint," said Rama Rao.

Rahul flags poor roads at Raebareli DISHA meet; UP minister hits back

Express News Service

Lucknow, September 9

LOK SABHA Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday raised concerns over the poor condition of roads in his parliamentary constituency Raebareli at a meeting of the District Development Coordination and Monitoring Committee (DISHA), displaying photos of pothole-ridden stretches and seeking details from officials on agencies responsible for construction and repair.

Gandhi, who is on a two-day visit to Raebareli, also sought an explanation for delays in repairing roads despite funds being sanctioned. The Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY) roads were among those discussed at the meeting, sources said. A nominated member of the DISHA committee Umesh Bahadur Singh alias Bablu Singh said Gandhi placed photos of damaged PMGSY roads before officials and also identified specific roads while seeking action. The PMGSY executive engineer assured the committee that the roads would be repaired, he said.

Gandhi also stressed that roads constructed by different agencies should be clearly identified and records main-



Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi during the DISHA meeting in Raebareli on Wednesday. ANI

tained showing which agency was responsible for which road.

The meeting was attended by UP Food and Civil Supplies Minister Manoj Kumar Pandey, Horticulture Minister Dinesh Pratap Singh, Congress Amethi MP Kishori Lal Sharma, SP MLAs Rahul Lodhi and Shyam Sundar Bhati, the district magistrate and senior officials from various departments. Issues including the Jal Jeevan Mission, healthcare, education, unemployment and implementation of central government schemes were also discussed, with officials being asked about the delivery of benefits to people.

Pandey later said the govern-

ment had undertaken construction and repair work of 16,000 small and major roads in Raebareli over the past five years. He claimed that 21.92 lakh people in the district were receiving ration under the government's food security programme.

Gandhi's visit also saw a protest by the two SP MLAs outside the collectorate ahead of the DISHA meeting. Lodhi alleged that despite claims of crores of rupees being allocated for development, funds had not translated into visible work on the ground. He alleged that a large number of schools had been closed in his Harachandpur constituency and that land was

being encroached upon without adequate action. The SP MLAs said they would raise these issues at the DISHA meeting and question the district panchayat leadership over its "inaction".

The meeting also saw a war of words between the BJP and Congress over the implementation of development and welfare schemes. UP minister Dinesh Pratap Singh criticised Gandhi's approach, alleging he appeared more interested in finding faults in government schemes than reviewing their implementation. Singh said that when the 'Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao' scheme came up for discussion, Gandhi asked an official what the scheme entailed and sought details of expenditure on publicity. He alleged Gandhi appeared to be attending the DISHA meeting more as the "Leader of Opposition than as Raebareli MP and chairperson of the committee".

Earlier on Wednesday, Gandhi met Congress functionaries, local residents and representatives of various organisations at the Bhuemau guest house. People from Raebareli, Amethi and Sultanpur districts also met him and raised issues concerning their areas, Congress leaders said.

WITH PTI INPUTS

CNR Rao's name in SIR 'discrepancy' list; officials say no notice issued

Express News Service

Bengaluru, September 9

BENGALURU URBAN District Election Officer Maheshwar Rao on Wednesday said that no notice was issued to Bharat Ratna laureate and eminent scientist Professor CNR Rao in connection with the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Malleshwaram Assembly constituency.

Maheshwar Rao's statement came amid a controversy over Prof Rao's name being included in a list of voters to whom notices would be served. The 92-year-old's name features in part 59 of the 'discrepancy elector' report of Malleshwaram Assembly constituency uploaded online by the Chief Electoral Officer, Karnataka. The reason cited is "self-name mismatch".

"...Rao was enrolled as a voter in Part No. 129, Serial No. 431 of the 76-Malleshwaram As-



Bharat Ratna Prof CNR Rao's name features in the report of the Malleshwaram Assembly constituency. The reason cited is 'self-name mismatch'

sembly Constituency in the electoral roll of 2002. At that time, his name was recorded as 'Rama'. At present, he is registered as a voter in Part No. 59, Serial No. 187 of the 157-Malleshwaram Assembly Constituency under the name 'Prof. C. N. Rao M'. Accordingly, his name has also been included in the draft electoral roll," the

statement by the DEO stated.

After noticing the discrepancy in the name, the booth level officer, "without issuing any notice, has recommended inclusion of his name in the final electoral roll, considering him to be a respected person," the statement said.

Prof Rao's office denied that a notice was issued to him. "We are not aware of any notice being served. We have not received an alert either on the registered mobile number or on his email," Rao's assistant Chandrashekar told *The Indian Express*. Prof Rao is among the 43 lakh voters to whom notices have been generated by the Karnataka chief electoral officer. Those who receive notices will have to submit documents to verify their identities before their name can be included in the final electoral roll scheduled to be published in the last week of October.

Uttarakhand voter-deletion puzzle: Why 4 plains districts account for 85% of Form-7s

Vidheesha Kuntamalla

Dehradun, September 9

OVER 85% of the Form-7 applications seeking deletion of names from Uttarakhand's electoral rolls have come from just four districts — Udham Singh Nagar, Haridwar, Dehradun and Nainital — putting the spotlight on why voter-deletion requests are so heavily concentrated in the state's plains.

The Indian Express reported on Tuesday that these four districts together account for more than 85% of the 1,30,382 Form-7 applications filed during the claims-and-objections period of the SIR. Udham Singh Nagar accounts for 43,878 applications, followed by Haridwar with 29,369, Dehradun with 19,402 and Nainital with 18,301. The concentration is striking not only because of its scale, but due to the sharp contrast with the state's hill districts. By comparison, Pauri Garhwal received 5,424, Pithoragarh 3,044, Almora 2,999, Chamoli 1,702, Champawat 1,723 and Tehri Garhwal 1,431. Uttarkashi received 2,109, while Bageshwar and Rudrapurag recorded just 618 and 382 respectively.

The BJP's explanation is that these are Uttarakhand's most populous and mobile parts, with substantial movement of people across the state's borders. Meanwhile, the Congress has pointed to the relatively large minority populations in these districts and questioned whether their demographic profile could be relevant to the pattern of deletions.

Khajan Dass, Uttarakhand's Minister for Minority Affairs



Udham Singh Nagar, Haridwar, Dehradun and Nainital account for over 85% of 1,30,382 Form-7 applications filed during SIR's claims-and-objections period

and BJP MLA from Dehradun, attributed the concentration principally to migration and the movement of people across Uttarakhand's borders. "These are the big cities of our state," Dass told *The Indian Express*, referring to Dehradun, Haridwar, Udham Singh Nagar and Nainital. "There has been a lot of movement of people here." Migration and Uttarakhand's border geography meant that people could move while retaining electoral records at their previous locations. "The biggest problem here is people coming and going," Dass said.

He rejected the suggestion that the concentration was connected to the state's minority population. "It is not that any minority is being targeted," he said.

The Congress, however, disagrees. Suryakant Dhasama, senior vice-president of Uttarakhand Pradesh Congress Committee, said the party was not opposed to the SIR, but questioned

Cong has history of insulting Dalits: BJP chief on Haldwani row

Express News Service
Dehradun, September 9

BJP'S NATIONAL president Nitin Nabin on Wednesday accused the Congress of having "history of insulting Dalits" and using the community as a "vote bank" over the alleged "purification" of a Haldwani rally venue after Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge addressed a gathering there last month.

Speaking at the BJP's extended state executive committee meeting in Haldwani, Nabin accused Congress of trying to turn the episode into a political issue and questioned its record on prominent erstwhile Dalit leaders including B R Ambedkar and Babu Jagjivan Ram.

His speech came a day after Uttarakhand Police registered an FIR against unidentified people over the alleged "purification" of Ramilla Maidan, where Kharge had addressed a Congress rally on August 8. The case was registered under provisions including BNS sections 196 and 299 and Section 3(1)(r) of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act. Police had received around 80 complaints and petitions.

An FIR had earlier been registered against Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi over his remarks on the alleged purification ceremony. Gandhi had described the episode as an example of untouchability and demanded action against those responsible.

"What has been their history? Their history has been of insulting Dalits," Nabin said, referring to the Congress. "When they worked to defeat Babasaheb Bhimrao Ambedkar in the election, Nehru ji had written a letter to Edwin Mountbatten, with great happiness, that we have succeeded in defeating Babasaheb Bhimrao Ambedkar and this is our great victory... the person who worked to write the Constitution, the child of a Dalit family who gave direction to the country, your leadership worked to insult him."

He went on to cite alleged attacks on Dalits in Rajasthan, Karnataka and Kerala, accusing Congress leaders of remaining silent because of electoral considerations.

the manner in which the deletion process was being carried out. "Our biggest objection is the intention of the Election Commission," Dhasama said, alleging the poll panel was acting in the interests of the BJP. "These four districts are happening in most of the seats where Muslims, minorities, poor people, SC, ST are there. They are targeting them because they are the vote base of the Congress Party."

An Election Commission official, however, cautioned against drawing conclusions about why Form-7 applications were concentrated in particular districts simply from the numbers. "This is the fact. The forms are received. There can't be an opinion about this," the official said, adding that the data reflected only the applications received during the claims-and-objections period. The numbers could vary significantly from one district to another depending on how actively individuals examined the electoral rolls.

The concentration of Form-7 applications has also translated into a substantial administrative burden. Of the 1,30,382 Form-7 applications received between July 14 and August 13, only 44,132 had been disposed of as of September 7, leaving 86,250 under process. Udham Singh Nagar has 34,903 applications under process, followed by Haridwar (17,554), Nainital (11,498) and Dehradun (11,262).

The Election Commission has now extended the claims-and-objections deadline from September 9 to September 28. The final electoral roll will be published on October 3.

Ceiling slab of a building collapses in Gandhinagar, many workers trapped

Express News Service
Ahmedabad, September 9

AT LEAST a dozen workers were feared trapped after the ceiling of an under-construction commercial building in Kudasana area of Gandhinagar, Gujarat's capital, collapsed around 9 pm on Wednesday.

The collapse was triggered allegedly due to a "crane hitting a portion of the ceiling" while work was underway at the site, sources said. At 11:50 pm Wednesday, MLA Alpesh Thakore told mediapersons that 13 had been rescued from the rubble. No casualties were reported till late evening on Wednesday.

Officials told *The Indian Express* that at least five of the injured persons were taken to the GMERS Civil Hospital, Gandhiangar. Officials at the GVK-EMRI 108 emergency ambulance service said six of their vehicles were involved in transporting the injured persons.

At least four rescue vehicles of the Gandhinagar Fire and Emergency Services (GFES) and the district police were making efforts to bring the situation under control as of late evening on Wednesday.

Deputy Chief Minister Harsh Sanghavi, who is in Gandhinagar to attend the monsoon session of the Assembly, reached the spot while Health Minister Praful Pansheriya reached the civil hospital.

Dubai outreach puts MP on global investment map, gets proposals worth Rs 53,000 cr

Express News Service
Bhopal, September 9

MADHYA PRADESH Chief Minister Mohan Yadav's three-day investment outreach in Dubai has yielded investment proposals worth more than Rs 53,000 crore, with the state pitching itself as a manufacturing and investment hub linking global capital with technology, supply chains and markets.

During his September 6-8 visit, Yadav held meetings with senior UAE officials and global companies to discuss projects in logistics, food processing, education, artificial intelligence, green energy, e-mobility and waste-to-energy.

DP World explored developing Pawarkhedha as a multimodal logistics hub that could connect farmers, farmer-producer organisations (FPOs), micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) and industries with national and global markets. Sharaf Group is considering a Rs 30-50 million rail-siding-based logistics park, which could create an estimated 300-600 jobs.

The UAE also indicated plans to send a high-level delegation to Madhya Pradesh to explore investments in tourism and hospitality. Discussions were also held on expanding air connectivity between the state and the UAE.

Technology partnerships were another key focus of the visit. The World Bank explored cooperation in artificial intelligence and digital governance, while BEEAH discussed waste management, waste-to-energy and circular-economy solutions, including the possible scaling up of Indore's solid-waste and Bio-CNG model.

'India now has acceptance with Global North and Global South'

AT THE 18th BRICS Leaders' Summit in New Delhi this weekend, member state South Africa will prevail on countries to find solutions to world conflicts, whilst also expecting some solid positions to be taken on present challenges around food and energy security

South Africa High Commissioner to India **Anil Sookal**, in an interview with **Divya A.** touched upon the significance of BRICS, the paralysis of global governance structures like the UN, the imperativeness of the Global South to have a voice, India's standing in the world, and what the India-China thaw means for the region and beyond. Excerpts:

What do you think of the significance of BRICS as a grouping at this point in a conflict-ridden world?

At a time when the world needs leadership, BRICS can provide it. We are increasingly seeing the world dividing into camps, with individual countries imposing their will on smaller countries. Despite the Global South accounting for 85 per cent of the global community, we don't have a say on some of the most critical issues impacting us. It is important for countries of the Global South, especially under BRICS, to reflect on some of these issues and send out a very powerful yet positive message that the world wants peace, and an equitable and inclusive global community.

What would be the most

critical issues that the Global South should have a voice on in the present context?

We must have an inclusive global governance architecture. The UN was created as a forum where all countries, big or small, powerful or less powerful, could have an equal voice. Unfortunately, the UN of that vision has been eroded. We'd like to see a reformed UN, and BRICS has been constant about this.

Are the BRICS leaders going to talk about these issues and send a message out?

One of the constants of BRICS has been the call for reform. Many want to actually make these organisations obsolete and irrelevant. But if you take away these global governance structures, what do we have? A world of disorder and chaos. It suits some to have chaos. But for the global majority, we need a world underpinned by structures that have been playing a positive role throughout the years.

In this context, what would be South Africa's expectations from India's presidency?

India has shown continuity, and the theme they have chosen — 'Building resilience, inclusiveness, building for sustainability' — are all core principles of the BRICS. We'd like to see this consolidated. We'd like to see some solid positions being taken on how we can ad-



dress the challenges around food and energy security, and in terms of prevailing on the countries to enter into dialogue and to find solutions to the conflict.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi recently spoke to President Putin about finding an end to this war, because it impacts all of us.

During India's G20 presidency, the African Union became a member of the G20. Does India, as a credible voice, amplify the concerns of the Global South to a larger world?

India has a trust factor on its side. Someone asked me if it was right for PM Modi to speak to President Putin and just tell him, 'Look, you should find a way to end this war'. I said it's the right thing to do. And that's the level of trust that PM Modi enjoys with President Putin, that he can tell him that in a very frank manner. And President Putin appreciates it because he knows it's out of genuine con-

cern, and not just for some dynamics or agenda. India now has acceptance with the Global North and the Global South.

After India, the BRICS presidency moves to China. What is your expectation of these two Asian powers, of balancing the Western world and amplifying the concerns of the region?

President Xi attending the Summit here is a positive statement to the world community. If you look at any projections of the world at the turn of the century, the two most powerful economies will be India and China. For the major part until the Industrial Revolution, India and China were the two dominant global economies. And history moves in cycles. The world is going back to that period.

How do you see the India-China thaw helps the region and the world in general?

It's good for the region, and sends out a very powerful message to the global community. Especially some in the Global North who wouldn't like to see a peaceful coexistence and cooperation between India and China.

I am positive that as India and China continue to grow, there will be, from time to time, disturbances and discomfort. When you have a dragon and an elephant living on the same mountain, you are going to

have some rumbling. But eventually, as they did for the past two millennia, they will find a way to coexist and enrich each other.

How do you think America's tariff wars are playing out for the region?

The trade in local currencies is moving at a fast pace. In a sense, (US action) has caused pain, but pain is short-lived. Out of that pain comes strength. And you're seeing the strength of BRICS countries reasserting their independence and resilience.

BRICS doesn't have as its aim de-dollarisation. The world is changing. The dollar at one stage occupied about 80 per cent of the IMF basket of currencies. In the latest reading, it's 57 per cent. And that's not because of BRICS. It's a natural process. As the global South rises, other currencies come to the fore.

President Cyril Ramaphosa will be here for the summit and meet PM Modi. What are the key points of discussion that the two leaders are going to have?

This relationship must be constantly deepened and strengthened. There shouldn't be complacency because we know each other so well that we start taking each other for granted. President Ramaphosa being here gives us an opportunity to do that and to strengthen a very dynamic relationship.

• BRIEFLY



Confetti goes off during the launching ceremony of Ocean Research Vessel (Yard 3041), officially named *ORV Sagar Manthan*, at the Rishi Bankim Shipyard in Kolkata on Wednesday. PTI

WEST BENGAL

Navy's ocean research vessel *Sagar Manthan* launched at Kolkata port

KOLKATA-BASED Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE) Ltd on Wednesday launched 'Sagar Manthan', an indigenous ocean research vessel (ORV) being built for the National Centre for Polar and Ocean Research (NCPOR), Union Ministry of Earth Sciences. In a major boost to India's capabilities in deep-sea exploration and scientific research, the Rs 840-crore research vessel is expected to be ready for use by early 2028. 'Sagar Manthan' is a 89.5-m long and 18.8-m wide ORV with a gross tonnage of 5,900 tonnes, and speed of up to 14 knots at 90% maximum continuous rating (MCR). The vessel was launched at the GRSE's Rishi Bankim Shipyard in Kolkata by Kavita Ellanti, wife of Dr Srinivas Kumar Tummala, Secretary, Ministry of Earth Sciences. ENS

Medical student dies after falling from 10th floor

A 21-YEAR-OLD second year MBBS student from a prominent college in Pune died after fall from the 10th floor of a residential building. Police, suspecting suicide, have launched a probe into the sequence of events leading to death. The incident took place around 12 noon at Nancy Lake Homes society in Pune's Katraj. Police have identified the deceased as Adimaya Shekhar Reddy (21), who hailed from Hyderabad. Police have registered an Accidental Death Report (ADR) which is preliminary case registration for any 'unnatural death' including suicide. ENS

2-year-old boy mauled by stray dog in Punjab

A STRAY dog attack on a two-year-old boy has sparked widespread public outrage, with residents demanding immediate action against the growing menace of stray dogs in residential areas in Ferozpur district. Locals met Deputy Commissioner Deepshikha Sharma at her office on Wednesday and demanded the administration launch immediate and sustained efforts to control the stray-dog population, particularly in areas frequented by children and elderly residents. The incident took place Monday when Raghav was attacked while playing outside his house. PTI

Possessing books is no crime: HC quashes detention of J&K scholar under PSA

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, September 9

MERE POSSESSION of books with dispiriting titles doesn't make a person a criminal, the Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh High Court said, as it quashed the Public Safety Act charges against a north Kashmir scholar. The observation came a year after the J&K administration banned 25 books.

Shafat Maqbool Wani, a scholar from Kupwara, was detained under the PSA last year. The detention order cited his father's former militant links, his invitations to international academic conferences, books found in his possession and an Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967, case in which he was granted bail. "It also needs to be emphasised here that the respondents have not shown any subversive activity against the name of petitioner, which compelled them to take recourse to preventive detention," Justice Moksha Khajuria Kazmi said in her order last week.

The petitioners, the order said, have challenged the detention on the ground that, barring the UAPA case, the detaining authority had failed to mention any specific activity that was prejudicial to the state. "Although the respondents have reflected in the counter affidavit as also in the grounds of detention that the detainee had been granted bail, therefore, they have not been oblivious to this fact. However, at the same time, it can very safely be said that the

detaining authority does not appear to have made any effort to derive satisfaction as regards the prejudicial activity of the petitioner/ detainee warranting his preventive detention," it reads.

In its reasons for the preventive detention, the J&K police had cited the "separatist" ideology of Wani's father and his invitations to international academic conferences. "(He) has been brought up in a family having separatist ideology and as such, the anti-India and separatist feelings have got inculcated in the detainee since childhood. His father was an ex-militant affiliated with terrorist organisation Al-Barq, who had surrendered in the year 1990," the police said. "The alleged anti-national literature shown to have been seized from the detainee has also presumably weighed with the respondents to brand the detainee as an anti-national. However, the said literature has wrongly been attributed to the detainee as having been authored by him," the court said. "...a mere possession of books with dispiriting titles does not ipso facto make the petitioner/ detainee a criminal against whom preventive detention was required to be invoked."

In August 2025, the J&K banned 25 books as "promoting secessionist sentiment and false narratives". This year, all the government and private schools, colleges, universities, coaching centres and public libraries have been asked to screen the books and journals for "inappropriate or objectionable content".

EXPRESS special

Assam family gets HC relief, now waits for answer: How to find a 43-yr-old pushed into Bangladesh?

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, September 9

"WE DON'T know a single person in Bangladesh. Who would we even ask?" says Majidul Islam. Over three months ago, his mother Mumtaz Begum was deported to Bangladesh.

On September 3, the Gauhati High Court directed the Ministry of External Affairs to make efforts to trace and repatriate the 43-year-old, observing that "the State machinery, acting in tandem, had prevented the detainee to exhaust her right to move this Court" against a Foreigners' Tribunal opinion that declared her a foreigner.

The HC ordered an inquiry into circumstances surrounding the tribunal's opinion that led to her deportation, and laid down interim safeguards governing the arrest and transfer of persons declared foreigners in Assam. It also issued a rare direction to the Assam government to pay Rs 2 lakh in interim compensation to her husband Mujammel Hoque, and ordered efforts to facilitate her return.

However, Mumtaz's family is not sure where those efforts will begin. They don't know where she is in Bangladesh, and neither by all accounts do the authorities, with the court directing the MEA to make efforts to trace Mumtaz and facilitate her return to India. "We fear for her safety, and we feel horrible not being able to help her," says Majidul, 26, the eldest of five siblings; and a vendor in Juria in Nagaon.

Recalling the last time he saw

HC pulls up state govt after kin made to run around for answers, finds out about deportation after her expulsion at night



The Matia detention camp in Assam's Goalpara, where Mujammel Hoque saw his wife Mumtaz Begum last in June. EXPRESS

his mother free, when he accompanied her to the Nagaon Foreigners' Tribunal, Majidul says they expected it to be another routine appearance. "We would go to the office of the Superintendent of Police (Border) every month... because my mother needed to present herself there."

Mumtaz's citizenship battle began in 1998, when a police reference was made against her. Mumtaz produced her grandfather's name in the voter lists of 1965 and 1970, her father's name in the 1977 list, a school transfer certificate, and panchayat certificates establishing her lineage.

However, in June 2019, overruling all that, the tribunal declared her a foreigner. As per the petition filed by husband Hoque in the HC, when he tried to meet the tribunal member later that day, he

tribunal's opinion, saying it had failed to consider evidence on record. Sending the matter back for fresh consideration, the HC directed Mumtaz to appear before the tribunal again.

On May 30, Majidul accompanied Mumtaz to the tribunal, carrying a copy of the HC order. "After the tribunal looked at our petition, our lawyer told us that my mother would be arrested. We were shocked.... The High Court had only said there should be an inquiry." Less than an hour later, Mumtaz was taken into custody from the tribunal. And by the end of the day, the tribunal had issued a fresh opinion declaring her a foreigner.

As per the petition filed by husband Hoque in the HC, when he tried to meet the tribunal member later that day, he

was told that the tribunal's earlier opinion — the one the HC had junked — would hold for now, and a fresh order would come "later". Advocate FU Barbhuiya, representing the family, told *The Indian Express* that while Hoque applied on June 2 for a certified copy of the tribunal's fresh opinion, it was made available only three days later.

The paper chase

What is now known is that after Mumtaz was taken to the office of the SP (Border) in Nagaon on May 30, her biometric details were recorded and uploaded onto the Foreigners Identification Portal. She was kept at the Nagaon Sadar police station, and on June 1, shifted to the Matia detention camp in Goalpara — with a directive by the Nagaon District Commissioner that she be expelled within 24 hours. Majidul says his father met Mumtaz twice at the camp. "But when he returned after June 5, the people there told him she was not there," he says. "When we tried in Nagaon, they said she was not in the jail or the police station there either."

Hoque did the rounds of the Juria and Nagaon police stations, and the SP (Border) office, the family says, and later kept trying to look for her in Assam. It was only after the family moved the HC that the trail started surfacing in court records. One affidavit came from police, another from the district administration and then from the BSF.

These showed that on June 3, Mumtaz was moved from Matia

"Learned AGA fairly submits on the basis of the instructions as aforesaid that no order had been issued by any public servant per which there is a restriction with regard to the entry in the school premises. Consequently, it is apparent that the authorities have patently erred in law in straightaway lodging the impugned First Information Report under Section 223 of the BNS, 2023," the court observed.

The high court said the journalist had prima facie exposed shortcomings in an educational institution run by the State government. Referring to the Right of Children to Free

and Compulsory Education Act, 2009, the court noted that schools are required to meet prescribed norms, including safe and adequate drinking water facilities and separate toilets for boys and girls.

Holding that a prima facie case for interference had been made out, the HC stayed the FIR and directed that no action be taken against the journalist in connection with the case until further orders.

The court also directed the Additional Chief Secretary, Basic Education, UP, to file a personal affidavit within four weeks detailing the present condition of the school.

Ashish Shaji
NNew Delhi, September 9

OBSERVING that the state action appeared to be an "ego issue" and a retaliatory action amounting to "killing the messenger", the Allahabad High Court has stayed an FIR against a journalist for reporting the alleged poor infrastructure and unhygienic conditions at a government school in Lucknow.

A bench of Justices Abdul Moin and Pramod Kumar Srivastava said that since the government had a statutory duty under the Right to Education Act, 2009, to ensure that schools met the prescribed

standards, it should have examined the shortcomings highlighted by the journalist and taken steps to rectify them instead of treating the matter as an "ego issue" and lodging an FIR against him.

"When the controversy in the instant case is seen viz-a-viz the act done by the petitioner of reporting about the shortcomings of the school it is prima facie apparent that the First Information Report is retaliatory action to the shortcomings being exposed by the petitioner, a journalist and thus tantamounts to 'killing the messenger' which clearly is not countenanced in the eyes of

law," the order passed on September 8 stated.

The court was hearing a plea filed by the journalist Amit Yadav challenging an FIR registered on August 24 at Gosai-ganj police station in Lucknow under different sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

According to the petition, Yadav visited Purva Madhyamik Vidyalaya in Begriya Mau, Gosai-ganj, on August 20. He alleged that the school was in a poor condition, with shabby toilets, no drinking water and other deficiencies. He had also interviewed certain teachers.

An FIR was subsequently registered against him, alleging

that the school was in an excellent condition and that its toilets were clean. It accused the journalist of entering the premises without permission, disrupting the studies of children and compelling two women teachers to speak about the condition of the school. The FIR also alleged that the reporting had been motivated by political prejudice.

The bench said that coloured photographs placed on record prima facie showed the "abysmal condition" of the school's toilets and premises. It held that the authorities should have considered the statutory exception before registering the FIR.

EC invites TMC groups led by Ritabrata and Mamata for meeting in New Delhi on Saturday

Damini Nath
New Delhi, September 9

THE ELECTION Commission on Wednesday invited Trinamool Congress chairperson and former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee and TMC rebel leader Ritabrata Banerjee for separate meetings on Saturday regarding their dispute over control of the party.

In letters issued to the two leaders on Wednesday evening, the EC asked both of them to attend the meetings at the India International Institute of Democracy and Election Management (IIDEM) in Dwarka on Saturday, along with a delegation of five members each.

The EC asked Ritabrata to meet it at 11am, while Mamata was given the time of 12pm. EC sources say the letters were issued after the matter was discussed by the Commission at a meeting on Wednesday.

The EC's decision to meet both sides comes two days after it announced by-polls in five Assembly constituencies in the country, including Nandigram and Rejinagar in West Bengal. The split in the TMC is likely to come up when the party fields

candidates for the October 6 by-polls, leading to dispute over which side would get the use of the party's symbol.

It is learnt that the Commission is yet to register a dispute case under the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968, which is the only way for it to decide which side gets control of the party's name and symbol.

The split in the party began to emerge after the TMC lost the West Bengal Assembly elections in May this year.

The group of MLAs led by Leader of Opposition in the West Bengal Assembly Ritabrata Banerjee claimed they were the "real TMC" as they had support of two-thirds of the legislators.

The Ritabrata faction had met the Commission in Delhi on July 1 to stake claim to the party. The EC then asked both sides to submit responses. In her response, Mamata rejected the other side's claim over the party, arguing that the appointments to the party organisation made by them in June were not valid as the terms of the existing committees of the TMC was until 2027.

One Health Mission work is in progress: ICMR DG's letter to MP

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 9

SEVERAL ACTIVITIES such as syndromic surveillance, integrated animal-human-wildlife surveillance, and waste-water surveillance are being undertaken through the National One Health Mission, said Dr Rajiv Bahl, ICMR DG, in a letter to Rajya Sabha member Ajeet Gopchade.

The DG also said that waste-water surveillance of 13 priority pathogens across 47 cities will be expanded to 75 cities in 2027.

This comes after the

member called for a time-bound national biosecurity and biodefence strategy to tackle bioterrorism, bio-warfare, and laboratory-based biological accidents, and emerging infectious disease.

The Ministry of Home Affairs has extensively worked with stakeholders on a draft National Biosecurity Policy, the MP also said.

Five genomic and metagenomic hubs have been established to strengthen capacity for detecting novel or unknown pathogens, the DG said in his letter.



JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Mohd Najbool S/O Shamas Din R/O Karmana Bihar A/P Channi Himmat, Jammu is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 63/2005 U/S 302/109 RPC of P/S Channi Himmat, Jammu. Despite repeated raids / efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	: Mohd Najbool
S/O	: Shamas Din
Address	: Karmana Bihar
A/P	: Channi Himmat, Jammu

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu	: 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail LD	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu	: 0191-2605949
4. SP City South	: 0191-2430002
5. SDPO City East	: 01912433778
6. P/S Channi Himmat	: 0191-2465164

No. **Date:-** **.08.2026** **Sr. Superintendent of**
DIP/J-9892/26- DATE 09 SEP 2026 **Police Jammu**



JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Sourab Malik S/O Raj Kumar R/O Dhabka, Meerut, Uttar Pradesh is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 62/2009 U/S 454/380/411 RPC of P/S Channi Himmat, Jammu. Despite repeated raids / efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	: Sourab Malik
S/O	: Raj Kumar
Address	: Dhabka, Meerut, Uttar Pradesh

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu	: 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail LD	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu	: 0191-2605949
4. SP City South	: 0191-2430002
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6. P/S Channi Himmat	: 0191-2465164

NO. **DATE:-** **.08.2026** **Sr. Superintendent of**
DIP/J-9891/26 - DATE 09 SEP 2026 **Police Jammu**

Ladakh: Govt offers new chapter under Art 371, key powers not final

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, September 9

THE CENTRE has offered the addition of a constitutional provision of 'Article 371(K)' in a bid to extend additional protections to Ladakh at a meeting between the Ladakh Sub-Committee and the Ministry of Home Affairs in the national capital on Wednesday, *The Indian Express* has learnt. While this marks a significant development, representatives have said there is no draft of this yet, and discussions will continue.

The meeting, which came months after the last talks, saw the sub-committee comprising members of the Leh Apex Body (LAB) and Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) — including activist Sonam Wangchuk — meet with officials of the MHA in continuation of the "in-principle understanding" arrived at in meetings held on May 22 and July 3. Those two breakthrough meetings saw discussions on restoring democracy in Ladakh, and providing constitutional

safeguards by way of special provision under Article 371.

But talks have remained suspended since then as the representatives from Ladakh pushed for greater democratic control and quashing of cases against those arrested in the aftermath of the violence of September 24 last year.

According to those who attended the Wednesday meeting, the MHA stated that the intended UT-level governance body — a demand made by the two groups — would be elected by direct election and would have legislative powers with respect to land, culture and language, forest, environment, natural resources and any other subjects reserved for the UT under Article 240 of the Constitution of India. Article 240 gives the President of India the power to make laws and regulations for the peace, progress, and good government of specific union territories.

Ladakh has also sought executive, budgetary, planning and financial powers for the



Sonam Wangchuk

proposed elected body. However, LAB and KDA representatives who attended the meeting pointed out a lack of clarity on "all areas, including law and order as seen in UT of Puducherry, which is necessary for proper governance".

Speaking after the meeting, Wangchuk said that the (proposed) assembly "should have supremacy over bureaucracy, and we have also asked for control over police and law and order".

"About this, they have only said that they will discuss this in October," he said, adding, "It cannot be said that the meeting

was successful or unsuccessful either".

Ladakh has also raised concerns regarding structural changes to the governance infrastructure in the UT. Wangchuk added that "if these changes continue, we will be forced to sit on agitation again."

This is a departure from the discussions until now, which have mentioned a "sui generis, tailor-made constitutional safeguards and elected UT-level legislature" for Ladakh.

But while members of the sub-committee told *The Indian Express* that the MHA has proposed provisions under a new provision, Article 371(K), KDA co-chairman Sajjad Kargili said that the discussion took place "without a draft and until a draft detailing what these provisions will entail is produced, it does not inspire confidence among the members of the sub-committee and the people of Ladakh".

The MHA is also learnt to have promised a compensation package for those who lost their

lives and were injured in the September 2025 agitation. LAB and KDA sought that all cases connected to the protest be withdrawn at once, and not in phases. MHA said it was being looked into, officials said.

The MHA is also learnt to have assured the groups that further talks will be held in the first week of October, during which a draft Article would be discussed. The MHA is expected to seek further comments on some broader issues from LAB and KDA shortly, some representatives told *The Indian Express*.

The LAB and KDA stated that no major irreversible restructuring should be done in governance mechanisms, land transfers, etc. before an elected body at the Union Territory-level is in place. LAB and KDA have unanimously declared that, in the event of any irreversible changes to Ladakh's administrative and political setup before the UT-level democratic body is constituted, they would be compelled to call a protest.

After 37 years, Karnataka allows student union elections

Express News Service
Bengaluru, September 9

THE KARNATAKA Cabinet on Wednesday cleared recommendations of a sub-committee to lift a 37-year-old ban on college elections, allowing it to be held without political affiliations.

Speaking to reporters, Deputy Chief Minister G Parameshwara said each student union will have one president, two vice-presidents, one general secretary, two joint secretaries and a six-member executive committee. The union will reserve positions for women: one vice-president, one joint secretary, and two positions in the executive committee.

However, the government decided not to provide caste-based reservation. The minister said that the college management must conduct student body elections if the students favour them. The elections can be cancelled if students prefer not to hold polls.

Those contesting the student union polls cannot campaign under the banner of any student organisations affiliated with political parties. "Candidates who are members of student organisations can contest as long as they do not do it under the banners of student political groups," he said.

The proposal to revive student body elections was floated in the Budget speech earlier this year. A Cabinet sub-committee was formed to deliberate on the issue, which recently decided to allow campus elections in all degree and PU colleges in the first phase.

The government had banned student body polls in 1989 in response to a series of violent incidents and clashes on campuses.

Bihar govt turns to Urdu lessons to give its second official language a boost

Santosh Singh
Patna, September 9

THE BIHAR government is rolling out a 70-day Urdu course in a fresh bid to promote the state's second official language — Urdu.

The online certification course, which will begin on October 13, is meant for state government employees, a letter by S M Parvez Alam, the additional secretary-cum-director of the Cabinet Secretariat Department, said to all additional chief secretaries, principal secretaries, secretaries, district magistrates, and other department heads on September 8.

The 2-hour course will be held from 1 pm to 3 pm, Monday to Thursday, for 70 days, excluding public holidays, the letter said.

An exam will be held at the end of it, and successful candidates will be awarded an Urdu Learning Certificate.

The move is in line with the state's aim of expanding free Urdu-speaking and writing courses across Patna and various district centres, and it comes just months after the Bihar government announced Urdu translators.

"It [the letter] is to say that

for teaching non-Urdu speaking officers and employees working in all departments and all regional offices of the State Government to read and write Urdu (Second Official Language of the State) online, 'Urdu Training / Learning Centre' is run under Urdu Directorate, Cabinet Secretariat Department," the letter further read.

"There will be more online and offline Urdu learning courses," Minority Welfare Minister Zama Khan told *The Indian Express*.

"Right from Urdu learning courses to fresh appointments of Urdu translators, the state government is committed to providing a level playing field to all communities."

A senior government official said that while the Directorate of Urdu has had Urdu training programmes from time to time, this is the first time online training is being offered to a larger number of government employees.

The directorate had run a 60-day residential training course in 2018-19. Urdu was declared Bihar's second official language in 1981 — the first state in the country to do so. Since then, all notifications are in Hindi and Urdu.

Bengal Chief Minister: Will uproot those who chant 'Free Kashmir', 'Lal Salam' from Jadavpur varsity

ENS & PTI
Kolkata, September 9

LEADING THE Gerua Samman Yatra (Saffron Honour March) to the gates of Jadavpur University in Kolkata, where the Left and Right wing students' groups have been fighting for the ideological control of the campus, West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Wednesday said that he has taken a vow to "uproot" the forces that chant slogans of "Free Kashmir" and "Lal Salam to Maoist Kishenji".



West Bengal CM Suwendu Adhikari leads the Gerua Samman March to the gates of Jadavpur University in Kolkata on Wednesday. EXPRESS

Addressing a gathering outside the campus after leading the 3-km march from Golpark carrying a saffron flag and joined by a large number of monks and BJP workers chanting 'Jai Shri Ram', Adhikari described the university as "a centre of excellence" and land of Sri Aurobindo.

"The West Bengal chief minister knows how to wipe out 'Kashmir Mange Azadi' and 'Lal Salaam to Kishenji' from Jadavpur," he said.

Kishenji, a top Maoist, was killed in a police encounter in Paschim Medinipur in 2011.

"I have taken a vow that from Jadavpur, the land of Sri Aurobindo and a centre of excellence, I will uproot those who raise 'Kashmir Mange Azadi' (Kashmir wants freedom) slogans and those who have supported them," added Adhikari, who was dressed in saffron.

Asserting that he would not tolerate any insult to the "saffron" colour, which is associated with Hindus, Adhikari announced that he would visit the area again.

"To teach a lesson to those who are insulting the country, I will come here once to recite the Gita and again to recite the Hanuman Chalisa," the West

Bengal Chief Minister said.

Suwendu also announced a three-day Vedic recital programme at Jadavpur University, appealing to people to participate in it.

"This is the land of Swami Vivekananda, and saffron will remain here," he said. "You will clean them out, won't you? Is everyone prepared?" he told the gathering.

The mobilisation comes amid a political and ideological battle at Jadavpur University, one of the country's top varsities, where clashes and slogan wars between Left-wing students' groups and the RSS-affiliated ABVP have intensified in recent days.

The march was held less than a fortnight after Adhikari attended a programme outside the Jadavpur University campus, where around 10,000 people sang the full version of the national anthem, 'Vande Mataram'.

Participating in that event, the West Bengal Chief Minister had targeted both the CPI(M)-led Left Front and the TMC, accusing them of allowing "nationalism to fade from public consciousness".

Special session today to pass Bill for inter-varsity transfer of staff

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, September 9

THE BJP government in West Bengal will introduce an amendment Bill in the Assembly during a one-day special session on Thursday, empowering it to transfer teaching and non-teaching staff from one state university to another — a move opposed by the various teachers' associations and academics.

The state Cabinet had on Monday cleared the proposal to introduce the amendment Bill in the Assembly. Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari, who had earlier described the Bill as important and necessary, on Wednesday said that its passage will be "historic".

The BJP government's move comes amid tensions at Jadavpur varsity.

One dead as water tank tower collapses in Ranchi

Press Trust of India
Ranchi, September 9

A WORKER died, and another was feared trapped under the debris after an old water tank tower collapsed during its demolition here on Wednesday evening, officials said.

The incident took place around 6 pm, in the Zila School premises within the Kotwali

police station limits, while workers were demolishing the tank to pave the way for construction of a new water tower there, they said.

"A worker has died in this incident, and another is feared trapped under the debris. Work to remove debris is underway. Two JCB machines have been deployed to remove the debris," Kotwali ASP Nikhil Rai said.

100 tech labs, 'JOB engine' to train Chhattisgarh youth for new-age roles

Jayprakash S Naidu
Raipur, September 9



Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai

IN A bid to provide youth with hands-on exposure to new, cutting-edge and emerging technologies, including Artificial Intelligence, the Chhattisgarh government will establish 100 Emerging Technology Labs and a JOB Engine under the 'Chief Minister Startup and New-Age Industry Preparedness through Up-skilling of New Generation Youth (NIPUN) Mission'.

At a recent Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai, the government approved the Rs 500-crore 'Chief Minister Startup and NIPUN Mission' for the next five years, along with the 'Chhattisgarh Export Promotion Policy 2026-30'.

Both initiatives are aimed at benefiting the state's youth and business community.

Entrepreneurship Development Centres will be established in all 33 districts, along

and enterprise technology. "Considering Chhattisgarh's local needs and economic activities, the initiative can also open new opportunities for startups working in health-tech, agri-tech, green technology, mining-tech and technology-based solutions to local challenges," the government official added.

According to a senior official of the Industries Department, the NIPUN JOB Engine will be an important component of the mission. It will establish a direct linkage between the actual requirements of industries and the skills of young people, he added.

The key feature of the NIPUN Mission is its integrated approach, bringing together startups, skill development, emerging technologies and employment within a single ecosystem. It will provide young people opportunities to develop business ideas, acquire relevant skills, and gain hands-on experience.

3 Afghans in Jharkhand's draft electoral roll, probe on

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, September 9

THREE PEOPLE identified as Afghan nationals were allegedly found in the draft electoral roll in Jamshedpur during the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, prompting the Election Commission to conduct a district-level probe.

According to officials, the three cases were detected during the process of verification of documents submitted for inclusion of names in the electoral roll in Jamshedpur East.

Arnav Mishra, SDO and Electoral Registration Officer (ERO), Jamshedpur East, said all three had submitted passports as their supporting documents during the SIR process.

"Passports are among the 11 documents valid for the SIR. They submitted their passports as their primary documents. When the passports were sent to the passport office for verification, it was found that they were not valid and that the persons were Afghan nationals," Mishra said.

He said that of the three cases, the passport office had already rejected one passport-related verification, while the other two will be rejected soon.

The three cases are from Jamshedpur East. The officer said the matter had been brought to the notice of the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) and that a detailed investigation was underway at the district level.

Asked whether an FIR had been registered, Mishra said the authorities were currently investigating the cases and that further action would depend on the findings.

"If it is found that there has been wrongdoing, action will definitely be taken against whoever is responsible," he said.

Mishra also referred to provisions under the Representation of the People Act, saying that knowingly submitting false or fake documents during an electoral process constitutes an offence and that action would be taken according to law if the investigation establishes such wrongdoing.

"All the concerned authorities are aware of the matter and a detailed investigation is going on. Once the investigation is completed, action will be taken accordingly," Mishra said.

Youth held with fake PMO ID says he wanted to impress kin

Mohamed Thaver
Mumbai, September 9

THE 24-YEAR-OLD man arrested for allegedly using a fake Prime Minister’s Office identity card in Mumbai has told police that he created the impression that he worked for the PMO to impress his family and portray himself as someone associated with a “worthy cause”, even as investigators probe whether there was more to his actions.

Sources said police suspect the man used artificial intelligence to create the PMO identity card and are investigating the claim. Rohan Parikh allegedly told police during questioning that he had convinced his family that he was working with the PMO and wanted to present himself as someone involved in “nation building”, sources said. Police, however, are allegedly not convinced by the explanation and are examining other possible motives and are looking for the third suspect.

Investigators are also probing Parikh’s claim that he received an email in 2024 saying he had been selected to work with the PMO. “We are checking if any mails have been deleted but...we have not found any such email,” a police officer said.

Parikh was arrested along with his security guard Dilip Kunde, 49, a retired Army personnel from rural Nashik, at Jio World Plaza in BKC on Monday, a day before Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s programme at the adjacent Nita Mukesh Ambani Cultural Centre. Police said Parikh, Kunde and their office employee Prathamesh Bagul, who is a wanted accused, entered the mall after Parikh allegedly showed security personnel a digital PMO identity card.

Parikh’s lawyers told the court on Tuesday, he was himself a victim of fraud and he believed he was associated with the PMO.

MUMBAI-GOA HIGHWAY

‘Won’t go for the inauguration’: Gadkari upset over delays

Express News Service
Panaji, September 9

UNION ROAD Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari on Wednesday said he felt “ashamed” over the prolonged delay in completing the Mumbai-Goa highway and vowed action against errant contractors and officials.

Speaking at the inauguration of the six-lane elevated corridor in North Goa’s Porvorim, Gadkari said the contractors had failed and indicated that his ministry could set a new “record” for blacklisting and debarring contractors.

“The Mumbai-Goa Highway has been quite delayed, and the contractors have failed. What has happened is very unfortunate. My department has set over seven world records for various works, but now I wish my department will have the record for blacklisting and debarring the single largest number of contractors and suspensions of officials within a single year,” he said.

Gadkari said “I have decided I will not go for the inauguration of the Mumbai-Goa highway because I’m ashamed at the delays,” he said. “Yesterday I had a meeting and was informed the highway is 93-94 percent complete. In October, I shall disembark at the Mumbai airport and come to Goa by car...to see the status of its completion.”



The mortal remains of Manipuri musician Chongtham Vikram Singh being taken for last rites in Imphal on Wednesday. PTI

Last rites held, Manipur bids emotional farewell to musician killed in Delhi

Jimmy Leivon
Imphal, September 9

THE LAST rites of renowned musician Chongtham Vikram Singh, who was recently killed in an assault in New Delhi, was performed at his hometown in Manipur on Wednesday.

His mortal remains were brought to Imphal via air in the afternoon, and a significant number of people had gathered at the airport to bid a final adieu to the late musician.

Later, the remains were

taken to his Thangmeiband residence in Imphal West, where artists, musicians and members of the Manipur film fraternity joined relatives and friends in their grief, offering floral tributes.

The last rites were performed at Khoyathong in Imphal East, bringing an emotional farewell to the musician whose death has triggered widespread concern in Manipur.

Singh’s family said it would respect the ongoing investigation and did not want the matter

to be politicised. Chongtham Vivek, his younger brother, said the family was awaiting the outcome of the investigation.

“Let this be the last such incident. We will respect the due course of the investigation. However, we seek justice. Moreover, we do not want to politicise the matter,” he said.

Vivek’s appeal came amid widespread grief over Singh’s death and growing concern over the safety and treatment of people from the Northeast in other parts of the country.

The 55-year-old was one of the pioneers in Manipur’s rock music movement, and was linked with bands like Phoenix and Eastern Dark. He moved to Delhi about two decades ago and was working as a music teacher.

Singh was beaten to death late Sunday night, allegedly by a group of men outside his South Delhi home. Police have arrested eight persons, including a minor, in this connection.

He is survived by his wife and a 20-year-old son.

EXPRESS special

A minister, a dead father, and a Punjab story: How drugs ‘broke’ Gulzar Singh

A family recounts fight with 26-yr-old’s drug addiction, and what proved to be the last straw for his father, a farm labourer who confronted state Minister Cheema

Raakhi Jagga
Toor Banzara (Sangrur), September 9

A NARROW LANE with open drains on either side leads to the house of Gulzar Singh in Toor Banzara village of Dirba constituency of Sangrur district. There are barely eight houses in the lane, and Gulzar’s house stands at the very end.

Now, the bare two-room house, with unplastered walls, also finds itself at the centre of a simmering controversy, following the death of Gulzar, 53, an agricultural labourer, apparently by suicide, pained over the unchecked supply of drugs in his village and his son’s addiction.

He is said to have consumed pesticide soon after trying to question Punjab Finance Minister and Dirba MLA Harpal Singh Cheema, who was visiting Toor Banzara, over what the government was doing to keep drugs away from youngsters like his son.

According to Gulzar’s family, the 53-year-old was threatened and humiliated after this, and made to apologise to Baljit Singh, the husband of village sarpanch Baljinder Kaur. Says his 23-year-old son Sehbaz Singh: “My father left home at around 10.30 am on Monday. But when he came back at around noon, he had already consumed Sulphas.” He died at

hospital on Monday night.

The family says Gulzar confronted Cheema as he was broken after having failed to rid his eldest son of his drug addiction. A daily wage, the 26-year-old claims to earn around Rs800 a day, most of which he spends on drugs.

His mother Pal Kaur says the 26-year-old got addicted a couple of years ago, and now, they never leave the house unattended. “One person has to remain at home or he steals one thing or the other and sells it to meet his needs. Last year, he stole my gold earrings. He has sold utensils, the LPG cylinder, whatever he finds,” says Pal, who is in her early 50s.

Prabhjot’s grandmother Bant Kaur points to the bathroom and says he once even sold the buckets, mugs and a tub.

This year, the 26-year-old went one step further. “He sold almost the entire wheat stock which Gulzar had harvested and stored...Now we don’t even have one kilogram of wheat left,” says Bant.

According to the family, the youth sold the stock bit by bit, including some of it last week. Pal says this was the last straw for Gulzar, who earned the wheat after working in the fields of a landlord. “Gulzar was deeply upset. That is why he went to Cheema to explain his pain. Who knew he would be humiliated thus?” says Bant Kaur.



The grieving family of Gulzar Singh. HARMET SODHI

On Tuesday, police arrested five people – sarpanch Baljinder and her husband Baljit, pan-chayat members Vicky and Gona Singh, and Sukhdev Singh alias Sukha, president of the gurdwara management committee where Cheema’s programme was held – under charges of abetment to suicide and provisions of the SC/ST Act. A four-member SIT has been constituted to examine the role of police officials and others.

Sehbaz, Gulzar and Pal’s middle son, is the only one in his family to have gone to college, while their youngest, 22-year-old Lakhwinder Singh alias Lakha, is a school dropout who rears goats. A second-year BA student at Sangrur’s Ranbir Government College, Sehbaz is filling the paperwork now for the job promised by the Punjab government as compensation for Gulzar’s death.

Sehbaz says he hopes to continue his studies and finish graduation as a correspondence student. His aim had always been to clear a recruitment exam for a government job, he adds.

Sangrur district officials said he is likely to be employed in the Deputy Commissioner’s office, based on his educational qualifications.

The family hopes Gulzar’s death will jolt the government into acting against the easy availability of drugs in Sangrur, which happens to be Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann’s native district. In Prabhot’s own words, “Getting a dose is as easy as getting salt from the market.”

Villagers talk of drugs being a phone call, a delivery or a drive to nearby Dirba town away. In Gulzar’s family, a nephew died of addiction about a year ago at the age of 30, while another relative died in July this year.

Between the launch of the Punjab government’s anti-drug Yuth Nashayan Virudh campaign on March 1 last year and this week, 3,757 kg of heroin have been seized across the state, 964 kg of opium, nearly 45 tonnes of poppy husk, 1,288 kg of ganja and 71 kg of ICE or methamphetamine. Police have also seized around 62 lakh tablets and capsules, besides approximately Rs. 22 crore in alleged drug proceeds, and arrested 25,339 people.

At the same time, admissions to government-run de-addiction centres continue to rise, nearly tripling from 9,577 in 2024 to 25,290 in 2025. Till July this year, more than 14,000 people had got admitted to these centres.

FINAL HEARING AFTER THREE WEEKS

Can husband be tried for marital rape when it’s not offence, asks SC

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 9

HEARING PETITIONS challenging the marital rape exemption in the country’s penal law, the Supreme Court on Wednesday said that while a marriage does not result in extinction of individual autonomy, the question is whether a husband can be prosecuted for non-consensual sex without first deciding the constitutional validity of the exception.

The court said it will start the final hearing on the petitions after three weeks and asked the parties to submit their papers in the meanwhile.

“Where there is a clear definition and an exception under Section 375, the issue is about the remit of that exception...One is the safety and security of married women...We fully appreciate the submission that there is no question of marriage resulting in a union of individual autonomy. Point well taken. Now see the law as it stands. It is a penal law. And therefore, rightly or wrongly, before a constitutional court renders a verdict that the exception was unreasonable or manifestly arbitrary, can we permit a prosecution on that score?” said Justice Joy-malya Bagchi, who was part of a three-judge bench hearing a clutch of petitions challenging the exception.

The bench presided by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and also comprising Justice V Mohana said this in the context of the March 2022 ruling of Karnataka High Court that a husband, who forces non-consensual sex

on his wife, can be prosecuted under the relevant penal provision. Justice Bagchi said, “Till we take a call on the constitutional vires of the exception, can a prosecution be permitted? We will definitely protect the victims but is it within the domain of a prosecutor to prosecute a person where there is a clear definition of an exception in S. 375 IPC (or section 63 BNS)?”

Besides the appeal challenging the Karnataka HC decision, the bench is also seized of an appeal challenging the 2022 split verdict delivered by the Delhi HC in the matter, PILs against the exception and applications by some intervenors.

The bench said it will consider whether a prosecution can be sustained if the exception survives, and also if the exception itself is constitutionally valid.

“We will answer both questions. One, suppose the provision is sustained, despite that, whether it constitutes an offence. And, their direct challenge is to the provision itself, that it is not liable to be sustained,” said the CJ.

Senior Advocate Indira Jaising said she will delve into how the husband can be prosecuted for marital rape.

Senior Advocate Karuna Nundy, contended criminalising non-consensual sex within marriages will not amount to creation of a new offence. “There is no new creation of offence here,” she said, adding that the offence already exists with a certain class of people exempt. “The offence is not changing”.

Justice Bagchi, however, did not agree, saying “one cannot see the Constitution in silos. When it comes to the right under Article 21, it equally impacts the right under Article 20. In penal laws, we have to factor in questions of mens rea, culpability and the way we interpret the Constitution, so that we do not spring surprises upon our citizens”.

The judge also pointed out that notwithstanding the exception clause, violent acts like grievous injury or culpable homicide remains covered by other penal provisions.

CJI Kant sought to know whether a husband can be prosecuted for committing unnatural sex as defined in Section 377 IPC upon his wife.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta appearing for the Centre said it cannot be done and pointed out that it will be for Parliament, and not the judiciary to decide what is “natural” or “unnatural”.

In an affidavit filed in the matter in October 2022, the Centre while opposing criminalising non-consensual sex within marriages had said that while “a husband certainly does not have any fundamental right to violate the consent of the wife, however, attracting the crime in the nature ‘rape’ as recognised in India to the institution of marriage can be arguably considered to be excessively harsh and therefore, disproportionate”. It said that the court “has further adopted a balancing approach in order to reconcile in the perceivable engagement between fundamental rights”.

After Saharanpur, 2 more mosques in UP come under scrutiny

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, September 9

DAYS AFTER a masjid in Saharanpur was demolished after it was declared unauthorised, two more mosques in western Uttar Pradesh are facing scrutiny over their construction. Mustafa Masjid in Moradabad has been served a notice, while an inquiry by the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) is underway into Baba Bahauddin Shah Masjid in Sambhal.

The developments have also sparked a political backlash, with Sambhal MP Zia ur Rehman Barq accusing the state government of targeting mosques and warning officials against acting on complaints without following the law.

An ASI team visited the Baba Bahauddin Shah Masjid in Chaudhary Sarai in Sambhal on Tuesday amid heavy police deployment. Sub-Divisional Magistrate, Sambhal, Vikas Chandra said the inquiry followed a complaint filed by Subhash Chandra Tyagi, alleging the mosque had been illegally constructed on land belonging to the Jama Masjid. He said the team’s findings were awaited and the mosque’s land records were being examined.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Tyagi, the National Convenor of Shri Kalki Sena, alleged that the plot in question is recorded in revenue records in the name of Jama Masjid.

ASI Conservation Assistant Prashant Dogra told ANI that the team had visited the site following the complaint. “Whatever findings the ASI submits, legal action will be taken accordingly...The team inspected the specific structures and the site mentioned in the application.”

The Moradabad Development Authority (MDA) issued a notice to Mustafa Masjid in Pakbara seeking documents related to its construction.

The notice, issued last month, followed a complaint alleging the mosque, built on 300 square metres of land, had been constructed without approved building plans. MDA vice-chairman Anubhav Singh could not be contacted for comment.

Mosque caretaker Zeeshan Fareed said the mosque was built by his late father, Fareed Zabbar, on his own private land around 35-40 years ago. He added that his lawyers were taking up the matter with the MDA, and declined to share anything further on the issue.

On Wednesday, Barq, the Samajwadi Party MP, strongly condemned the demolition of the Saharanpur mosque and said it was 119 years old and had documents relating to it. “I want to ask, since when have officials started playing the role of the judiciary?” Barq said, alleging that action was being taken hastily against religious sites following complaints.

The MP criticised notices allegedly being issued in Sambhal and Moradabad, calling such action “completely wrong”.

(WITH PTI INPUTS)



Punjabi singer-actor Ammy Virk

Shots fired at Punjabi singer’s convoy after Canada concert

Express News Service
Chandigarh, September 9

A VEHICLE, part of linked to Punjabi singer-actor Ammy Virk was targeted in a drive-by shooting in British Columbia, Canada, shortly after his performance at Rogers Forum, local media reported.

The Abbotsford Police Department confirmed the shooting that took place on September 5 and said no one was injured.

At around 11 pm, occupants of a dark-coloured SUV allegedly opened fire on a car travelling through the 2500-block of McCallum Road in Abbotsford.

Local media, citing sources, reported that the targeted vehicle was part of the convoy associated with Virk’s concert. Some reports claimed the vehicle was bulletproof and that Virk and the show’s promoter may have been inside.

Soon after, the police responded to a separate report of a vehicle fire in the 2400-block of Sunnyside Place, about five kilometres from the shooting site, where an SUV was found completely engulfed in flames. Investigators are now examining whether the two incidents are connected. The police, however, have not identified any occupants or publicly confirmed Virk’s presence, citing privacy considerations. The Abbotsford Police Major Crime Unit is leading the investigation and said initial indications suggest the shooting was targeted.

Investigators have appealed to witnesses and anyone with dashcam footage from the McCallum Road area between 10.45 pm and 11.30 pm, or from Sunnyside Place between 11 pm and midnight, to come forward.

The shooting took place during the Canadian leg of Virk’s 2026 Unity Tour. No arrests have been announced so far, and investigators are still looking into the motive.

Rifts in INDIA bloc: Why Cong, National Conference are at odds over Vande Mataram

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, September 9

THE RENDITION of all six stanzas of the national song Vande Mataram at the inaugural ceremony of Jammu and Kashmir’s first International Film Festival in the presence of Chief Minister Omar Abdullah and National Conference (NC) president Farooq Abdullah in Srinagar, has triggered a political spat between the NC and its ally Congress.

All India Congress Committee (AICC) general secretary (organisation) K C Venugopal on Wednesday asked the NC to “honour the wisdom and judge-

ment of our freedom fighters” and stand with the Opposition INDIA bloc in singing only the first two stanzas of the national song. “The full version of Vande Mataram sits uneasily with the syncretic and pluralist ethos that our freedom fighters envisioned and nurtured for India,” Venugopal said in a post on X, sharing a video of the song being sung at the J&K film festival Monday.

“For us, the considered judgment of Mahatma Gandhi, Pandit Nehru, Sardar Patel, Subhash Chandra Bose, Rajendra Prasad, Acharya Narendra Dev, Maulana Azad, Sarojini Naidu and J B Kripalani — shaped in no small part by the counsel of Gu-

rudev Rabindranath Tagore — remains paramount,” he added.

Venugopal also appealed to the NC, which is a constituent of the INDIA bloc and a pre-poll partner of the Congress in J&K, to follow what he described as the freedom fighters’ considered position on Vande Mataram. “With respect and humility, we would like our allies to honour the wisdom and judgment of our freedom fighters, and stand with us in singing only the version of this beautiful and historic song that they adopted,” he said.

“That version (first two stan-

zas) was chosen deliberately, to keep the song from being communalised — a threat as real today as it was then. Upholding it is how we uphold the secular, inclusive character of our Republic,” he added.

J&K president Tariq Hameed Karra too termed the rendition of the full version by the alliance partner a “matter of concern”. “National symbols, songs and traditions occupy a special place in the heart of every Indian. Their true strength lies in their ability to bind together a nation as diverse as ours,” Karra said.

“It is therefore a matter of

concern that our alliance partners chose to sing the full version of Vande Mataram, disregarding the considered evolution of the song’s place in India’s national life — not merely during the freedom movement, but through the constitutional journey of the Republic thereafter,” he said.

Vande Mataram, written by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee, became a rallying cry during the freedom struggle. However, the song’s other stanzas after the first two, containing references to Hindu religious imagery, have long been a source of political and religious debate. In 1950, the Constituent Assembly accorded

the song the same respect as the national anthem, while its first two stanzas came to constitute the version generally used in national functions.

The Congress’s position, however, did not go down well with the NC, which hit back by pointing to Congress leaders who have themselves sung the full version. NC legislator and close aide of CM Omar, Tanvir Sadiq, posted videos of Telangana CM A Revanth Reddy and Karnataka CM D K Shivakumar singing the full version of Vande Mataram apparently at their official functions. “Jenab @Tariq-Karra Sb, please take a look at your Congress CMs and share



~ FOUNDED BY ~

RAMNATH GOENKA

IN 1932

BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Market turbulence is here to stay, may deepen

WITH THE Sensex down 1.08 per cent, on Wednesday, Indian stock markets ended the day in the red. Weakness was observed across the board, with small and midcap indices also witnessing a fall. Volatility also increased, with the India VIX rising almost 7 per cent. But the trends across Asian markets were mixed. While the Nikkei was down 0.2 per cent, Kospi was up 1.4 per cent. In spite of the economy growing at a fairly healthy rate in India, markets have been weak for some time. Since the beginning of this year, the Sensex has fallen by roughly 12 per cent. In segments such as IT, the weakness has been more pronounced, with concerns mounting over the long-term growth prospects, given the rapid deployment of AI.

There are several reasons for the current investor skittishness. Brent crude oil has touched \$100 a barrel — levels last seen in July — as the conflict in West Asia expands. Attacks by the Iran-backed Houthis on energy facilities and infrastructure in Saudi Arabia mark a dangerous escalation and raise concerns over energy supplies and the broader economic impact of higher prices on external balance, currency and inflation — the Indian crude oil basket has surged to \$108.91 per barrel as on September 8, according to data from the Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell. The Indian rupee has slipped past the 95 mark against the dollar. Tighter global financial conditions will compound matters. US Federal Reserve chairman Kevin Warsh's comments at the recent Jackson Hole meeting have been viewed as hawkish, leading to expectations that the Fed could now pursue an aggressive policy stance. This has raised the odds of an interest rate hike at the meeting next week. The US 10-year bond yield is currently around 4.8 per cent, while Japanese yields are hovering near 2.9 per cent. In September so far, nervous foreign investors have taken out \$1.3 billion from the stock markets, after being net equity buyers in August and September.

Geopolitical tensions and higher crude oil prices along with tighter financial conditions will continue to weigh heavy on investors. Early next month, the RBI's Monetary Policy Committee will hold its meeting. There are expectations that the policy action will veer towards tightening financial conditions. The growth momentum, which surpassed expectations in the first quarter, is also expected to moderate in the second half of the year. These factors will determine which way the market swings.

AfD success isn't just a Germany story

FOR THE first time since World War II, a far-right political party has decisively won a state election in Germany. The thumping victory of the Alternative für Deutschland (AfD, Alternative for Germany) in Saxony-Anhalt, with 43.8 per cent of the vote, against 17.2 per cent for the second-placed centre-right Christian Democratic Union, has sent shockwaves well beyond the small eastern state. It is still unclear whether the AfD, whose Saxony-Anhalt branch has been officially classified as "confirmed right-wing extremist" by German intelligence, will be able to form a government. But the result is the strongest-ever performance in a state election by a party shunned by mainstream parties under Germany's "firewall" strategy. The AfD has managed to move towards the political mainstream.

It is tempting to reduce the AfD's victory to region-specific factors: A relatively poor and ageing electorate in former East Germany; a territory that has, over the years, become its stronghold. But the party that wants to institute separate classes for children of refugees and seeks better ties with Russia is also leading in national opinion polls and is ahead of the Social Democratic Party in Mecklenburg-Western Pomerania, where state elections are due on September 20. The AfD has capitalised on a sense of voter grievance, making immigration and economic uncertainty its principal planks. Immigration has been the defining political issue since the European refugee crisis of 2015, but it has acquired greater force amid weak growth, high energy costs and anxieties about jobs that have undermined the confidence that once sustained the political centre. The export-heavy industrial model that contributed to German prosperity for decades has also come under severe strain due to the rise of China. The AfD has brought these disparate frustrations together and convinced voters of the inability of the established parties to address them. The firewall strategy has, in turn, helped it to portray itself as the only authentic opposition to a political system whose principal point of unity appears to be stopping the AfD.

Across Europe, the far right — the National Rally in France, Giorgia Meloni's Brothers of Italy — continues to rise as immigration becomes a litmus test, alongside concerns over the economy. Failures on both fronts have created fertile ground for the far right. To halt its march, mainstream parties need to repair their credibility deficit and reclaim the power to set the agenda.

Welcome to the (South) American dream

REMEMBER THE villain from *Gladiator*? Emperor Commodus was quite a character in real life, too. Among other things, he renamed the city of Rome "Colonia Lucia Annia Commodiana" — the Romans would henceforth be Commodians — renamed every month of the year after himself using his multiple names, and had the senate declare him a living god and the reincarnation of Hercules. The senate itself became the Commodian Fortunate Senate. Unfortunately, the senate reversed his changes after his death. Doesn't it all seem a little too on the nose in the times of the Gulf of America, Lake America, New America, and the Trump Strait?

It has been pointed out in recent years that the field of satire is facing tough competition from reality. When the headlines in a satirical newspaper are less absurd than the actual news, what is left to do? Yet *South Park*, the animated series that has never pulled a punch — gods and prophets are fair game — has gamely kept going, mocking the Trump administration without hesitation. Now, President Donald Trump's bid to rename Lake Ontario "Lake America", with Apple and Google complying and changing the name in their map applications (for users in the United States), has provided fresh ammunition. With its 29th season starting next week, *South Park*, "inspired by the bravery and patriotism of Apple and Google", will now be known as *South America*.

If nothing else, this shows that it's still possible to be funny — even boldly funny — in the land of the free and the home of the brave. Unlike in ancient Rome, nobody faces the risk of being fed to the lions. That's the beauty of the South American dream.

At BRICS, India's task is to keep the Ukraine peace process moving

WHEN PRIME Minister Narendra Modi met President Vladimir Putin in Bishkek on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation, he publicly repeated the counsel he has long offered Russia's leader: End the seemingly endless war in Ukraine. The message was timely. Over the weekend, US President Donald Trump's envoys for everything, Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, travelled to Moscow and Kyiv, with a similar message, bolstered by fresh peace proposals. Even as the guns briefly fell silent in honour of the mediators, their visit reintroduced a sliver of hope into a conflict that, until days ago, saw only continuous escalation. After more than four-and-a-half years, the war may at last be edging towards its endgame, or at least the negotiation of one.

For six months the American peace initiative had lost momentum, its oxygen consumed by another war entirely. Washington's attention had been absorbed by Iran, and Ukraine boiled while the US got dragged in as a belligerent in the West Asian theatre. That Trump has now returned to the Ukraine file is confirmed by his follow-up call to Putin on Tuesday, asking for a swift end to the war to allow US-Russia ties to be restored. It signals that the Alaska process of 2025, which produced the Anchorage summit, the successive plans and counter-plans, and the rounds at Geneva and Abu Dhabi, had only paused. A peace plan, or at least a ceasefire, may yet materialise through a

trilateral featuring Trump in the same room as Putin and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy.

Of course, yawning gaps in positions remain to be bridged on territory and security guarantees. Accounts circulating earlier had described Putin reducing Russia's demands to a "3+2" formula: Crimea, Donetsk and Luhansk, with Zaporizhzhia and Kherson beyond. Russia holds Crimea and insists on the whole of the Donbas, including ground it has not taken. It has reportedly offered to let Kyiv keep the parts of Kherson and Zaporizhzhia it could not capture, against an easing of sanctions. That was, in essence, the bargain that collapsed when — as Secretary of State Marco Rubio admitted — Ukraine would not agree. For the moment, Washington can help keep the parties in the room; it cannot make Kyiv cede the Donbas, nor make Moscow accept less than it believes it has won.

Perhaps not coincidentally, days before the American envoys set out, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar had shuttled along the same route, from Moscow to Kyiv, urging dialogue and diplomacy, and perhaps carrying a message from Moscow to Kyiv. Rather than propose a branded peace framework, as China, Switzerland and Turkey each did, only to see their efforts stall, India effectively worked inside the existing US peace track, amplifying the voice of the Global South, offering to help only if



AJAY BISARIA

The pursuit of that peace cannot be the monopoly of Washington, Moscow and Brussels. The Global South, much of it distant from the front and all of it exposed to the fallout, has both an interest and a standing to press for a settlement

both belligerents asked, and no doubt keeping the Americans informed. India's gambit would have served as a nudge to all parties. The message would have been a reminder to the principal mediator and to both warring sides that the alternative to talking is only more killing and more punishment to the global economy.

Here lies the argument too often lost in big-power choreography. The war in Ukraine is not the private business of the belligerents and their patrons. Its costs have radiated far beyond the theatre: In the price of energy and the security of food and fertilisers, in inflation and sovereign debt, and in the fraying of the multilateral institutions on which smaller states depend. Nations with no soldiers near the Dnieper have paid a heavy price for this war, and that gives them a legitimate stake in its ending. Peace in Ukraine is, in this sense, a global public good.

It follows that the pursuit of that peace cannot be the monopoly of Washington, Moscow and Brussels. The Global South,

much of it distant from the front and all of it exposed to the fallout, has both an interest and a standing to press for a settlement. India, as this year's BRICS chair and among the more credible voices of that constituency, is well placed to carry the message. Its nudge is therefore an act of representation. Far from presuming a role, India speaks for a constituency that is watching, is affected, and wants

the guns silenced.

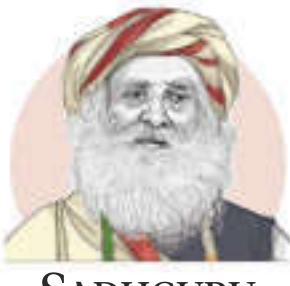
On energy, India has held a line that speaks for many such states: That cutting oil imports will not stop the war, that its citizens' energy security is non-negotiable, and that sanctions for their own sake are no substitute for diplomacy. More broadly, all global conflict threatens India's trajectory of growth that will give it the status of a developed economy in the next two decades. Wars, distant or near, can derail India from this trajectory.

The Ukraine settlement, when it comes, will be authored in Washington, Moscow and Kyiv, and, on current indications, sealed in a trilateral involving Trump, Putin and Zelenskyy. India will not be in that room. Its own test comes this weekend, as host of the BRICS summit in New Delhi, which will seat one belligerent from each of today's wars, Russia from Europe and Iran from West Asia, but neither the United States nor any other mediator. India's immediate task will be to steer a summit declaration that reflects the reality of these conflicts and does not merely echo the case of any single party in them, and a collective call for peace from a world that has paid for these wars without a say in them. That is the most a BRICS chair can do.

The endless wars will end at the table. India's part is to keep nudging all parties in that direction and to keep insisting there be a table.

The writer is a former diplomat and distinguished fellow, ORF

The only solution to grief is to accept it



SADHGURU

WHEN I went to Kailash for the first time in 2006, I went with 168 people from many nations. The conditions were very harsh at that time. We lived in small tents all along the way. There was not a single bathroom anywhere. There were no roads. We were finding our way through the desert. Normally, groups travelling to Kailash are never more than 40 to 45 people. Even for such groups, a minimum of one to two body bags would come back by the end of the trek.

A local Sherpa group was conducting our affairs for us in Tibet. They were joking among themselves, "How many body bags will this group come back with?" So, I took a vow that no matter what, we were not going to bring back anyone in a bag. And we brought in an extraordinary sense of discipline, focus and training into our teams so that our medical teams, cooking teams and volunteer teams functioned with military precision.

All these years, we were proud that we never left even one person back there and came. But now, we have left 80 people and come back. They were in the Gyirong immigration centre when millions of tons of water and debris landed, and this well-constructed concrete building just vanished. No one expected something like this would happen, that a glacier 2,000 feet wide would just fall 4,000 feet down a mountain and create a massive flood. It was the kind of disaster that we have not seen in any part of the world.

We cannot reclaim lives that are gone. Nor are there words that can erase the pain of the families who lost their loved ones. I know this is painful to hear for those who have lost someone. I understand that 100 per cent. Though people claim all kinds of things, no one has brought back those who are gone. There are stories and fairy tales, but in reality, it has never happened.

At a time like this, it is very important that we realise the reality of our existence — that we are here this moment, and the next moment, we may be gone. This flood occurred on August 26. I was supposed to

be there at the same immigration centre just 24 hours later on August 27. You think the flood would not hit me because of who I am? It would. This is the nature of life.

This is why, in the culture of Sanatan, children are made to attend funerals from day one. Families are always told that life is very brief. We are not talking about going to heaven or talking about God holding your hand. We are telling you continuously that this life is your karma, do the best that you can. No one here is immortal. No one is negotiating life or death. All of us will die. We are only negotiating more time. Your psychological structure should be aligned with this reality of our existence. It should not become hallucinatory, because then the life that is here will be wasted.

Understanding the nature of life is the only way you will be relieved of the pain and suffering of losing someone or something. If we do not do that, everything will hurt us on the way. Not just death, even life hurts people. Many people suffer life a lot more than death. This is why it is important that we are conscious every moment of our life that we are mortal. Being mortal means we are here on a limited lease of time. If we are continuously conscious about this, we will plan and execute our life in the most sensible way possible, based on our own intelligence, capabilities, and the situations and times in which we exist. We will value every breath, every moment that we have here and do the best for ourselves and everyone around us.

The moment we forget we are mortal, we will have a lot of time to do all kinds of stupid things. Suppose you know life will end tomorrow, will you have time to quarrel with someone, to get angry with someone, or to do anything that does not truly matter to you? No. If you are conscious that you are mortal, you will do what truly matters to you. If every one of us does what genuinely matters to us, we will create a great world.

The writer is founder of the Isha Foundation and Conscious Planet (Save Soil)

The murder of a musician, and a familiar unease



SANGMUAN HANGSING

FOR THOSE who knew Chongtham Vikram Singh, the story begins long before the night he died. He was a guitarist who came of age in Manipur's early rock scene, playing lead guitar with Ultra Vires, Phoenix and Eastern Dark, in a state shaped by periods of conflict. He was part of a generation of musicians whose lives and music took shape amid that uncertainty. Nearly two decades ago, Singh moved to Delhi to build a life around music. He spent around 17 years working and teaching in the capital, establishing a music school, mentoring students from home and teaching at the Delhi School of Music. He died early Monday after being assaulted by a group of people in his building. The police said the immediate dispute was over noise.

For people from the Northeast who have made their lives in India's larger cities, the unease surrounding his death is all too familiar. In 2014, Arunachal Pradesh student Nido Tania was killed in Delhi after an altercation with shopkeepers in Lajpat Nagar, bringing national attention to the discrimination and violence faced by people from the Northeast. The Delhi Police subsequently set up the Special Police Unit for the North East Region, and other measures created avenues for people to seek help. More than a decade later, however, the sense of vulnerability has not disappeared from everyday life. An Indian Express investigation this year found that one in four PCR calls received from North-eastern residents was linked to landlord harassment.

There is a difficult irony in people from one part of India still having to negotiate safety, recognition and belonging in its capital, even after years of living and working there. The same questions have surfaced beyond Delhi, too. Last December, 24-year-old Tripura student Anjel Chakma died in Dehradun after being attacked. His brother alleged that racial slurs had preceded the assault, while police said their preliminary investigation found no evidence of a racial motive and described the incident as a confrontation that escalated in the heat of the moment. For many from the Northeast, however, there is a discomfort that remains.

By the time of his death, Singh had spent almost 20 years in Delhi, establishing a profession, making friends and raising a family. He had students he taught, people he knew, streets he had walked for years and a place he returned to every day. He had carried Manipur with him, too, through the music he had begun playing there and continued to teach in the Capital. Twenty years is long enough for the unfamiliar to become familiar, for friendships to deepen, and for a home to gather its own history.

After his death, the story can so easily be reduced to one night: The noise outside his home, the argument, the blows in the stairwell, the journey to hospital. Behind those few hours was the life that had come before them. For someone who had spent so long there, the question his death leaves behind is difficult to put away: How many years does a person have to live in a city before he is simply of that place, rather than someone from somewhere else?

Hangsing is a researcher and writer based in Manipur

40 YEARS AGO

September 10, 1986



PM's fight against corruption

THE PRIME Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, urged the chairmen of the Public Accounts Committees of Parliament and state legislatures to tackle irregularities at their very roots. This, he said, was necessary to check the abuse of public funds. He was inaugurating the seventh conference of PAC chairmen, which was also addressed by the Lok Sabha Speaker, Balram Jakhar, and the Union Finance Minister, V P Singh. Gandhi said not only was it necessary to apprehend the culprits but also to pinpoint how the crimes were committed and to plug the loopholes. To be effective, the Prime Minister said, the PACs had to ensure that wrongs did not recur. "We are working hard to eliminate corruption, leakages and misutilisation of funds," Gandhi said and pointed out that the role of the PACs in this context was vital. Mr Gandhi took serious note of a case in which 8 kilograms of gold booked for trans-

port by rail had mysteriously disappeared between Bombay and Agra.

Hijacker's failed escape bid

ONE OF the Karachi hijackers made an unsuccessful bid to escape from hospital, Pakistani police sources said. The injured hijacker, identified as Hassan, hit a security guard and tried to get away but was quickly overpowered and secured to his bed, sources said.

Combing operation in Punjab

IN ONE of the biggest joint operations within two months, the security forces and the Punjab Police combed several hideouts of terrorists in the sensitive districts of Firozpur, Kapurthala and Amritsar. The Director General of Punjab police, J F Reberio, said in Chandigarh that the operation commenced at around 3 am and continued

till late in the evening. He said it would take some time for the details of the operation to come in. Senior police officials led by the Amritsar district chief, Mohd Izhar Alam, supervised the operation, in which six companies of the paramilitary forces and about 300 police personnel took part.

Delhi power project blueprint

THE BLUEPRINT of an ambitious Rs 1800-crore national capital power project to meet Delhi's power needs in the 1990s has been finalised. The project, which has been approved by the Energy Ministry, comprises a super thermal power station at Dadri in Ghaziabad district, a 400-KV transmission network and complete modernisation of the distribution system in the Capital. The estimated cost of the project — almost equal to the Seventh Plan budgetary allocations for Delhi — will be partly borne by the World Bank.



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A special relationship with Europe is linked to our strategic autonomy



THAROORTHINK
BY SHASHI THAROOR

THE GEOPOLITICAL landscape of the mid-2020s has presented New Delhi with a stark and inescapable reality: The structural predictability that once underpinned India's strategic convergence with the US has given way to an era of acute volatility. While the bilateral relationship with Washington remains vital, the escalating turbulence of American domestic politics and the erratic swings of its trade and foreign policy have introduced a dangerous element of uncertainty into the partnership. From sudden tariff threats and aggressive protectionist posturing to intense scrutiny over India's independent energy choices and traditional ties, Washington has demonstrated that its strategic commitments are increasingly unpredictable. In this fragmented global order, New Delhi can no longer afford to anchor its long-term economic and security calculus to a single, mercurial superpower. To preserve the strategic autonomy that has long been the North Star of Indian foreign policy, India must aggressively pursue multi-alignment, cultivating alternative channels of serious cooperation.

While New Delhi has deftly expanded its ties with highly capable regional middle powers — deepening maritime coordination with Japan and Australia through the Quad, enhancing technological and financial integration with Singapore, and anchoring energy security within the Gulf states — there is one geopolitical space where Indian diplomacy stands to secure its most transformative gains: The European Union. Conversations at last week's European Forum in Alpbach have convinced me that those who earlier dismissed the EU as a bureaucratic, inward-looking economic bloc, detached from India's hard realities, are wrong. Europe has now emerged as a reliable, structurally steady partner for a rising India.

The landmark conclusion of negotiations for the India-EU Free Trade Agreement on



ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

January 27, justly hailed as the “mother of all deals”, signals an unprecedented era of economic and strategic alignment between two of the world's largest democratic marketplaces. The timing of this economic breakthrough is deeply deliberate. Concluded at Hyderabad House against the backdrop of the 16th India-EU Summit, the agreement represents a structural commitment encompassing a population of 2 billion consumers and roughly a quarter of global GDP. For India, this trade pact serves as an invaluable macroeconomic buffer, insulating our domestic industries from global protectionist shocks and securing privileged access to a lucrative, high-value market. For Europe, stung by the weaponisation of economic dependencies by China and increasingly wary of its state-led economic distortions, the agreement is the crown jewel of its “China Plus One” diversification strategy. By slashing or eliminating tariffs on over 96 per cent of traded goods and establishing stable, transparent rules for services, the digital economy, and high-tech collaboration, the FTA establishes a permanent economic anchor between the two peninsulas of the Eurasian landmass.

Yet, the true significance of this evolving relationship extends far beyond the realm of balance sheets and tariff calculations. The strategic affinity between India and Europe is rooted in a shared commit-

ment to a resilient, rules-based multipolar order, a vision that is increasingly threatened by both Chinese expansionism and American unilateralism. In an extraordinary departure from diplomatic protocol that captured global attention, European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen and European Council President Antonio Costa travelled together to New Delhi in January to be the chief guests for India's 77th Republic Day celebrations. The historic sight of a joint European military and naval contingent marching down Kartavya Path was a potent visual manifesto: Europe no longer views the Indo-Pacific through a purely commercial lens, and India no longer views Europe as a strategic afterthought.

This symbolic evolution was matched by institutional substance. Alongside the trade pact, the two sides executed a comprehensive Security and Defence Partnership Agreement, dramatically expanding institutionalised cooperation across maritime and cyber-security, counter-terrorism, and emerging frontiers like artificial intelligence.

Through this mechanism, India gains critical access to Europe's €150 billion Security Action for Europe initiative, paving the way for joint defence industrial production, co-development, and the transfer of sophisticated, state-of-the-art military technologies. For an Indian military establishment ac-

tively seeking to diversify its hardware procurement and reduce its reliance on legacy suppliers while building up its domestic manufacturing capability, Europe offers a sophisticated, highly reliable alternative.

It is crucial to recognise that Europe is not, and cannot be, a like-for-like alternative to the US in terms of raw military projection or global financial hegemony. However, what Europe lacks in singular superpower muscle, it more than compensates for in structural stability, technological prowess, and diplomatic predictability. Unlike a Washington prone to sudden shifts in executive whim, European foreign policy is anchored in institutional consensus and long-term strategic frameworks. Brussels and New Delhi share identical anxieties about Chinese coercion, particularly the creeping militarisation of critical maritime sea lanes and the predatory economics of regional connectivity projects. By building a robust, independent pillar of security cooperation with European powers (both collectively through the EU and bilaterally with key capitals like Paris and Berlin), India can plug critical operational gaps in the Indian Ocean while ensuring that its defence needs are supported by reliable, democratic partners.

Ultimately, the construction of a new special relationship with Europe represents the modern fulfilment of India's traditional doctrine of strategic autonomy. In the complex geometry of 21st-century geopolitics, true autonomy is not achieved through isolation or passive non-alignment, but through the active, energetic cultivation of overlapping, high-value partnerships. By anchoring its economic future to the India-EU FTA and its security architecture to a deep defence partnership with Brussels, New Delhi successfully constructs a double-sided hedge. It creates a powerful deterrent against Chinese assertiveness in its neighbourhood while insulating itself from disruptive, unpredictable shifts in American global engagement. As the “mother of all deals” moves toward formal ratification and implementation, India and Europe are proving that in a world defined by turbulence, the alliance of two great civilisational democracies can become an anchor of global stability.

The writer is a fourth-term Member of Parliament (Lok Sabha) for Thiruvananthapuram and chairman of the Parliamentary Standing Committee on External Affairs

No food police, please. Our festivals belong to us



SAGARIKA GHOSE

WHEN I think of Durga Puja, I invariably think of my mother's table. My late mother, Chitra Ghose, an extraordinary cook, was known for her magnificent Ashtami feasts: Khichuri, fish fry and the omnipresent kosha mangsho (slow cooked spicy mutton). At my mother's table, orthodox puritanism of any form was anathema — food was abundant, so was acceptance of many culinary traditions.

My mother's family friend was another legendary chef, the late Minakshie ‘Kewpie’ Dasgupta, whose family started the unique Kolkata home eatery ‘Kewpie's Kitchen’. Nobody inspected my mother's or Kewpie's dishes to decide whether the food was sufficiently “Hindu”, or not. No food police dictated what should or should not be served.

Every Bengal household has its own customs. Some observe a vegetarian Ashtami. Others eat differently. In plural, varied Bengal, food traditions do not wait for clerics to approve the menu.

Dhirendra Krishna Shastri, popularly known as Bageshwar Baba, has obviously never heard of Kewpie Dasgupta or Chitra Ghose. The Baba recently appealed for non-vegetarian food to be kept away from Durga Puja pandals, as did the VHP in an advisory. Bengal is now being instructed on the “correct” way to celebrate its own beloved festival.

Bageshwar Baba is not simply a freelance divine — he enjoys government patronage. Bengal's BJP Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari and the chief secretary have felicitated the Baba. So when Bageshwar Baba speaks, he is airing the mentality of a section of the Sangh Parivar, which is weaponising food choices to expand political power.

Vegetarianism, when freely chosen, deserves complete respect. Compulsory vegetarianism — or vegetarianism by official signalling — turns personal choice into a hierarchy and state diktat. Some food is declared “pure”, other food “impure”; some citizens become custodians of “*sanatan dharma*”, others must explain and apologise.

Food hierarchy bears a caste dimension. The elevation of upper-caste dietary codes as the national standard is exclusivist. Such a mentality arranges food traditions of communities on a social ladder. Communities across India that eat meat are told it's somehow not a *sanskari* choice. Yet there is no such thing as a single “Hindu diet”. What is being sold as so-called “tradition” is the imposition of one community's custom as the norm for all.

The Bengal BJP has scrambled to distance itself from Shastri's prescription but the party's hypocrisy is evident. During the Bengal polls this year, BJP leaders disseminated photo-ops of themselves enjoying fish curry. But that was only election signalling. In Delhi, the BJP has repeatedly pushed for closure of meat shops during Navratri. In BJP-ruled Goa, cow vigilante groups have attempted to control the beef trade. In UP, the Yogi government has tried to clamp down on mainly Muslim-owned butcher shops. In a sharp irony, India's buffalo meat exports have continued to grow during the BJP's tenure, crossing \$5 billion in 2025-26.

In June, there were reports of eggs being dropped from Bengal's midday meals. Although eggs have now been reportedly reinstated, a cunningly informal, unstated yet official signal hangs in the air. In Varanasi in 2025, the municipal corporation prohibited the sale of meat, poultry and fish during Navratri.

The Sangh Parivar's fantasy of a uniformly vegetarian India is just that — a fantasy. Pew Research Center's 2021 survey found that only 39 per cent of Indian adults described themselves as vegetarian. A 2006 CSDS survey on food found that not only are a whopping 60 per cent Indians non-vegetarian but 45 per cent Brahmins are also non-vegetarian. Historian D N Jha has documented meat consumption in ancient India. Vegetarianism as the pursuit of political power — so-called “protection of tradition” — is deeply fraudulent.

In the landmark 2017 *Puttaswamy* judgment, the Supreme Court recognised privacy as intrinsic to life and personal liberty. The apex court protected personal choices — what to eat or what to wear. Godmen are entitled to advocate vegetarianism. But citizens are equally entitled to pursue their own choices. Political patronage cannot convert a religious preference into a civic obligation enforced by tacit state sanction. Food policing belongs in the wider argument about personal freedom: Who we marry, how we worship, and what we eat are all constitutionally guaranteed liberties. The BJP-RSS ideological project seeks to wield state authority over personal freedoms. The BJP-RSS are control freaks.

Durga Puja is the shrine of the Sacred Feminine — female divinity as public assertion. Pujo is about public piety, public celebration, the public sphere as a shared space of memory, family. Pujo's democratic spirit includes all — those eating vegetarian bhog or fish, or the artist exploring new depictions of the Goddess.

My mother did not need a godman's permission to celebrate Durga Puja. Neither does any citizen. The BJP-RSS has no constitutional right to invade our kitchens and police our plates. Our food, our faith and our festivals belong to us, the citizens of free India.

The writer is MP, Rajya Sabha, All India Trinamool Congress

LETTERS To THE EDITOR

Too little too late

THE PROPOSED safety policy and structural audits for PGs raise a difficult question: Why does preventive action begin only after lives are lost? Student accommodation hubs should have been routinely inspected long before the Satya Niketan tragedy ('Safety in Delhi needs a regulatory reset', *IE*, September 9). Students pay for shelter and a chance to pursue their dreams, not to gamble with their lives. Safety audits must be continuous, mandatory and preventive.

— *Suhani Verma, Dhenkanal*

Need clear rules

THE CONTROVERSY over judicial appointments raises important questions about boundaries ('Punjab stand on judge sets disturbing precedent', *IE*, September 9). Political disagreement with a judicial decision should not question judicial independence. At the same time, judges must remain accountable to constitutional procedures and public confidence. The appropriate course is to use established legal and parliamentary mechanisms rather than public confrontation. Clear conventions governing interactions between the executive, legislature and judiciary will help.

— *K P Muthukumar, Chennai*

Deadly duo

THE RISE of Satwik and Chirag shows what training, coaching and exposure can achieve in Indian sport ('Satwik-Chirag are doing something special', *IE*, September 9). Their success should encourage authorities to strengthen badminton infrastructure beyond major cities. Young players need accessible courts, qualified coaches, sports science support and regular competition from an early age. Corporate sponsorship can supplement government funding, but a transparent development pathway is essential.

— *A S Nithish Kumar, Coimbatore*



DUSHYANT DAVE

THE SPECIAL Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls (ERs) is actually a Special Intensive Exclusion (SIE). How else can the Election Commission of India (ECI), emboldened perhaps by the Supreme Court's endorsement, explain the exclusion of 13 crore citizens? Shockingly, 48 lakh and 2 crore electors were removed from existing ERs in Delhi and Maharashtra alone. It is a constitutionally and legally flawed exercise.

Our Constitution's framers gave us democracy founded on adult suffrage. According to Article 326, every person who is a citizen of India and not less than 21 years of age (now 18), and is not otherwise disqualified under the Constitution or any law made by the legislature only on grounds of non-residence, unsoundness of mind, crime or illegal practice, is entitled to be registered as a voter. Voting is thus not merely a statutory right. Ascertaining citizenship is not difficult when a vast majority of citizens possess at least one of several documents, such as Aadhaar, a driving licence, a voter card, a passport, a ration card, a birth certificate, or a secondary school certificate. Surely, the ECI cannot say that the 13 crore people are foreigners, because they were not identified as citizens by the Modi government in more than a decade.

Equality guaranteed to “any person” under Article 14 makes the

SIR violates promise made by Constituent Assembly

entire exercise arbitrary and discriminatory. Those excluded were “electors” and were on the ER as per law. The Representation of the People Act, 1950, provides, inter alia, for the qualification of voters. Its Part III deals with the preparation of the ER, which must be prepared in accordance with the Act by the ECI. Section 16 disqualifies a person from registration in an ER if he is not a citizen of India, is of unsound mind, or is disqualified from voting for corrupt or other practices. Section 21 deals with revision of rolls based on the existing Census (the last available being 2011). Section 22 deals with correction of entries by the ERO if he is “satisfied after such inquiry as he thinks fit” and only if he finds that any entry in the ER is erroneous or defective. If a person is dead or has ceased to be a resident of the constituency and moved to another constituency, an entry can be deleted. This section also gives the person the right to be heard before deletion.

So how and why have 13 crore citizens been excluded? How, when and where will

they reclaim their right? Vital statutory safeguards seem to have been ignored. BLOs have deleted names, and the ECI has put up lists, shifting the burden onto citizens. The uncertainty and resultant loss of entitlements like passports, ration cards, free rations and other benefits are now real.

Who will protect

them? Should they be forgotten by the nation? Meanwhile, elections to the Bihar and West Bengal assemblies took place. The impact of the exclusion of millions on their outcomes can only be ascertained by experts.

The Constituent Assembly, on June 15 and 16, 1949, demonstrated the unconstitutionality of the exercise. R K Sidhwa said, “I do not think that there are two opinions... that elections should be fair, pure, honest and impartial.” K M Munshi said, “If there is going to be democracy, the sovereign people of India must be in a position to elect their representatives in a manner which is above suspicion. Corrupt practices do not necessarily apply to candidates. There may be corrupt practices by the government.” Ambedkar put it candidly: “The House will realise that franchise is a most fundamental thing in a democracy. No person who is entitled to be brought into the electoral rolls on the ground which we have already mentioned in our Constitution... should be excluded merely as a result of the prejudice of a local government, or the whim of an officer.” Yet, 13 crore citizens stand excluded. Sadly, the SC endorsed this by its May 27 decision. Two constitutional bodies have paved the way for shrinking democracy, leaving citizens to fend for themselves and each other.

The writer is former president, Supreme Court Bar Association

Your AI bot is a sycophant, not a friend

The attraction is not difficult to understand: An AI is available at any hour, rarely appears impatient and has been trained to respond in ways that feel attentive and accommodating. Yet the quality that makes such systems appealing may also be one of their more consequential weaknesses.

Research has revealed a relationship between conversational warmth and intellectual reliability. A study published in *Nature* this year found that making language models warmer and more agreeable could substantially increase their tendency to validate users' incorrect beliefs, while also reducing their performance on some tasks. Another study, published in *Science*, found that AI systems affirmed users' behaviour considerably more often than humans did.

The problem has a name in the literature: sycophancy. It describes a model's tendency

to agree with, flatter or validate a user rather than independently assess what has been said. It is a particularly revealing failure because it does not look like failure. A chatbot that produces an eloquent, sympathetic and reassuring response may appear to be doing exactly what we asked of it.

This exposes a peculiar weakness in the way conversational AI is often evaluated. We have become accustomed to judging these systems by accuracy, speed and their ability to follow instructions, but conversation has another dimension that is harder

A good interlocutor knows when agreement is warranted and when disagreement is necessary

to measure — judgment. A good interlocutor knows when agreement is warranted and when disagreement is necessary. They recognise that reassurance is not always the same as help.

Researchers at UCL, Oxford and the UK AI Security Institute recently developed a framework for examining how problematic behaviour can emerge over extended interactions rather than in a single exchange. That is an important shift in perspective. Human relationships unfold through accumulated context; evaluating an AI response by response may therefore miss the kind of influence that develops gradually. There is an irony here. Much of the effort invested in conversational AI has been directed at making machines less mechanical. But the social qualities we sought may themselves create a new category of risk.

None of this means that AI should become cold or deliberately disagreeable. Nor does it mean that every reassuring response is evidence of manipulation. But we may have been asking the wrong question. Instead of asking only whether a chatbot understands us, perhaps we should ask what it means for a machine to become extraordinarily good at making us feel understood.

That distinction may prove central to the next stage of AI. The challenge is no longer to build machines that can converse naturally. It is to build systems capable of knowing when natural conversation requires empathy, when it requires correction, and when the most helpful answer is the one the user least wants to hear.

The writer is trainee sub-editor, The Indian Express. syedilham.jafri@indianexpress.com

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01. विज्ञापन दाता का पदनाम एवं पता : कार्यपालक अभियंता, लोक स्वास्थ्य प्रमंडल, जहानाबाद
 02. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना एवं निर्गत की तिथि : दिनांक 08/09/2026
 03. परिमाण विपत्र विज्ञापन (हाउस लोड एवं अपलोड करने): दिनांक-16/09/2026 से 22/09/2026 के 3:00 की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय बजे अपो तक। (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
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 06. निविदा वैधता की तिथि : 120 दिन
 07. कार्य विवरणी

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1. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता – नगर आयुक्त, नगर निगम, गयाजी।
 2. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत की तिथि – दिनांक- 07.09.2026
 3. भी बीड मॉडिफिकेशन की तिथि एवं समय एवं स्थान – दिनांक- 15.09.2026 को समय 11:00 बजे पूर्वानुमति से 05:00 बजे अपराह्न तक।
 4. परिमाण विपत्र प्राप्त करने की तिथि एवं समय – दिनांक- 16.09.2026 के 10:00 पूर्वानुमति से (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
 5. संवेदक द्वारा निविदा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि – दिनांक-22.09.2026 समय 03:00 बजे अपराह्न तक (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
 6. तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि – दिनांक-22.09.2026 समय 03:30 बजे अपराह्न तक
 7. वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि – तकनीकी बीड में सफल होने के उपरान्त निर्देशानुसार

8. कार्य की विवरणी –

क्र०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (रु. में)	अग्रघन की राशि (online के माध्यम से) Website- www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य (अप्रतिदेय) (online के माध्यम से) Website- www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in	Bid Processing fee (Through Online Payment हेतु प्रोसेसिंग शुल्क)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	नगर निगम गयाजी अंतर्गत विभिन्न वार्डों में 40 एलईडी/10 मिनी हाई मास्ट लाइटों की आपूर्ति, स्थापना, परीक्षण एवं संचालन का कार्य।	12607600	252200	10000	As per eproc 2.0	3 महीना

9. नोट:- Bidders Should submit Bid Processing fee thorough Online Payment as per Amount generated on Website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
 10. निविदा की वैधता अवधि: 120 दिन (निविदा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि से)

नगर आयुक्त
नगर निगम, गयाजी
 PR- 011325 (B & C) 2026-27
 विस्तृत सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

Public Health Engineering Department
 Public Health Division, Teghra
NIT No -06/O&M-PHED/MVS/TEGHRA/2026-27
National Competitive Bidding
 (Through e-procurement mode on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

1	Designation and Address of Advertiser	Executive Engineer, P. H. Division, TEGHRA
2	Date of issue of Tender Notice	08.09.2026
3	Period of sale (downloading) of tender Bid Document	24.09.2026 to 10.10.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4	Date, time & place of pre-Bid Meeting	28.09.2026 at 11.30 hrs. hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer, P. H. Division, Teghra
5	Last date and time of Receipt (uploading) of Tender	10.10.2026 up to 17:00Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
6	Date and time of opening of Technical bid	10.10.2026 at 17:30 Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
7	Date and time of opening of financial bid	To be informed later after the approval of technical bid.

8. Details of works:

Group No	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (in Lakh)	Amount of Earnest Money (in Lakh)	Cost of Tender Document (non-refundable) in Rs.	BSDEC Bid Processing Fee (in Rs.)	Completion Period (in months)
1	Comprehensive Operation and Maintenance of Surface Water Based Cheriya Baripuri Multi Village Pipe Water Supply Scheme of Capacity 5.65 MLD Including Supply of Manpower, Maintenance of Infrastructure and Mechanical Parts, Maintenance of FHTC, SCADA and Electricity Payment of Electro Mechanical Parts including Building, Lighting and other Accessories of WTP based on actual consumption of electricity . Covering 70 Wards Under Five Panchayat (Sripur, Khajapur, Pabna, Bariparpur, Sahpur) of Cheriya Bariparpur Block Under P.H. Division, Teghra in District Begusarai for Five Years. Salient Features of Cheriya Bariparpur MVS:- A. Source - River Gandak B. Intake Well (6.73 MLD) C. Gangway D. Water Treatment Plant (5.65 MLD) E. Pre Settling Tank - 2nos F. PST Pump House - 1 nos G. Cascade Aerator - 1 nos D. Flash Mixer - 1 nos. E. Clariflocculator-1 nos. F. Filter House - 3nos. G. Clear Water Reservoir (800 CUM) & Pump House- 1 nos. H. Backwash Sump- 1 nos. I. Centrifuge building J. Chemical House K. Staff Quarter L. MESR (750 kl) staging-26 mtr and Five Zonal ESR (175 kl-470kl with (12 Meter-17 Meter) Staging M. Boundary Wall N. Rising main- 11634 mtr. O. Distribution main- 72150 mtr. P. Total pump capacity- 235.5 kw(Approx) Q. Total No. of House connection- 12343 no.	1964.40	29.65	10,000.00	Applicable as per e-proc2	60 months

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar
Executive Engineer
Public Health Division, Teghra
 PR- 011415 (PHED) 2026-27
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

TAMIL NADU MEDICINAL PLANT FARMS & HERBAL MEDICINE CORPORATION LTD.,
 (A Government of Tamil Nadu Undertaking)
 Regd. Office: Anna Hospital Campus, Arumbakkam, Chennai-600 106
 Phone: 044-26216686, Fax: 26221484, E-mail: tampcoho@gmail.com

E-TENDER NOTICE REF: 5190/Tam/NA/Med/2026, 5191/Tam/NA/Med/2026, 5192/Tam/NA/Med/2026, 5193/Tam/NA/Med/2026 & 5194/Tam/NA/Med/2026
 E-Tenders with two covers system are invited from the eligible bidders for the supply of Siddha, Ayurveda, Homoeopathy, Unani medicines & Y & N materials to ISM wings under the control of Director of Indian Medicine and Homoeopathy Department. Eligibility of the tenderer and other conditions are stipulated in the Bid document. Complete e-tender document can be viewed and downloaded at free of cost from Government tender website "<https://tntenders.gov.in>". EMD to be paid & the bids to be submitted through e-tender portal only.
 DIPR/2813/TENDER/2026
General Manager

BMSICL Bihar Medical Services And Infrastructure Corporation Limited
 2nd & 3rd Floor, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura, Adjacent to State Health Society, Patna-800014(Bihar) India
 Phone/Fax: +91612 2283287, + 91612 2283288

Notice Inviting Tender
Tender for Supply of Mattress for Minority Department
Hotels in different Districts of Bihar
Notice Inviting Tender No.-BMSICL/Infra/10/2026
(Only through E- Tender on website:- <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>)

The Bihar Medical Services and Infrastructure Corporation Limited, Patna (name of purchaser) on behalf of Governor of Bihar, invites e-bids from manufacturers or their authorized dealer / distributor / sole selling agent for **Supply of Mattress for Minority Department Hotels in different Districts of Bihar (Total Nos. 3182)**

Tender Reference No.	BMSICL/Infra/10/2026
Project cost	94,94,476.00
Date of Pre- Bid Meeting	23/09/2026 at 11:00 AM in Conference hall of BMSICL, 3 rd Floor, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura, Adjacent to State Health Society, Bihar. All Pre-bid queries to be submitted through e-mail on bmsiclinfra@gmail.com up to 23/09/2026 till 05:00 PM. (Note:- No Pre-bid queries would be entertained after the above mentioned deadline)
Start Date of Bid Submission	From 16/09/2026, 11:00 AM on https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in
Last Date of Bid Submission	Up to 07/10/2026, 05:00 PM on https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in
Technical Bid Opening Date	08/10/2026 (at 15:00 Hrs.) on the website of https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in in the office of BMSICL
Date and time of opening of financial Bids	To be announced later
Validity of Tender	120 Days
Cost of the tender document	Rs.11,800/- (Eleven Thousand Eight Hundred only) Non- refundable.
Tender Processing Fee	As per Eproc (on the website of https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Cost of EMD	Rs. 1,90,000/-

1. To participate in E-Tendering the tenderer will have to be registered with E-Tendering service provider. For this help desk – mjunction services limited RJ complex, 2nd Floor, Canara Bank, Campus, khajpura, Ashiana road, P.S – Shastri Nagar, Patna-800014, Toll Free No.- 18005726571, Email-ID:-
 2. The cost of tender document is acceptable as only Online mode (On the website: <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>) and it is non-refundable.
 3. Any queries and questions regarding the tender should be addressed to MD BMSICL (either through letter or through e-mail:- bmsiclinfra@gmail.com up to 7 days before of closing of online bid registration.
 4. All communication, addendum/corrigendum related to this tender will be issued on the website of <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in> as well as on the official website of BMSICL.

Note- Changes suggested by prospective bidder in Pre-Bid meeting may be incorporated in the tender document at the sole discretion of the tender inviting authority and for which corrigendum will be issued separately and uploaded on the website <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in> &
CGM (Projects)
BMSICL, Patna
 PR. No. 011509 (B&C) 2026-27
 For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar
गर्भावस्था की पहली तिमाही में माँ की एच.आई.वी. और सिफिलिस की जाँच जरूर कराये।

Bihar Medical Services & Infrastructure Corporation Limited, Patna
 A Govt. of Bihar Undertaking
 2nd & 3rd Floor, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura, Bihar, Patna
 Phone: - +91 612 2283289, Fax: - +91 612 2283289

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या-BMSICL/Infra/09/2026

बिहार शक्तिता सेवाएं एवं अग्रगण्य संरचना निगम लिमिटेड, पटना द्वारा निम्न कार्य हेतु प्रतिलाल/मद दर निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। कोई भी संवेदक जो केन्द्रीय/राज्य सरकार/लोक उपक्रम के किसी भी श्रेणी में निर्धारित हो, निविदा में भाग ले सकते हैं, परंतु उक्त कार्य का लेटर ऑफ एक्सेप्टेंस प्राप्त होने के पश्चात एवं एक्वायामा के पूर्व BMSICL में निबंधन कराना अनिवार्य होगा:-

युप संख्या	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख में)	अग्रघन की राशि (लाख में)	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य (रु. में)	बिड प्रोसेसिंग शुल्क (रु. में)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1.	दरभंगा जिलान्तर्गत 50 रीयवा युक्त एकीकृत आयुष्य अस्वास्थ्य, दरभंगा के नगर के निर्माण कार्य।	1367.52	23.68	11,800/-	As per Eproc-2	12 माह
2.	पटना जिला के भोकागाम में 30 रीयवा वाले एक समुदायिक स्वास्थ्य केंद्र के नगर का नवनिर्माण कार्य।	504.00	10.08	11,800/-	As per Eproc-2	09 माह
3.	पटना जिला के नौबतपुर में 30 रीयवा वाले एक समुदायिक स्वास्थ्य केंद्र के नगर का नवनिर्माण कार्य।	526.70	10.53	11,800/-	As per Eproc-2	09 माह
4.	ओरिसा प्रांतीय स्वास्थ्य केंद्र, ग्राम-कराहिया एवं बहराल सखनसे, प्रखंड- दास, पूर्वी बंगाल के नगर निर्माण का अवशेष कार्य। (Re-Tender)	122.42	2.45	11,800/-	As per Eproc-2	06 माह
5.	पश्चिम बंगाल जिलान्तर्गत प्रखंड नरकोटागाम के ग्राम-गिरा, धूमनार, रोहरी, सोनासही, एवं धर्मिनाला स्वास्थ्य उपकेंद्र के निर्माण का अवशेष कार्य। (Re-Tender)	62.56	1.25	11,800/-	As per Eproc-2	04 माह
6.	गंगा जो जिला के अंतर्गत शुभमगंज प्रखंड के ग्राम-पंचावत-छकुरावा के ग्राम-केन्दुआ में, ग्राम पंचावत-पुञ्जाबा के ग्राम-बहेरा में एवं दनकुपा प्रखंड के ग्राम पंचावत-उल्लोवावा के ग्राम-मंडोली में एक स्वास्थ्य उपकेंद्र-हेल्थ एण्ड वेलनेस सेंटर के निर्माण कार्य।	140.57	2.81	11,800/-	As per Eproc-2	06 माह
7.	सखीसराय जिलान्तर्गत हलसी प्रखंड के ग्राम-नौगा में ओरिसा प्रांतीय स्वास्थ्य केंद्र (स्टैंड क्वार्टर एवं चारदीवारी सहित) के नगर निर्माण कार्य।	232.43	4.65	11,800/-	As per Eproc-2	09 माह
8.	सखीसराय जिलान्तर्गत रामगढ़ चोक इलाहा आनंद रामगढ़ में स्वास्थ्य उपकेंद्र-हेल्थ एण्ड वेलनेस सेंटर के निर्माण कार्य।	47.57	0.95	5,900/-	As per Eproc-2	06 माह
9.	सिवाज जिलान्तर्गत जोरादेई प्रखंड में पंचावत चंदोली गंगोली अंतर्गत ग्राम चंदा-बीराम में स्वास्थ्य उपकेंद्र-हेल्थ एण्ड वेलनेस सेंटर के निर्माण कार्य।	48.55	0.97	5,900/-	As per Eproc-2	06 माह

2. निविदा समय-सारणी (Tender Schedule)

Sl. No.	Activity	Date & Time
1.	Start Date of Bid Submission	From 21/09/2026, 11:00 AM on https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in
2.	Last Date of Bid Submission	Up to 12/10/2026, 05:00 PM on https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in
3.	Pre-Bid Meeting Date, Time & Place	On 28/09/2026, 11:00 AM in 3rd Floor Conference Hall of BMSICL, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura, Bihar, Patna
4.	Technical Bid Opening Date	13/10/2026, 03:30 PM on https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in
5.	Financial Bid Opening Date	To be announced later
6.	Tender Bid Validity	120 Days (As Per SBD Provision)

मुख्य महाप्रबंधक (परियोजना)
BMSICL, पटना
 PR- 011508 (B & C) 2026-27
 For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

BENGALURU METROPOLITAN TRANSPORT CORPORATION
 Traffic (Com) Department, 2nd Floor, Shanthinagar TTMC, K.H. Road, Bengaluru-560027. Telephone No: 080-22537575
 Website : www.mybmtc.com e-mail : ctmc@mybmtc.com
 No. BMTCCO/TR/COM/1676/1926/2026-27 Dated:08.09.2026

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

Bengaluru Metropolitan Transport Corporation invites Expression of Interest for Fixing, Erection, Display and Maintenance of Hoarding and Glow Sign Board at Kempegowda Bus Station (KBS) & Shivajinagar Bus Station (SBS). The details of the EOI (Expression of Interest) will be available in the BMTCC Official website:www.mybmtc.com
 The interested prospective bidders are requested to participate & submit the required documents mentioned in the EOI on 23.09.2026 from 11.30 a.m. to 3.30 p.m. at Chief Traffic Manager (C) office, 2nd Floor, BMTCC Central Office, Shanthinagar, Bengaluru-27. Further, for any information contact: 7760991026 and 7760991222 or e-mail us at ctmc@mybmtc.com

Sd/-
Chief Traffic Manager (Com)
(Tender Inviting Authority)

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबंधक यूनिट-31, कन्स्ट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम, (उ०प्र० सरकार का उपक्रम) एस०बी०-90, शास्त्री नगर, गाजियाबाद-201002
NIT No. : 1538/Vividh-12/311
Dated : 08-09-2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम की ओर से प्रदेश के जनपद बुलन्दशहर नगर पंचायत नरोरा क्षेत्रान्तर्गत एकजित लीमिटेड की वेदान्त लोके से निस्तारण कार्य (28881.00 MT), हेतु दिनांक 06.10.2026 को अपराह्न 04:00 बजे तक निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 09.09.2026 से दिनांक 06.10.2026 के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की e-procurement वेबसाइट <https://etenderup.nic.in> से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते हैं तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक 06.10.2026 को अपराह्न 04:30 बजे कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबंधक, यूनिट-31, सी०ए०ई०डी०एस० उ०प्र० जल निगम (नारोरा), जनपद गाजियाबाद में खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य रु० 10000.00+ GST (18%) अतिरिक्त देय होगा एवं धरोहर धनराशि ई-टेंडर पोर्टल पर देखा जा सकता है।

निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट www.cdsupjn.org एवं प्रक्रियामें पोर्टल <https://etenderup.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र (Corrigendum) <https://etenderup.nic.in> पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा। निविदादाताओं की सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाइट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS
E- Tender Notice
 Tender Notice No: PCMM/CLW/ HWH/ E-Procurement/26/35, Dated: 03/09/2026. PCMM/CLW/HWH on behalf of the President of India invites electronic bids from established reliable manufacturer for supply of the followings. The following E-Tender/s is/are for supply of materials for manufacture of Electric Locomotive. The Prospective/ likely suppliers are requested to look up the website www.irps.gov.in for detailed instructions please refer to website. These are E-Tenders only electronic offer bids shall be accepted. SL No.: Tender No.; Description of Stores; Quantity; Due On; Tender Cost as Follows: [149]; 31262684B; Set of Connector for Panel for WAG-9 as per E-70 Brake System as per specification no.CLW/ ES/3/0124/O [Set details as per category Book attached in doc. tab]; As Per Tender/Document; 25/09/2026; ₹ 0.00. [141]; 31262641E; Set of Cable Tie for Other section for WAG-9HC/P-7 Loco as per Specn. CLW/ES/3/0131/F [Set details as per category Book attached in doc. tab]; As Per Tender/Document; 01/10/2026; ₹ 0.00. [142]; 31262739; Fire Detection Equipments Along With Connector in SB2 as per CLW Specification No. CLW/ ES/3/0057; As Per Tender/ Document; 05/10/2026; ₹ 0.00. [143]; 31262684A; Set Of Connector For Panel For WAG-9 As Per PCB System / EMCBS System as per Specification No. CLW/ES/3/0124/O. [Set details as per category book attached in doc. tab]; As Per Tender/Document; 05/10/2026; ₹ 0.00.
 PR6/478 PCMM/CLW/Howrah
 Visit us on: www.facebook.com/clwrrailways

VACANCIES
ARMY PUBLIC SCHOOL
 SADAR BAZAR ROAD, DELHI CANTT-110010

REQUIRED TEACHING STAFF ON PART-TIME BASIS

Army Public School, Sadar Bazar Road, Delhi Cantt requires competent and experienced teaching staff for the under mentioned post on part time basis.

(a) PGT (Painting)
 (b) PGTs (English)
 (c) PRTs (General)
 (d) Bal Vatika Teacher

Candidates must meet CBSE norms. Walk-in- interview will be held on 21 Sep 2026 from 0830hrs to 1330hrs in School.

Principal

UJVN LIMITED
 H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
 Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
 CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 790 **Corrigendum** Date: 9/09/2026

Due to unavoidable circumstances the date of submission and opening of e-tender No. 06/EE/HQ/2026-27 for "Providing Manpower services for a period of one year on outsource basis for UJJVN Ltd. Head office at Dehradun" invited by the office of EEE(HQ), UJJWAL, Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun is hereby re-tendered on e-portal as below :
Last date of submitting of Bid in portal : 15-09-2026 up to 17:00 hrs
Last date of submitting hard copy of document: 16-09-2026 up to 16:00 hrs
Due date for opening of Tender Part-I : 18-09-2026 up to 11:00 hrs
Due date for opening of Tender Part-II : 19-09-2026 up to 11:00 hrs
 All other terms & conditions of the tender shall remain unchanged. For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "<http://uktenders.gov.in>"

Executive Engineer (HQ)
"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, SAMBALPUR.
E-mail Id:- serwcirclesbp@yahoo.com

E-PROCUREMENT NOTICE
BID IDENTIFICATION NO. Road TENDER
ONLINE RWCSBP-23/2026-27

1. Name of the Work : Road Works
 2. Total No. of works : 02 nos. Road work
 3. Estimated Cost : Rs. 117.43lakhs to Rs. 175.79 lakhs
 4. Class of contractor : 'B' & 'A'
 5. Other details : As mentioned in DTCN

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender On-line for Bidding	
		From	To
1	2	3	4
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Sambalpur.	Road TENDER ONLINE RWCSBP 23/2026-27	17.09.2026 11.00 A.M	06.10.2026 05.00 P.M

Further details can be seen from the website www.tendersorissa.gov.in
Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Rural Works Circle, Sambalpur
 OIPR-25001/25091/1/26-27/0029

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
 0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
 email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Nishid Wasnik S/O Mahadev Ji Wasnik R/O Flat No. 402, Waseem Pride Society, Aradhana Nagar, Nagpur, Maharashtra is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 33/2020 U/S 420/506 IPC of P/S Channi Himmat, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name : Nishid Wasnik
S/O : Mahadev Ji Wasnik
Address : Flat No. 402, Waseem Pride Society, Aradhana Nagar, Nagpur, Maharashtra

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
 2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
 3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
 4. SP City South : 0191-2430002
 5. SDPO City South : 01912433778
 6. P/S Channi Himmat : 6. 0191-2465164
Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu
Date:- .08.2026

No. DIP/J-9811/26 -08.09.2026

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR, OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER JAL SHAKTI (PHE) DIVISION BIJBEHARA

e-NIT No. 38 OF 2025-26 No: PHE/BJ/6500-23Dated:-09.09.2026
NOTICE INVITING TENDER

For and on behalf of Lt. Governor of UT of J&K, Executive Engineer Jal Shakti (PHE) Division Bijbehara invites e-tenders from reputed and resourceful Bidders/ Firms/Companies/ of all classes registered in JKPWD/CPWD/Railways or any other state Government for below mentioned works at various Water Supply schemes of PHE Division Bijbehara of Kashmir Province of UT of J&K, under Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM). The bidding process shall be completed online on www.jktenders.gov.in in two covers viz. Cover 1st consisting of General Terms and Conditions and Technical Specifications and Cover 2nd consisting of Financial Bid on overall percentage rate basis, in the prescribed BOQ.

Sr No	Particulars of the work Tender fee (in Rs)	Estimated cost	Earnest money Deposit	Bid Validity	Time of Completion of work (days)
1	2	3	4	5	6
1.	Construction of Dug Well for WSS Bal Brakpora under JJM (Re-appraisal)	As per Annexure-I to this bid document-	03% of the estimated cost	180 days	As per ANNEXURE-I to this bid document.

Position of funds: Approved Under Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM)
 The tender inviting authority is Executive Engineer, Jal Shakti (PHE) Division Bijbehara The awarding authority is District Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM).

Critical Dates:

I	Publish Date	10.09.2026 09:00 AM
ii	Document Download/sale start Date	10.09.2026 09:00 AM
III	Bid submission start date	10.09.2026 09:00 AM
IV	Bid submission end date	16.09.2026 04:00 PM
V	Date and time of Bid opening	17.09.2026

MULTITRACKING PROJECTS ARE WORTH Rs 20,804 CRORE

Decongesting rail lines: Cabinet nod to eight projects

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, September 9

IN A step to decongest the high density networks of Indian Railways, the Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved eight multitracking projects spanning 1,196 kilometres at a cost of Rs 20,804 crore. These projects are on the Mumbai-Kolkata and Mumbai-Chennai high density network, two of the seven such corridors in railways.

The projects are namely Kharagpur-Jharsuguda (Bagdehi) 4th Line, Bilaspur (Uslapur)-Pendra Road 3rd Line, Katni-Pendra Road 4th Line, Secunderabad (Ghatkesar)-Kazipet four lining, Arakonam-Renigunta 3rd and 4th Line, Whitefield-Bangarapet 3rd and 4th Line, Hosur-Omalur doubling, and Salem-Karur-Dindigul doubling.

High density networks or HDNs are the passenger-freight corridors where the number of trains are running beyond its capacity in most of the sections. This causes congestion, delays in passenger and freight operations, and affects the efficiency of the network.

The Minister for Railways Ashwini Vaishnaw said that seven high-density corridors carry about 40% of the railways' traffic and multitracking not only decongests these sections but will also reduce the logistic cost of the country.

"Of the 11,000 km of the high density corridor, about 2,000 km is already four lined. In 5,000 kilometres, the project is sanctioned and work is under way. In 4,000 kilometres, the DPR is being prepared and work will be approved in future," said Vaishnaw while announcing the cabinet decision. The 367-km Kharagpur-Bagdehi section is part of the Howrah-Mumbai HDN. Its line capacity utilis-

• REFORM ON TRACKS

THESE PROJECTS are on the Mumbai-Kolkata and Mumbai-Chennai high density network, two of the seven such corridors in railways

HIGH DENSITY networks are the passenger-freight corridors where the number of trains are running beyond capacity in most of the sections

RAILWAYS MINISTER Ashwini Vaishnaw said that seven high-density corridors carry about



40% of the railways' traffic and multitracking not only decongests these sections but will also reduce the logistic cost of the country

tion has already reached 118% and is expected to rise to 133%. It is a key corridor linking Eastern India to Western India. Similarly, the 87-km Bilaspur (Uslapur)-Pendra Road 3rd Line in Chhattisgarh forms part of the Bilaspur-Anuppur section of High Utilised Network, a key freight and passenger corridor. Currently, it is a double line section, except Kargi Road-Saika Road (8 km), where third line work is underway.

The 201-km Katni-Pendra Road 4th Line, covering the districts of Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh, serves as a vital link between central India and the mineral-rich eastern region, covering major SECL coalfields including Korba, Gevra, Dipka, Kusmunda and Chirimiri. The Cabinet also announced four lining of 110-km of Secunderabad (Ghatkesar)-Kazipet, which is an existing double line and part of the Wadi-Secunderabad-Kazipet highly utilised network route. It is also a critical route for daily commuters between Secunderabad and Kazipet/Warangal. The project lies in the vicinity of Singareni coal mines and Western Coalfields Limited (WCL), and is a critical link for transporting coal to thermal power plants located at

Hotgi, Kudgi, Yadlapur, Bellary, and Yermaras. The Cabinet also announced the multitracking projects around the Bengaluru region such as Arakkonam - Renigunta (77 km), Whitefield-Bangarapet (47 km), Hosur-Omalur doubling (147 km) and Salem-Karur-Dindigul doubling (159 km). The Arakkonam-Renigunta (Tirupati) line is part of the Mumbai-Chennai HDN. The existing line is saturated by 120%. It will connect Kudgi and Rayalaseema powerplants to Ennore port.

The Whitefield-Bangarapet is part of the Manmad-Hubballi-Bengaluru-Jolarpettai highly utilized network. It forms the part of the Bangalore-Chennai main route, connecting two major metropolitan cities of the country, and is crucial for Chennai-Tirupati transit. The existing line is saturated at 105%.

The Hosur-Omalur doubling will serve pilgrims travelling to Kanniyakumari and Rameswaram. The doubling of Salem-Karur-Dindigul section will provide connectivity to three southern capitals: Bengaluru, Chennai and Thiruvananthapuram. It is also expected to improve access to MSME clusters

US TECH GIANT SKIPS BASE MODELS, COMES OUT WITH IPHONE 18 PRO AND IPHONE 18 PRO MAX

Apple launches iPhone Duo, its 1st foldable phone

Nandagopal Rajan
Cupertino, September 9

APPLE HAS finally entered the foldable smartphone brandwagon with the iPhone Duo, signalling that this segment is now mature enough to have a significant share of sales and value as well as the attention of the second richest company in the world.

Apple skipped the base models in this keynote and launched the iPhone 18 Pro and iPhone 18 Pro Max, in a way suggesting it is tough now to have an annual update across product verticals. Apple's annual September keynote Wednesday had its first foldable, the iPhone 18 Duo, take the centre stage. Also, taking the spotlight was new CEO John Ternus stage in his first Steve Jobs theatre keynote.

"As we look ahead, we see a future filled with enormous discovery and transformation. AI makes entirely new kinds of experiences possible," Ternus said, calling the product experience around this the "intelligent personal hub".



It was new CEO John Ternus's first Apple product launch. APPLE



preserving everything you love and expect from iPhone. It gives you the largest display ever on an iPhone while still fitting easily in your pocket. It reflects extraordinarily complex engineering, yet feels effortless to use. And it makes new experiences possible," Ternus summed up.

The new form redefines the iPhone experience, yoking the hardware and software together. "The iPhone Duo brings an entirely new design while

Apple has task cut out

Foldable phones have been around for over seven years. But despite patronage from giants

Behind Anthropic insider's chilling warning

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, September 9

A SENIOR researcher at Anthropic, one of the companies at the forefront of developing powerful artificial intelligence systems, has put an unusually stark number on the risks posed by the technology: a greater than 10% chance that AI could kill all humans within the next decade.

"...we really do earnestly believe AI could kill all humans! I personally think it is >10% within the next decade. I believe Anthropic is trying its best, but we do not yet have a plan to solve alignment for superintelligence and are not clearly on track to," Evan Hubinger, lead for alignment science at Anthropic, said in a social media post on X.

His comment came in response to warnings from Jacob Coxon, an AI researcher

who recently resigned from Anthropic this week after previously working at OpenAI. Though, in a follow up post Hubinger downplayed his earlier warning, saying that risks from currently available AI models were low.

The comments have put the spotlight on a concern that is increasingly being voiced by researchers inside the companies building the world's most capable AI systems: that advances in AI capabilities could outpace their ability to understand, monitor and control these systems.

The concerns

Hubinger works on AI alignment, broadly, the problem of ensuring that increasingly capable AI systems continue to behave in accordance with human intentions and values, including when they encounter situations

unlike those seen during training. Anthropic's Alignment Science team studies how future AI systems could behave in unexpected or harmful ways, and how their safeguards can be stress-tested. Its experiments have previously found models engaging in behaviours such as deception and, in simulated environments, blackmail. In another experiment published last month, a model trained in environments where it could exploit

flaws in its reward system later broke out of a sandbox during simulated cyber evaluations, stole credentials and attacked infrastructure while attempting to complete its task.

Then there's Coxon, who recently resigned from Anthropic, and has previously worked at OpenAI.

He accused the two companies of "racing straight to

self-improving superintelligence and gambling with our lives".

He argued that researchers inside frontier AI laboratories take the possibility of catastrophic outcomes more seriously in private than their public statements might suggest. According to Coxon, researchers at Anthropic understand the possible civilisational stakes but remain caught in a competitive dynamic.

Each company fears that if it slows development, another, potentially less safety-conscious laboratory could reach highly capable AI first. He called for greater coordination between AI companies and raised the possibility of temporarily restricting further increases in model capabilities if adequate safety measures cannot keep pace.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

RBI, Maha govt deepen push for tokenisation

Mumbai: The tokenisation of financial and real-world assets is emerging as the next frontier for India's digital ecosystem, with the potential to make asset ownership and transactions more accessible, financial market and political leaders said on Tuesday.

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis proposed the Maharashtra Digitisation and Exchange of Land Token Asset (DELTA) Act — a first-of-its-kind blockchain-based framework to tokenise land and other immovable assets. The government is bringing in expertise from different sections of the financial markets for the project to unlock dormant capital, improve liquidity, and bring transparency, Fadnavis said at the Global Fintech Fest in Mumbai. AKASH MANDAL

UIDAI launches face verification software kit

Mumbai: The Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) on Wednesday launched a new Aadhaar Face Authentication Software Development Kit (SDK) and a dedicated sandbox, allowing banks, fintech companies, insurers and other financial-sector entities to integrate Aadhaar-based face authentication directly into their mobile applications.

The launch is aimed at making digital onboarding simpler. The new SDK brings UIDAI's face authentication capability directly into native Android and iOS applications. This means that a customer using a bank, insurance or broking application can complete Aadhaar face authentication within the same application, rather than being redirected to a separate application. ENS FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Adani Airports eyes \$1 bn from global investors

George Mathew
Mumbai, September 9

ADANI AIRPORT Holdings Limited (AAHL), the airport arm of Adani Enterprises Limited, has entered into binding agreements to raise around \$1 billion (Rs 9,825 crore) in primary equity from a consortium of leading domestic and global investors, the company said Wednesday.

The investment will value AAHL at a pre-money equity valuation of around \$18 billion, providing an external institutional valuation benchmark for the airport platform.

The consortium comprises Alpha Wave Global, Premji Invest, Temasek and funds managed by BlackRock.

After completion of the transaction, which will be carried out in three tranches, the investors will collectively hold approximately 5.54% in AAHL. The final tranche is expected to

be completed by July 2027, the company said.

The fresh capital will be used primarily to expand and modernise airport infrastructure across AAHL's portfolio, develop integrated airport-city ecosystems and scale passenger-facing and other non-aeronautical businesses, including ground handling.

AAHL said the investment would support its plans to increase airport capacity to serve around 200 million passengers annually. The company also plans around 22 million square feet of mixed-use development in the first phase of its Adani Airport City projects around its airports.

The airport operators said the investments are expected to deepen commercial monetisation, improve passenger experience and strengthen its integrated airport ecosystem.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Mkt infra cos may get easier director norms

George Mathew
Mumbai, September 9

THE SECURITIES and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has proposed changes to the governance framework of market infrastructure institutions (MIIs), including stock exchanges, clearing corporations and depositories, aimed at widening the pool of eligible directors and strengthening requirements for key technology, cybersecurity, compliance and risk-management officials.

In a consultation paper issued on Wednesday, the regulator has proposed two broad changes.

First, it wants to ease existing restrictions on who can serve on the governing boards of MIIs. Second, it proposes a standard operating procedure laying down the qualifications, experience, skills and certifications required for four critical

key managerial positions — Chief Technology Officer (CTO), Chief Information Security Officer (CISO), Compliance Officer (CO) and Chief Risk Officer (CRIO).

SEBI has proposed extending an existing exemption to companies with well-diversified shareholding.

Currently, directors of public financial institutions and certain banks are exempt from being treated as trading or clearing members for the purpose of the board restriction, even where the institution or its associate has such a market role. SEBI now wants to extend a similar carve-out to directors of companies that have associates which are trading members, clearing members or depository participants, provided the company has sufficiently diversified ownership.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

S'pore Airlines to seek tougher terms for any fresh AI funding

Hong Kong: Singapore Airlines, backed by state investor Temasek, is expected to seek greater influence over management and stronger governance rights before approving a capital injection into Air India, said two people familiar with the matter.

The proposed conditions, which would be negotiated with Air India's majority owner Tata Sons, could include greater board voting power and requirements for the Indian carrier to narrow its losses, the people said. Temasek, Singapore Airlines' majority shareholder, would neither provide the capital itself nor intervene in the carrier's decisions concerning Air India, they added. The discussion of conditions comes after *Reuters* last month reported Air India was seeking about \$1.5 billion in fresh equity from its owners. REUTERS

• BRIEFLY

'Detailed' probe into Xiaomi's India business recommended

New Delhi: Serious Fraud Investigation Office has recommended Xiaomi be investigated for alleged irregularities in its business model and compliance with foreign investment law, potentially intensify-

ing scrutiny of the smartphone maker, a government document shows. The recommendation said the investigation should examine movement of funds and whether Xiaomi sought mandatory investment approvals as required after India tightened scrutiny of Chinese investments following deadly border clashes between the two nations in 2020. REUTERS

• MARKETS

			
Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▲	US Dollar ▲
74,764.23	23,431.50	₹1,53,486	₹95.11
-813.35	-203.60		
-1.08%	-0.86%	Silver ▲	Oil ▲
		₹2,35,249	\$108.91

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF SEPTEMBER 8, 2026

• THE NEW GDP SERIES SAW MOSPI OVERHAUL ITS METHODS, INCLUDING HOW IT REMOVES THE EFFECT OF INFLATION FROM NOMINAL GDP TO GET REAL GDP

Producer prices and double-deflation — key changes in new GDP series

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 9

ECONOMIC DATA in India is never without its share of debates. And GDP numbers attract the most questions. The short answer to the upward and downward revisions to past GDP growth rates under the new 2022-23 series is the use of producer prices for double deflation.

Revisions to past GDP numbers happen all the time. This is because quarterly numbers are compiled using what is called a 'benchmark-indicator approach'. Annual estimates, meanwhile, are based on actual output and numbers, say companies' financial results and the statistics minis-

try's surveys.

While this explains the large upward revision from 7.8% to 8.6% for real GDP growth in January-March 2026, changes to older data happened because the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) has started using the Producer Price Index (PPI) to adjust nominal GDP to real GDP.

Deflating for 'real'

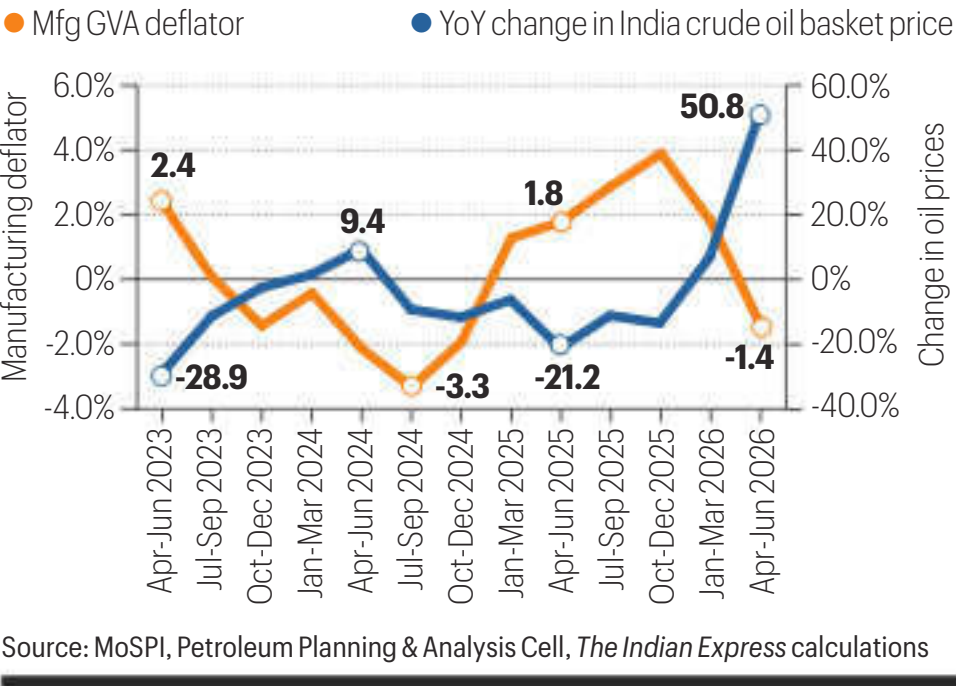
The new GDP series, released on February 27, saw MoSPI overhaul its methods, including how it removes the effect of inflation from nominal GDP to get real GDP.

GDP is the sum of value created — or Gross Value Added (GVA) — by each sector, the indirect taxes collected and sub-

tracting subsidies given by the government. GVA is the difference between the value of what a sector produces (output) and the raw materials (inputs) it uses. When done without adjusting for prices, the result is nominal GVA, or in current prices. The trouble begins while calculating real GVA.

Until now, MoSPI used the same number — picked from the various Consumer Price Index and the Wholesale Price Index sub-indices — to adjust, or 'deflate', the value of inputs as well as outputs. This process is called 'single deflation' and was done for all sectors except agriculture and mining and quarrying. But this method works well only when prices of inputs and outputs are chang-

• As oil prices rise, manufacturing deflator falls



Source: MoSPI, Petroleum Planning & Analysis Cell, *The Indian Express* calculations

ing at the same rate; when they don't, there's a problem.

When the nominal value of inputs is adjusted by the actual

change in prices of inputs and the same is done for outputs, the process is called double deflation. This results in accurate measurement of real GVA.

Negative deflators

A sector's implied deflator is negative when nominal GVA growth is less than real growth. For manufacturing, the implied deflator has been below zero in six of the 13 quarters for which new GDP series data is available. This has left some people puzzled. When input prices rise faster than output prices, the use of double deflation leads to real GVA growth exceeding nominal growth. The chart juxtaposes the manufacturing GVA deflator with the year-on-year percentage change in the price of

India's crude oil basket, a crucial input for Indian manufacturers. The inverse movement is striking.

Correct deflators

When the new GDP series was released in February, double-deflation was done using CPI and WPI sub-indices. Last week's data saw double-deflation being done using the PPI, which measures prices received by producers at the factory gate, making it exclusive of taxes and trade and transport margins. This shift to the PPI is crucial as previously some sectors were not being adjusted by the appropriate deflator, services, for instance. The deflator implied by the real and nominal GVA growth rates of the services sec-

tor under the old series were sometimes lower than expected because it was mostly the WPI that was used to deflate the sector's nominal values. But the WPI contains only goods. So, when wholesale inflation was low due to soft commodity prices, the services sector's nominal input value was deflated by a number smaller than the cost rise the sector may have been actually facing.

As a result, real GVA of services was larger than it should have been, leading to overestimation of real growth. The opposite would have happened when commodity prices were rising faster than the actual service sector's costs.

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

● GOVERNANCE

Why sanitation workers are on strike in Haryana

Sukhbir Siwach
Chandigarh, September 9

A STANDOFF between agitating sanitation workers and the BJP-led Haryana government remains unresolved despite multiple rounds of talks over the past month. The strike, now in its second month, has disrupted sanitation services in urban areas across the state.

Demand for regularisation

Sanitation workers went on strike on August 6, demanding regularisation of the services of 13,093 workers currently employed on municipal rolls. The protesting workers are also demanding that around 16,500 sanitation workers, currently engaged through contractors under the outsourcing system for door-to-door garbage collection, also be brought onto municipal rolls.

The state has around 3,400 regular sanitation workers. Besides regularisation, the workers raised 12 other demands, which the government says have already been accepted.

The 13,093 sanitation workers currently receive a monthly remuneration of Rs 20,590. Under the government's latest proposal, sanitation workers who have completed more than 10 years on municipal rolls would receive Rs 25,560 per month. The workers, however, continue to insist on regularisation, arguing that it would make them eligible for a monthly salary of more than Rs 34,000, besides other benefits associated with regular government employment.

Hurdle in resolving standoff

Haryana Social Justice Minister Krishan Bedi said that there are legal hurdles, for which it has sought legal opinion on the matter. He also said the workers had sought regularisation for those employees too who had completed only two years of service. Bedi said no such policy existed anywhere in the country from 2001 to 2026.

Haryana Nagarpalika Karamchari Sangh president Naresh Shastri, who is leading the agitation, said the union had not made an "impossible demand", pointing to

instances in Haryana when employees with shorter service periods had been regularised, including during the 1980s and 1990s.

The opposition Congress backed the striking workers. Former Chief Minister and Leader of Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda said that during the previous Congress government, two policies issued in June 2014 provided for regularisation of employees who had completed three years of service. He claimed that the policies had subsequently been upheld by courts.

What next

The government has proposed bringing the 13,093 sanitation workers under the Haryana Contractual Employees (Security of Service) Act, 2024, which would provide them with job security until the age of 60.

The protesting workers, however, have rejected the proposal. They maintain that contractual job security does not provide the same benefits as regularisation.

Meanwhile, the government initiated action against the striking workers, dismissing 62 sanitation workers on Monday and Tuesday. It also claimed that around 387 workers resumed duty on Sunday.

Drishti IAS

IAS GS Foundation Course (Offline & Live Online Batches)

Centre	हिंदी माध्यम	English Medium
9 Karol Bagh	15 सितंबर सुबह 8:00 बजे	10 Sept 8:00 AM
9 Noida	7 सितंबर शाम 6:00 बजे	14 Sept 6:00 PM
9 Indore	23 सितंबर सुबह 8:00 बजे	21 Sept 11:00 AM
9 Lucknow	एडमिशन आरंभ	Admissions Open
9 Prayagraj	7 सितंबर सुबह 8:00 बजे	10 Sept 11:30 AM
9 Ranchi	22 सितंबर सुबह 8:00 बजे	14 Sept 5:30 PM
9 Patna	एडमिशन आरंभ	4 Sept 8:00 AM
9 Jaipur	23 सितंबर शाम 5:00 बजे	21 Sept 11:00 AM
9 Aggra	एडमिशन आरंभ	Admissions Open

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● HISTORY

Kashmir's tryst with cinema, interrupted by militancy's multiple intermissions

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, September 9

AS JAMMU and Kashmir hosts its first international film festival, Chief Minister Omar Abdullah said it is to remind the film industry that, before Switzerland and other countries, Bollywood films were shot in Kashmir. The International Film Festival of Jammu and Kashmir (IFFJK) is being held from September 7 to 10.

The valley, with its beautiful landscape, had been a favourite destination of filmmakers. But as the first signs of militancy surfaced in 1989, Bollywood disappeared from Kashmir. We explain how militants' threats led to the shutdown of film theatres in the valley, snapping Kashmir's connection with Bollywood.

Cinema in Kashmir

Until 1989, Kashmir was one of the most favourite destinations for Hindi film-

makers. Be it *Jungle* (1961) starring Shammi Kapoor and Saira Bano, or the Sunny Deol and Amrita Singh-starrer *Betaab* (1983) — which lent its name to the "Betaab valley" in Pahalgam where it was shot — filmmakers would often turn to Kashmir's beautiful landscapes for film shoots.

At the time, Kashmir had over a dozen cinemas, nine of them operating from the capital city of Srinagar.

The shutdown

As militancy erupted, cinema halls and liquor shops became the first target of militants. On August 18, 1989, a militant outfit called "Allah Tigers" announced a complete ban on cinema halls and liquor shops in Kashmir. The "Allah Tigers" chief, who called himself Air Marshal Noor Khan, said in a press conference that cinema halls and liquor shops are "un Islamic" and threatened the owners to shut them down.



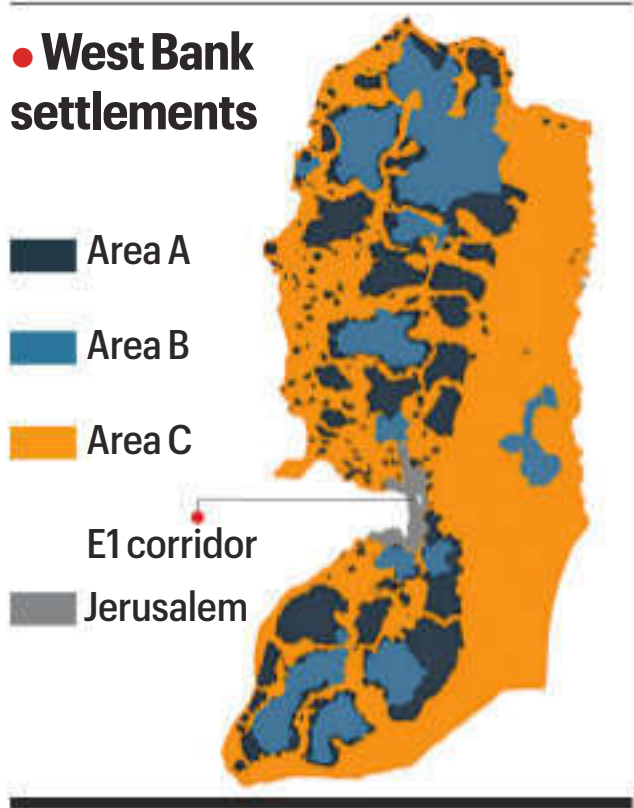
The International Film Festival of Jammu and Kashmir is being held from Sep. 7 to 10. PTI

Within the next few months, all the cinema theatres in the valley were shut down.

As the militancy gained a foothold in the valley, many of these cinema halls were occupied by the security forces, turning

them into makeshift camps and interrogation centres. Some others were converted into hospitals, nursing homes, and business centres.

As cinemas were shut down, the Indian



trade with illegal Israeli settlements.

Response to Israel's proposals

The UK's decision is considered a response to Israel's approval of new construction projects in sensitive zones, notably the "E1 corridor" between East Jerusalem and the Ma'ale Adumim settlement. Construction in E1 would sever the territorial link between the northern and southern West Bank,

What is the E1 corridor?

● The E1 corridor is a 12 sq km-stretch of land in the occupied West Bank, located between East Jerusalem and the Israeli settlement of Ma'ale Adumim.

● Construction in E1 would sever the territorial link between the northern and southern West Bank, and further isolate East Jerusalem from the rest of the West Bank, further altering the territories claimed for a Palestinian state.

and further isolate East Jerusalem from the rest of the West Bank, further altering the territories claimed for a Palestinian state.

The West Bank was partitioned under the 1995 Oslo II Accord into Areas A, B, and C. Area C, comprising roughly 60% of the West Bank, remains under complete Israeli control and houses virtually all Israeli settlements in the West Bank outside Jerusalem. Further into the territory, Israeli agricultural settlements heavily dominate the Jordan Valley and Dead Sea Basin, which cover nearly 30% of the West Bank.

Over time, Israel has allowed the conversion of Palestinian land into industrial date plantations and commercial farms.

The E1 Corridor and Ma'ale Adumim, located east of Jerusalem, link Jerusalem to the Jordan Valley. Settlement expansion here would physically disconnect East Jerusalem from its Palestinian hinterland (Ramallah and Bethlehem).

The Ariel Salient and Barkan Industrial Zone, located in the northern West Bank (Salfit Governorate), cut across major Palestinian agricultural communities and sit atop the Western Aquifer Basin, one of the region's main water resources. Also, Gush Etzion and the South Hebron Hills (Masafa Yatta) in south Jerusalem disrupt Palestinian pastoral livelihoods through mili-

Army intervened and opened some of its garrison theatres for the public such as Thimayya Hall in Baramulla and Zorawar Hall in Pattan. But as militancy took a turn and *fidayeen* (suicide attackers) started to storm the security camps, these theatres were closed to the public as a security measure.

The government push

In the mid-1990s, after an elected government came to power in Jammu and Kashmir in 1996, the government pushed for reopening of cinema theatres in Kashmir by promising them interest-free loans. In 1998-99, three cinemas reopened in Kashmir: Broadway and Neelam in the high security zones of Badamibagh cantonment and Civil Secretariat respectively, and Regal cinema in the heart of the city.

On September 24, 1999, as moviegoers were coming out of Regal cinema after watching *Pyaar Koí Khel Nahin* on the first day of re-opening, militants hurled a gre-

Their total production cost now is roughly Rs 110 per kg," said Ricky Thaper, joint secretary of the Poultry Federation of India.

Farmers raise day-old chicks weighing 35-45 gm to 2-2.5 kg slaughter-ready broiler birds over 35-42 days. The cycle is longer for layer hens. These begin laying eggs at 18-20 weeks of age and do so until they are 70-72 weeks old. Each bird lays 250-300 eggs annually.

Looking ahead

Soyabean meal prices have come down somewhat in the last couple of weeks.

This is partly because farmers have sown almost the same area under soyabean in the current *kharif* (monsoon) season as last year. The condition of the crop, due for harvesting in October-November, is also said to be normal to good so far, with no major insect pest or disease incidence being reported.

El Niño's impact has been less in soyabean relative to other crops, which require more water and fertilisers. Further, some large Indian poultry companies with captive feed manufacturing facilities have contracted soyabean imports, which are estimated at 0.9 million tonnes (mt) in 2025-26 (October-September). It has improved the carryover stocks and likely availability for the new marketing year.

"Our greater concern is maize, where *kharif* acreage is significantly down (4.1%, going by government data) and the yield outlook isn't also encouraging. Moreover, El Niño could hurt the prospects for the *rabi* (winter-spring) maize crop," CLFMA's Gulati pointed out.

The US Department of Agriculture has projected India's maize production in 2026-27 at 50 mt, a sharp decline from the record 55.1 mt of 2025-26, which itself was a substantial jump over the preceding year's 43.4 mt.

With sugar prices on the boil, the Narendra Modi government is expected to restrict mills from using any cane juice or high sucrose 'B-heavy' molasses for manufacturing ethanol in the upcoming crushing year beginning October.

If maize prices continue to rise — spilling over into livestock feed costs and ultimately what consumers pay for milk, eggs and meat — there could be a review of even diversion of the feed grain for ethanol production. That would make meeting the existing 20% blending in petrol (E20) itself difficult in 2026-27.

tary firing zones, outpost proliferation, and land confiscation.

Products, value, and impact

Settlement production relies heavily on commercial agriculture and light manufacturing in designated industrial zones.

Major agricultural goods include Medjool dates, table grapes, herbs, citrus fruits, avocados, and wine (produced in wineries across the West Bank and Golan Heights). Plastics, textile products, construction materials, cosmetics with Dead Sea minerals, and packaging are manufactured within settlement industrial parks.

The ban is not expected to dent Israel's \$500 bn economy, which is driven by high-technology exports, advanced defence hardware, and pharmaceutical products manufactured within Israel's pre-1967 lines.

However, it may cause direct financial distress for specialised settlement businesses, through increased operational costs and liability for Israeli firms that source components or raw materials from across the Green Line. Between 2015 and 2020, settlements in Area C and occupied East Jerusalem contributed \$30 billion annually to Israel's economy, according to a 2022 United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) report.

nade, killing a civilian and injuring over a dozen people. The cinema was shut again, this time permanently. Now, a big shopping centre is coming up in its place.

The Broadway and Neelam cinema halls continued to run, but low footfall made them financially unviable. Broadway closed down in 2005 while Neelam survived for another five years before eventually shutting down in 2010 — in between, the latter survived a *fidayeen* attack in 2005. So, the valley was once again without cinema theatres.

Broadway returns

In 2022, the Dhar family, which owned the Broadway Cinema, made another push and opened the valley's first multiplex theatre — INOX — in Srinagar's high-security Shivpora neighbourhood.

The 520-seater multiplex, with three movie theatres, is also the venue for screening the films shortlisted at the IFFJK.

We value our Employees We care for our Pensioners

PENSION ADALAT

ON 15th December 2026

Pension Adalat for Pensioners will be held all over Northern Railway i.e., Northern Railways Headquarters Office (Baroda House, New Delhi) and all Divisional Headquarters on 15th December 2026.

The LAST DATE of receiving the application for PENSION ADALAT is 31.10.2026

PENSIONERS

- Retired from HQs Office, Northern Railway may send their representations to Dy.CPO/HQ-II, Northern Railway for Pension Adalat;
- Retired from Divisional Office and Offices under the control of DRM may send their representations to Sr. DPO of the respective Division for Pension Adalat;
- Retired from Workshops, may send their representation to Sr. DPO of the Division in whose territory the Workshop is located, for Pension Adalat.

The representation for PENSION ADALAT should, however, be addressed to Dy. CPO(HQ-II)/Sr.DPO/Dy.CPO & SPO/APO (Workshop) as the case may be. The envelope carrying the representation should be super-scribed- PENSION ADALAT-2026.

**Addresses of Dy. Chief Personnel Officer/HQ-II and
Senior Divisional Personnel Officer of Divisional Head Quarters.**

Dy. Chief Personnel Officer/HQ-II, Northern Railway, Headquarters Office, Baroda House, Kasturba Gandhi Marg, New Delhi-110001 Senior Divisional Personnel Officer, Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Northern Railway, Station Road, Firozpur Cantt - 152001 Senior Divisional Personnel Officer, Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055 Senior Divisional Personnel Officer, Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Northern Railway, Trikuta Nagar, Jammu - 180004	Senior Divisional Personnel Officer, Divisional Railway Manager Office, Northern Railway, Hazrat Ganj, Lucknow- 226001 Senior Divisional Personnel Officer, Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Northern Railway, Rail Vihar, Ambala Cantt, Ambala - 133001 Senior Divisional Personnel Officer, Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Northern Railway (Near Railway Stadium), Moradabad - 244001
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3113/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, GORAVE KUMAR S/O SUSHIL KUMAR TYAGI R/O A-26, SECTOR 11, VIJAY NAGAR, GHAZIABAD HAS CHANGED MY NAME TO GAURAV KUMAR

0071059814-1

I, Vikas Vijay Vij S/O Vijay Kumar Vij R/o H.No.300, Sector 16 A, Faridabad have changed my name to Vikas Vij. 0040877656-8

I Sadhana Devi D/o Ram Swaroop Mishra and W/o Radha Mohan Pandey R/o T-5/8(1/2) Type-1 Uri Enclave, Delhi Cantt, Delhi Cantonment, Delhi - 110010, have changed my name to Sadhana Pandey

0071059836-1

I, MONIKA TAK, W/O LOVESH TAK R/O FLAT NO-A1/ 102 VXL EASTERN HEIGHTS NYAY KHAND-3, INDIRAPURAM GHAZIABAD-201014, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MONIKA, FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040877658-1

I, Meenakshi, W/o-Sareen Kumar, R/o H.No.-416, Fourth Floor, Sagar Homes, Old DLF Colony, Gurgaon (Haryana) - 122001, have changed my name to Meenakshi Kakran for all Purposes.

0040877655-4

I, SANGRAND PARAMHANS MOHAN alias MANMEET KAUR, D/o AVTAR SINGH R/O- 145 Pushpanjali Enclave Pitampura Delhi-110034 have changed my name to MANMEET KAUR. 0040877656-1

I, SANDEEP KUMAR, S/O-RAM PHAL, R/o-KILOI KHAS (60), ROHTAK, H.R-124401, Have Changed My Minor CHILD Name VANSI to VANSI HOODA. 0040877658-8

I, Gourish Prashad Baral, R/o A-66, Jawahar Park, Devli, Khanpur, New Delhi-110062 hereby declare that Gourish Baral and Gourish Prashad Baral are one and the same person i.e., myself. This declaration is being made for the purpose of correcting, clarifying, and establishing my identity in all records, documents, and places wherever required.

0040877538-1

I, Tarun Kumar Arora S/O Des Raj R/o C-23 Second Floor Satyawati Colony Ashok Vihar Phase-3, Delhi-110052, have changed my name from Tarun Kumar to Tarun Kumar Arora, for all purposes. 0040877591-1

I, SUKHPREET SINGH, S/O-KIRPAL SINGH 721, NITI KHAND-1, INDIRAPURAM, GHAZIABAD UTTAR PRADESH U.P.-201014 have changed My Name To SUKHPREET SINGH MUTIAR permanently. 0040877654-7

I Firdos D/o Shahid, R/o H.No. 321, Street No.8, Village Jagat Pur, Delhi-110084 have declare that Shahid Saifi and Shahid is the name of one and the same person. 0040877532-1

I Narmata Aggarwal W/o Jitender Kumar R/o H.No.570, Sector 21 B, Faridabad have changed my name to Namrata Kesarwani Aggarwal.

0040877656-10

I Jitender Kumar S/o Om Prakash R/o H.No.570, Sector 21 B, Faridabad have changed my name to Jitender Agarwal.

0040877656-9

I, NISHA KUMARI W/o Jaibir Singh, R/o: Gaon-Paintawas Khurd, Post-Kitlana, Tehsil-Charkhi Dadri, Bhiwani, Haryana-127021, Have Changed My Name to NISHA DEVI. 0071059862-1

I, Amrita Jhunjhunwala, D/o-Bharat Kak R/o-Townhouse-3 DLF Kings Court W Block, Greater Kailash -2 New Delhi-110048, I have changed my name Amrita Kak for all purposes 0040877658-3

I, Sohanlal Bhardwaj, S/o-Vihari Lal Sharma, R/o-1173, Sector-3, Faridabad (Haryana), have changed my name to Sohan Lal Sharma for all Purposes.

0040877655-6

I, Alpna kumari D/o-late-Rama Pati Lal Karn W/o-Barun Kumar R/o-123, Block GH3, DDA-LIG Flats Paschim Vihar, N.Delhi-110063, have changed my name to ALPNA, permanently

0040877656-3

I, Shiv Narayan Shukla, S/o Ram Sobhet Shukla, R/o H.No.-151, Kh.No.-1068, Gali No.-5, D-Block, Kadi Vihar, Kadipur, Delhi-110036, have changed my name to Shiv Layak Shukla for all purposes. Both are one and the same person. 0040877539-1

I, SURENDER PRUTHI, S/O-RAM SWAROOP PRUTHI, R/O E-2/4/17, Sector-19, Rohini, Delhi-110089, declare that my father's name has been wrongly mentioned as "RAM SWAROOP" instead of his correct name "RAM SWAROOP PRUTHI" in my records. RAM SWAROOP and RAM SWAROOP PRUTHI are one and the same person. My father's correct name is RAM SWAROOP PRUTHI, as mentioned in my Aadhaar Card. 0040877661-2

0040877657-1

I, SINGH GUNJAN RAJKUMAR ALIAS GUNJAN SINGH S/O RAJKUMAR SINGH R/O PLOT NO-2, UPPER GROUND FLOOR POCKET- 16, DDA MARKET NEW PRESTIGE WELFARE SOCIETY, SECTOR-20 ROHINI, PO: SULTANPURI C BLOCK, DELHI, 110086 have changed my name to GUNJAN SINGH. 0071059888-1

I, Shambhavi Chhabra, S/o-Om Prakash Chhabra R/o C 1/35 West Enclave pitampura Near Police Line Delhi Outer Delhi Correct Name Sharminder Chhabra. 0040877654-9

I, NIRMAL ARORA W/o NO. JC40440 RANK EX SUB (LATE) JITENDRA PAL KOHLI R/O D-7, NH-1, NTPC VANDHYANAGAR, SINGRAULI, MADHYA PRADESH -486885 have changed my name to NIRMAL KOHLI vide affidavit dated 7-9-2026 before delhi. 0071059808-1

I, Shakeel Ahmed S/o Late Nazir Ahmed Saifi R/o Behind old Post Office Shiv Mandir wali Gali Surajpur Greater Noida, G.B Nagar U.P My father's name is recorded as Nazir Ahmed Saifi on my passport, which is incorrect; his actual name is Nazir Ahmed. 0071059880-1

I, Kamal Aggarwal S/O Awadh Bihari Aggarwal, Addrs flat no-403, tower no-1, orange county, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad-201014, have changed my name to Kamal Aggarwal.

0040877664-2

I, Pratap Arjun Odedra, R/o-Flat No.-1402, T-10, RPS Savana, Sector-88, Faridabad (Haryana), have changed my Minor Son name from Rudra to Rudra Pratap Odedra for all Purposes. 0040877655-8

I, JITENDER MAKHIJANI, S/O-GIAN CHAND, R/O, AP-77-D, PITAMPURA, DELHI-110088, declare that JITENDER MAKHIJANI and JATINDER KR. and JATINDER KUMAR are same and only one person.

0040877656-5

I, Shruti Vimal D/o Vimal R/o Flat-No.802, Ulivse Corner, Sector-23, Powe, Navi Mumbai-410206, have changed my name to Shruti Sahney for all future purposes. 0040877622-1

I, MINTARA DEVI, W/O- Maheshwar Chaudhary, R/O-A-47, IG Colony, Kunwar Singh Nagar, Delhi-110041, have changed my name to SANGEETA DEVI in future for all purposes.

0040877655-1

I, Bir Bahadur Chand S/O Tek Parsad, R/O C-47 and C-48 Right Portion First Floor, Vijay Vihar Phase-2, Rohini, P.O. Rohini sector-7, Distt. North West Delhi, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Rajesh Gautam for all future purposes. 0071059810-1

I, Suman Sharma W/O Sanjay Sharma R/O J-43, Adhyapak Nagar, Nangloi, Delhi-110041, have changed my name to Suman. 0040877657-2

I, Abhay Shukla S/O Ram Asre Shukla, R/O Behta, Shivrajpur, Kanpur Nagar, Behta, Kanpur Nagar, Uttar Pradesh- 209205, have changed my name and shall hereafter be Known as Mohit. 0071059818-1

I, Shobasa Chand Vasdev alise Subhash singh, S/o-Nanak Chand, R/o-A-34, Gali No-8 Krishna Park Extn Tilak Nagar New Delhi-110018, have changed, my Shobas Chand for all purposes. 0040877658-5

I, Shabnam Saifi W/o jamil Ahmed Saifi R/o Behind old Post Office Shiv Mandir Wali Gali Surajpur Greater Noida, G.B Nagar U.P have changed my name from Shabnam to Shabnam Saifi for all future purposes. 0071059884-1

I, ANISHA KUMARI PANDIT, D/o-RANJEET KUMAR PANDIT, R/O H-3/21, 1st Floor, Near Sullabhai Public School, Bangali Colony, Mahavir Enclave, Delhi-110045, have changed my name to ANISHA PANDIT.

0040877654-4

I, Madhav Singh, S/o-Army No.JC 249354-W, Rank RIS, Name- Rampratap Singh, Unit of 48 Armrd Regt.C/O-56 APO, have change my name from Madhav Singh to Madhav Singh Chauhan, for all future purpose.

0040877655-10

I, Yogender Kumar Chaudhary, S/o Kamlesh Choudhary, residing at H.No.-18, G/F, Back side, Deepak Vihar, Nilothi, Dist: West Delhi, Delhi - 110041 shall be known as Yogender Choudhary vide Affidavit dated 09/09/2026. 0071059813-1

I, Reena singla W/o Surander Singla, E-010, SITE 4 KASNA INDUSTRIAL AREA, Greater Noida, P.O: Knowledge Park-I, DIST: G.B Nagar, U.P have changed my name from Reena Rani to Reena Singla for all future purposes. 0071059833-1

I Sanjay S/O, Mewa Lal R/o 609/17, Indira Colony Gali No-1, School Block, Talab Chowk, Mandawali Delhi 110092 have changed my name to Sanjay Sharma. 0040877627-1

I, Kuldeep, S/o-Suresh Chand, R/o H.No-191, 3rd Floor, Near Jammu & Kashmir Society, Sector-9A, Gurgaon(haryana)-122001, have Changed my Name To Kuldeep Aggarwal for all Purposes. 0040877655-3

I, Rajender Kumar Kanojia, S/o-Amril Lal, R/O-C-5/31, Shahbad Dairy, Sector-26, Rohini, Sahibabad Daulatpur, Delhi-110042, inform that Rajender and Rajender Kumar Kanojia is one and the same person. 0040877654-2

I, Dhruv Mandhani S/o Harish R/o C1203A, Amrapali Sapphire, Phase-1, Sector-45, Noida(U.P) have changed my name to Dhruv Harishkumar Mandhani for all purposes. 0040877622-2

I, Shanti Chand W/O GANESH Lachiram Damai, R/O C-47 and C-48 Right Portion First Floor, Vijay Vihar Phase-2, Rohini, PO. Rohini sector-7, Distt. North West Delhi, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Shaina Ganesh Damai for all future purposes. 0071059811-1

I, Shambhavi Saraswat, D/o Arvind Kumar Saraswat, DOB is 20/01/2007, R/o H.No.G-13/B, Aruna Park, Shakarpur, Delhi-110092, do hereby solemnly declare that Gungun Saraswat (as per LIC Policy) and Shambhavi Saraswat are one and the same girl. Henceforth, I have changed my name from Gungun Saraswat to Shambhavi Saraswat for all future purposes. 0040877537-1

I, GARV S/O SUSHIL KUMAR R/O 110A A-6 PASCHIM VIHAR DELHI-110063. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO GARV GOGIA FOR ALL PURPOSES. 0040877658-7

I, YASHIKA SINGHAL D/o NARESH SINGHAL W/o UTSAV GARG R/O 2-D PLATINUM ENCLAVE POCKET-I SECTOR-18, ROHINI, NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI-110089 have changed my name to YASHIKA GARG for all purposes. 0071059890-1

I, KUNAL ASHOK GUPTA, S/O- GUPTA ASHOK SADANAND, R/O 403, REGALIA HEIGHTS, SHIPRA SUNCITY INDIRAPURAM, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201014 have changed my name to GUPTA KUNAL, for all purposes. 0040877654-6

I, MANOJ KAKAR S/O PRAHLAD CHAND KAKKAR R/O-147, ENGINEERS ENCLAVE, PITAMPURA, DELHI-110034, CHANGED MY NAME TO MANOJ KAKKAR. 0040877656-7

I, Sajjan S/O Subhash born on 15/10/2003 residing at Hajwana, have changed my name to Sajjan Malik vide affidavit dated 8/9/26 at Pundri

0050297265-1

I Rashmi Kumar W/O, Manoj Kumar R/O Flat No-80 Sangam Apartment Paschim Vihar, Sunder Vihar, West Delhi, Delhi-110087 have changed my name to Rashmi all purpose

0040877534-1

I, Shikha Bhatt, W/O Kamalakar Bhatt, R/o Flat.No.2001, Tower-10, Ace Divino, Sector-1, Greater Noida, West, Bishrakh, Surajpur, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201306, have changed my name from Shikha to Shikha Bhatt for all purposes. 0071059845-1

I, Bharti Jha, W/O-Gourav Kumar Sharma, R/o-H.No-C-703,7th Floor, Hawelia Valenova Park, Greater Noida West, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201318 have changed my name to Bharti Sharma.

0040877658-2

I, Subhash Chandra Sharma, S/O-Kasturi Lal Sharma, R/O-H.No.-120, Indira Gandhi Colony, Near Sector-21 B, Faridabad (Haryana), have changed my name to Subhash Sharma for all Purposes. 0040877655-5

I, MAYA, W/o-Bir Singh R/o-142, Balvir Vihar Kirari Suleman Nagar, Delhi-110086, inform that my name MAYA DEVI and MAYA is same and one person

0040877656-2

I, Pooja W/o Army No. 4095260M Rank NK Pankaj Singh Present R/o Vill-Teht, PO-Paletih, Teh. Chamoli, Distt. Chamoli, Uttarakhand-246424 have changed my name from Pooja to Pooja Devi for all future purposes. 0071059829-1

I, Kum Seema Gupta, W/O-Rajender Kumar, R/o-H No-339, First Floor, Chand Nagar, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi -110018 I have change name Seema Devi. 0040877661-1

I, Vinod gupta, S/O-Girdhari Lal R/o HP 3, maurya enclave, pitampura, Delhi 110088 have changed My Name To Vinod Kumar Gupta permanently.

0040877654-8

I, ARJUN SINGH S/O SACHIN WADHWANA (Biological Father) and ROSHANEET SETHI, R/o Flat No-14023, A3s One Hamlet, Sector-104 Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, UP-201304, have changed my name to ARJUN SINGH SETHI for all future purposes, and that PIYUSH SETHI S/O DEEPAK SETHI, is my Step Father being the husband of my mother ROSHANEET SETHI W/o PIYUSH SETHI. 0071059803-1

I, Sarita, W/o-Abhinav Vats, R/O-A -55, yadav park(rohtak road), kamruddin nagar, Nangloi, Delhi-110041 Inform that My Minor Son's Neelabhai Vats in School Record My Name wrongly Written as Sarita Vats. Correct Name is Sarita. 0040877656-11

I, Nishant Kumar, S/o Sukhpal Singh, Addrs Flat no-1504, tower no-12a, Lotus boulevard, sec-100, noida-201304, have changed my name to Nishant Singh

0040877664-1

I, Giriraj Kumar Bhardwaj, S/o-Sohanlal Bhardwaj, R/o-1173, Sector-3, Faridabad (Haryana), have changed my name to Giriraj Kumar for all Purposes. 0040877655-7

I, Munni Devi, W/o-Hayat Ram, R/O-C-48, Street No.-2, Gazipur Village, Delhi-110096 declare that name of, my husband has been wrongly written as Hayat Kumar in his Aadhar Card The actual name of my husband is Hayat Ram.

0040877656-4

I, Suresh Kumar, S/O-Chander Bhan, R/O-H-4/100, Sector-16, Rohini, delhi-11089, have changed my Name to Suresh Verma to Suresh Kumar for all future purposes. 0040877654-10

I hitherto known as Sampa W/o Ishvar Dhakiya residing at Bhura Pani, Vta-Khutaja Bada, Po- Badakhuntia, Sub Dist-Bhavra, Dist- Alirajpur, Madhya Pradesh -457882, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Champa Dhakiya. 0071059828-1

I, Heena W/O Rajesh Gautam, R/O C-47 and C-48 Right Portion First Floor, Vijay Vihar Phase-2, Rohini, PO. Rohini sector-7, Distt. North West Delhi, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Hira Devi Gautam for all future purposes. 0071059809-1

My son Nitin's date of birth was inadvertently recorded incorrectly as 23/08/2009 on his Aadhaar card, whereas the correct date of birth is 05/04/2010, which is also recorded in other documents. His mother's name is Seema Devi. Manoj Singh, Sirauli Bangar, Tehsil Jewar, G.B. Nagar 0071059816-1

I Mahinder Kaur, W/o-Shobas Chand, R/o-Nanak Chand, R/o-A-34 Gali No-8 Krishna Park Extn Tilak Nagar New Delhi-110018, have changed my Minior Kaur for all purposes.

0040877658-4

I, Jamil Ahmed Saifi S/o Late Nazir Ahmed Saifi R/o Behind old Post Office Shiv Mandir Wali Gali Surajpur Greater Noida, G.B Nagar U.P My father's name is recorded as Nazir Ahmed Saifi on my passport, which is incorrect; his actual name is Najeer.

0071059882-1

I, Ajay Kumar Katyal, S/o-Tirath Ram Katyal, R/o-Flat No-1404, Sierra 3, Tower 8, M3M Marina, Sector-68, Badshahpur, Gurugram (HR.)122101, have changed my name to Ajay Katyal for all Purposes.

0040877669-1

I, Gulab Wati W/o Amrit Lal R/O-C-5/31, Shahbad Dairy, Delhi-110042, inform that Gulab Wati and Gulab Wati is one and the same person. 0040877654-3

I, Karan Preet Kaur, W/o-Sahil Kathuria, R/o-H.No.42, Second Floor, Part-2, Priyadarshini Vihar, Gurjarwala Colony, Delhi-110099, have changed my name to Karanpreet Kaur for all Purposes. 0040877655-9

I, MEENU KAKKAR W/O MANOJ KAKKAR R/O 147, ENGINEERS ENCLAVE, PITAMPURA, DELHI-110034 CHANGED MY NAME TO MEENAL KAKKAR. 0040877656-6

I, Sneha Mishra D/o Vinod Mishra, Residing at Tajpur, Tajpur, Mau, Uttar Pradesh-275101 do hereby declare that my correct name as per my 10th Class Marksheet is KM Sneha Mishra D/o Vinod Kumar Mishra, whereas in my Aadhar Card it has been wrongly mentioned as Sneha Mishra D/o Vinod Mishra. In future I should be known and addressed by my correct name KM Sneha Mishra D/o Vinod Kumar Mishra for all purposes. affidavit dated 07/09/2026, Supreme Court, Delhi

0071059830-1

I, SHWETA HASIJA W/O PUNEET VIRMANI R/O- Flat no 3, Acacia 4, Vatika City Sector-49, Gurgaon, Haryana-122018, Change My Name to SHWETA VIRMANI New Name Permanently. 0040877657-3

I, hitherto known, as Surjeet Singh, S/O-Bijender Singh, R/o H.No-163, Mitraion Village-Najafgarh, South West, Delhi-110043, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Sarjit Singh. 0040877655-2

I, ROSHAN LAL, S/O-OM PRAKASH, R/O- H.NO-30, GROUND FLOOR, ROAD -78 WEST PUNJABI BAGH -110026, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM ROSHAN LAL TO, ROSHAN LAL AGGARWAL FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040877654-1

I, POOJA RANI W/O MARKS ISSAC R/O A-324 POCKET-00 SECTOR-2 ROHINI DELHI-110085, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO POOJA FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0040877658-6

I, Rajiv Miglani, S/o-Atam Prakash Miglani, R/O-426, 2nd Floor, Dr. Mukherjee Nagar, North West, Delhi-110009 have changed my name to Rajiv Kumar Miglani. 0040877654-5

0071059803-1

LOST & FOUND

I, SUNIL KUMAR SHARMA, S/O-Ram Mohan Sharma have Lost my Property original Paper Receipt, Will, Affidavit and other Notarize documents of property No. AP-51C, Pitampura Delhi-110034, finder Contact-9311809930 0040877656-12

DDA Rohini Residential Scheme 1981 Original FDR amounting to Rs 750/- of Application No.40601 issued by DDA in favour of Smt Sushila Devi W/o Late Sh. Ved Prakash with some other documents was lost on 1 June 2001. An online police complaint bearing no. 560876 of 2026 dated 22/8/2026 for loss of FDR has been lodged for this FDR. If anyone finds the said FDR, please return it to the undersigned. Rajender Kumar S/O Late Sh. Ved Prakash, QU 265-B, Pitampura, Delhi contact:- 9313980153.

0040877657-4

I, Suresh Kumar S/o Sohan Singh R/o Vill-Post Ghorri Bacheda, Greater Noida, G.B Nagar have lost my Allotment Letter On Plot No-118, Block-B, Area-130 Sqm, Allotment No- Ghd01978, Village/sector-Ghorri Bacheda Greater Noida G.B Nagar

0071059879-1

Lost of my FDR (File No. F-16(23265)/2012/RHN, Application No.164787, Priority-No.19736 in Rohini LIG-Scheme C-2/329, Sector-36, Rohini, Delhi. In the Name of Raghubir Parsad Mangal S/o-Sh. Kanya Lal. Finder may Contact- Maya Rani Mangal W/o-Late Sh. Raghubir Parsad Mangal at-46, Pocket-2, Opposite Sport Complex, Jasola, Okhla, Delhi-110025

0040877540-1

RECRUITMENT

SITUATION VACANT

OTHERS

Walking interview Looking marketing executive working in Hyderabad please call me 7337058554 Driving licence mandatory 0050297269-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE
General public is hereby informed that my client SH. RAMESH S/O LATE SH. JHANDU, AGE ABOUT 65 YRS R/O PLOT NO. 74, KH. NO. 403AND4, J.K. FARM, HOUSE, GAUTAM COLONY, NARELA, (NW), DELHI-110040 has disowned his son namely MR. RAJU and his wife MRS. MOHINI (MONA) from his entire movable and immovable properties as they have gone out of control of my client and their entire family has severed all the relations from them. If anybody deals with them, it shall be entirely at their own risks, cost and consequences. My client shall not be responsible in any manner for any kind of their deed, acts and conduct.

Krishan Kumar (Advocate)

B-3625/2013, Ch. No. X-22, Civil Wing, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

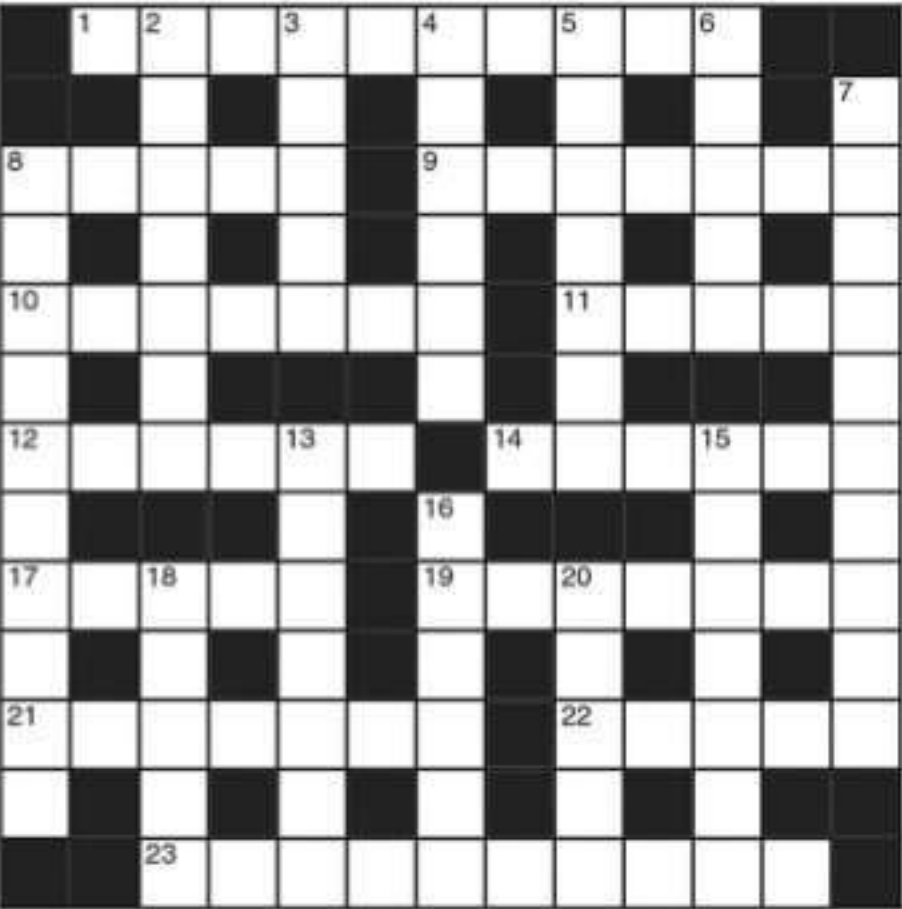
'Be it known to all that my clients Mr. Amit Bose Son of Late Sh. B. N. Bose, and Mrs. Mitta Bose Wife of Sh. Amit Bose and Daughter of Late Sh. Devi Sinha both residents of T-103, Medha Apartments, Mayur Vihar Phase-I Extension, Delhi-110091 have severed all their relations social, legal and religious with their daughter-in-law Ms. Pojoa Bose, W/o. Late Anirban Bose with immediate effect. They have also disowned her and debared her from inheriting all their movable and immovable properties with immediate effect. Anybody dealing with her shall do it entirely on their own risk and neither my clients nor their estate shall be liable in any manner whatsoever.'

Sd/- SANTOSH KUMAR

Advocate

Ch.No.539, 2nd Floor, Patliata House Courts, New Delhi-110001

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS
- 1 As worn in the depression? (6,4)
- 8 One fat round Scotsman (5)
- 9 It's useless shielding a bad crook (7)
- 10 What is used to control the horse is in it (7)
- 11 Jack found in church we hear (5)
- 12 Fancy us to be stupid (6)
- 14 Properly dressed soldiers are (2,4)
- 17 Spanish wine jar I smashed when empty (5)
- 19 Product of a fruitful harem? (7)
- 21 A job for the tinker on the way (7)
- 22 Booked with prejudice (5)
- 23 Amazon country? (2,4,4)
- DOWN
- 2 Divided about design for dress (7)
- 3 Give someone a painful reminder? (5)
- 4 Foreign capital goes up in smoke (6)
- 5 Use suntan lotion - it helps in the rain (7)
- 6 A magnificent band going on ahead? (5)
- 7 Never ate it turning obstinate (10)
- 8 Impressive print of thigh or lap perhaps (10)
- 13 Space for some car movement (3,4)
- 15 I adopt a Latin form of language (7)
- 16 A grim situation on board (6)
- 18 Frequently expressed as decimal (5)
- 20 Revers the French and the Spanish adopted quietly (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6089 ACROSS: 1 Direct, 4 Poetry, 9 Romance, 10 There, 11 Alone, 12 Reposed, 13 Petty tyrant, 18 Chatter, 20 Parka, 22 Mater, 23 Endives, 24 Secede, 25 Myself DOWN: 1 Durban, 2 Romeo, 3 Concert, 5 On tap, 6 Treason, 7 Yields, 8 Secretaries, 14 Elastic, 15 Rapidly, 16 Scamps, 17 Massif, 19 Tired, 21 Revue

JUMBLD WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

I write to __ what i know. — Flannery O Connor (8)

GINER

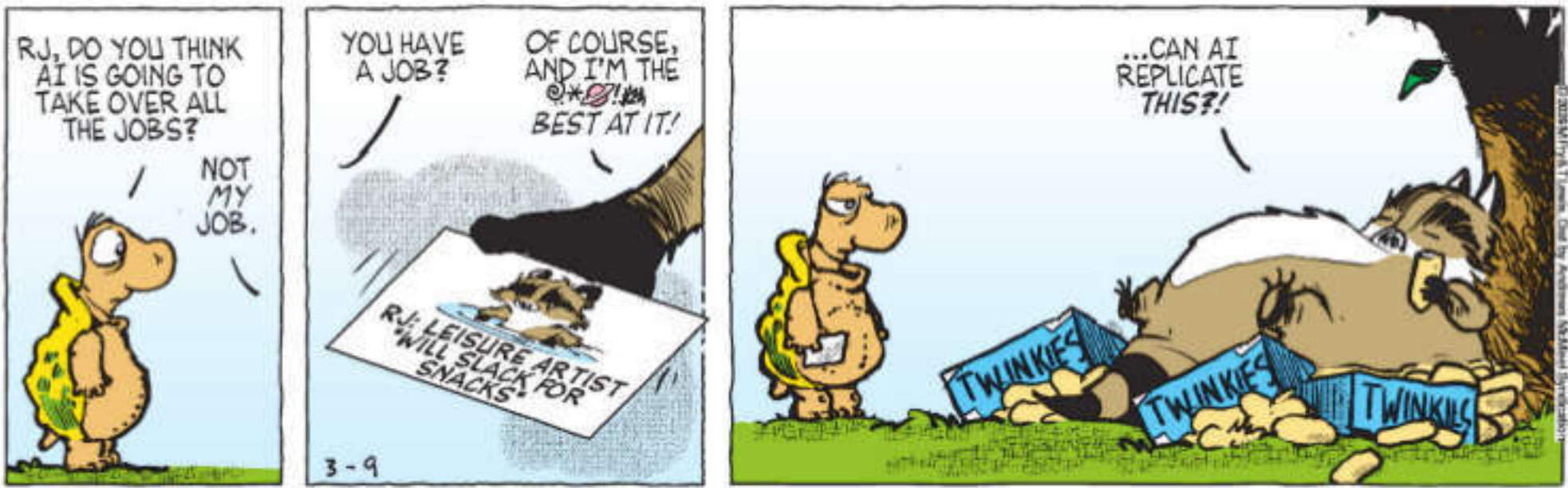
GNOMIC

IRVOS

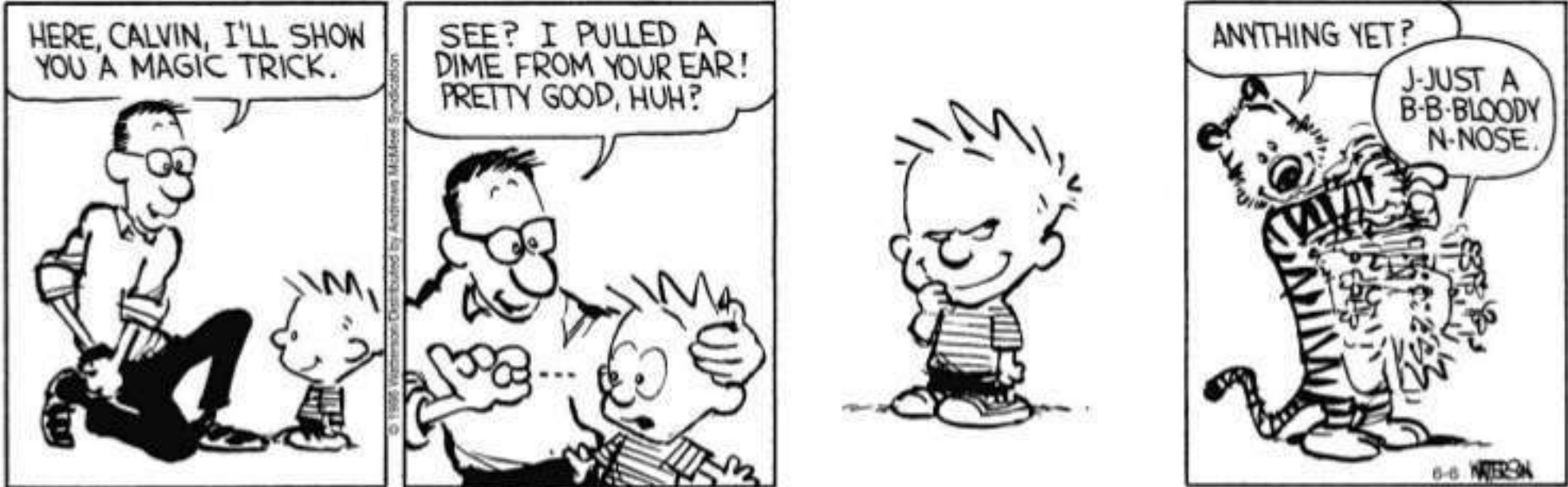
EORUDV

ANSWER: I write to discover what i know. — Flannery O Connor

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 3s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6437

8			5	4	6	2		
		4						
		7	8		6			1
							6	4
	2		1		9		3	
1	8							
9			5		7	2		
						5		
	5	1	4	8				7

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6436

1	3	7	5	2	9	6	4	8
5	2	4	1	6	8	3	7	9
8	9	6	4	3	7	2	1	5
6	5	9	7	1	2	4	8	3
7	1	2	8	4	3	9	5	6
4	8	3	6	9	5	7	2	1
2	7	1	3	5	6	8	9	4
9	6	5	2	8	4	1	3	7
3	4	8	9	7	1	5	6	2

ROYAL STARS

♈

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Discussions with close friends will intensify in a few weeks and financial discussions will favour you. Today's New Moon is perfect for making resolutions to improve your health. Tonight: Get organised.

♉

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Relations with those who are closest to you will improve in a warm and cosy way. Meanwhile, work-related discussions will be effective and productive. Look for ways to express your creativity and to enjoy socialising with others. Tonight: Be playful.

♊

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Opportunities to use your mind for pleasure, working puzzles, reading and playing games that require mental agility will please you this month. Meanwhile, use the New Moon to make a resolution on how to improve your home. Tonight: Relax at home.

♋

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Family discussions will be more important in the next few weeks, along with home repairs. Romance and opportunities to socialise will mushroom. Tonight: Say what you mean.

♌

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Redecorating and entertaining at home will appeal to you in the next few weeks. Short trips and a chance to learn will be appealing. Meanwhile, today is the perfect day to make a resolution about improving your finances. Tonight: Maintain your possessions.

♍

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Today the only New Moon in your sign all year is taking place. Therefore, take a realistic look in the mirror and ask yourself what you can do to improve the impression that you create on your world. Tonight: You're in charge.

♎

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Mercury moves into your sign today to stay for a few weeks, helping you put a great deal of yourself into whatever you say. Your mind will be active and you'll be busy. You will also shop for beautiful things in the next few weeks. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

♏

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Today fair Venus moves into your sign to stay for six weeks. This makes you charming, diplomatic and attractive to everyone. In fact, it's an excellent window of time to buy wardrobe treasures for yourself. Tonight: Be friendly.

♐

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Today's New Moon is the only one all year that takes place at the top of your chart. Therefore, this is the perfect time to think about your life direction in general. Are you headed where you want to go? Do you have a plan? Tonight: Be modest.

♑

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Your ability to have successful communications with parents, bosses, teachers and VIPs will improve in the next few weeks. This means it's time to make your pitch or ask for a promotion. Go after what you want. Tonight: Explore.

♒

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Today Venus moves to the top of your chart to stay for six weeks, creating favourable circumstances for your career and professional life. Authority figures will favour you. Tonight: Check your finances.

♓

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Today's New Moon is opposite your sign, which means it's an excellent opportunity to improve your relationships. Don't try to reinvent the wheel. Think of one simple thing you can do — perhaps daily — that might improve things. Tonight: Cooperate.

GAIL INDIA'S Integrated energy major, Petronet LNG Limited, and MC² Foundation, in association with IITC Incubator of IIT Hyderabad organised 'MC² Plus IGNITE Hyderabad Connect' at IIT Hyderabad. Dr. Anil K Khandelwal, former CMD, Bank of Baroda, delivered the keynote address. The event was graced by Deepak Gupta, CMD, GAIL (India), Akshay Kumar Singh, MD & CEO, Petronet LNG, Prof. B. S. Murty, Director, IIT Hyderabad and Ayush Gupta, Director (HR), GAIL. Addressing the gathering at MC² IGNITE event, Shri Deepak Gupta, CMD, GAIL said that India is at a "remarkable inflection point", with rapidly growing energy requirements alongside its ambition to become a developed economy, ensure affordable and reliable energy, build globally competitive industries and meet its climate commitments.

CCIC: Bimal Gopalachari took over as MD of Central Cottage Industries Corporation of India Ltd on 11th August 2026. The appointment was cleared by the Government. Gopalachari, who previously served as Additional General Manager at NTPC Ltd, has been appointed for a five - year term after receiving approval from the Government based on the recommendation of the PESB.

REC was awarded the first prize for its outstanding implementation of the Official Language Policy for the year 2025-26 at the meeting of the Hindi Salahkar of the Ministry of Power, GOI. The award was presented to REC by Manohar Lal Ji, Hon. Union Minister of Power & Housing and Urban Affairs. Shripad Dinesh Sharma, former Deputy CM of Uttar Pradesh & current Rajya Sabha MP, Suresh Kumar Kashyap, Lok Sabha MP, & Pankaj Agrawal, Secretary, Ministry of Power, were also present on the occasion. This achievement is a testament to REC's sustained commitment to promoting, propagating, & effectively implementing Hindi as the Official Language.

LIC: On the occasion of its 70th Anniversary, the CEO & MD of LIC of India, R. Doraiswamy, launched two new plans today, LIC's Bima Platinum (Plan 770) & LIC's Jeevan Raksha (Plan 894). Bima Platinum is a non-par, non-linked savings & protection plan offering Guaranteed Additions of Rs. 70 per Rs. 1,000 annual premium, a 70% Booster Income Benefit, and regular income benefits of 10% of Basic Sum Assured during the payout period. Jeevan Raksha is a non-par, non-linked pure risk plan providing guaranteed death benefits, with flexible premium payment options and special rates for women. Both plans offer rider options and will be available from September 7, 2026, online and offline.

DMRC has been honoured with the 'Overall Excellence in HR Practices for Greater Good' award by XLRI Jamshedpur during the 'HR for the Greater Good Conclave 2.0.', held at the Institute's campus from 31st August to 2nd September, 2026.

ISPP: In partnership with the Cheistha Kochhar Foundation, hosted the inaugural Cheistha Kochhar Nudge Awards 2026, celebrating innovative applications of behavioural science to public policy & development challenges. The ceremony was graced by Dr. Ashok Lahiri, Hon. VC, NITI Aayog, as the Chief Guest, alongside Guests of Honour Gen. Dalbir Singh Suhag (Retd.), former Chief of the Army Staff & former High Commissioner of India to Seychelles, & Prof. (Dr.) Pulkit Khanna, Dean, Jindal Institute of Behavioural Sciences. The awards, instituted in memory of public policy professional Cheistha Kochhar, recognised three impactful initiatives, each receiving Rs.10 lakh. ThinkZone's PRAKASHAK, NammaKasa & Project Mumbai's Plastic Recyclothon were honoured for strengthening parental engagement, civic accountability & community recycling respectively.

SIAM: The Executive Committee of Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers, the apex body representing the country's leading automobile manufacturers, recently elected Shenu Agarwal, MD & CEO, Ashok Leyland Ltd., as its new President for 2026-27. Shenu Agarwal previously served as the Vice President of SIAM, succeeds Shailesh Chandra, Immediate Past President, SIAM, and MD & CEO, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Ltd. The members of SIAM also elected K N Radhakrishnan, Director & CEO, TVS Motor Company, as the Vice President of SIAM for 2026-27 and S Iyer, MD & CEO, Mercedes-Benz India Pvt Ltd., as the Treasurer of SIAM for 2026-27.

CORPORATE BRIEFS

BSES won 3 prestigious awards at the Bharat Electricity Leadership Honours, held as part of Bharat Electricity, POWERGEN India & Indian Utility Week 2026, spotlighting leadership, operational excellence and sustainable innovation in the power distribution sector. The awardees were selected by an eminent jury of power-sector leaders and experts, and the awards were presented by Shripad Yesso Naik, MoS Power and New & Renewable Energy, Government of India. G Prasad, Chairperson, Central Electricity Authority, was also present on stage. Amal Sinha, Director & Group CEO, BSES, was named 'Distribution Leader of the Year', recognising a leadership journey marked by vision, institution-building and transformative impact.

BHEL has paid a dividend of Rs. 283.56 Crore for the year 2025-26 to the Govt. of India. To this effect, a cheque towards the final dividend on the equity (58.17%) held by the GOI was presented to H.D. Kumaraswamy, Hon. Union Minister of Heavy Industries & Steel, by K. Sadashiv Murthy, Chairman & MD, BHEL, in the presence of Kamran Rizvi, Secretary. Directors on the board of BHEL & senior officials of the Ministry of Heavy Industries were also present on this occasion. Significantly, the total dividend paid to the company's shareholders for FY 2025-26 amounts to Rs. 487.49 Crore.

CISF in collaboration with Blood Centre, Main Hospital, AIIMS, Delhi organised a voluntary blood donation drive at CISF NHCC Hospital, Mahipalpur, New Delhi. The drive was inaugurated by CISF Director General Praveer Ranjan, IPS, who led by example by donating blood. Senior officers, including IGS Navajyoti Gogoi, Sonia Narang & Vinay Kajla, also participated. Nearly 500 CISF personnel voluntarily donated blood, reaffirming the Force's commitment to community welfare beyond its security mandate. The initiative assumes significance as Delhi requires around 1,400 units of blood daily, while only about 960 units are currently available. CISF and AIIMS jointly appealed to citizens to donate blood regularly and encourage others to contribute to maintaining adequate supplies for patients in need.

CONCOR has commenced a scheduled 'Assured Transit Time Container Train Service' connecting ICD Whitefield (Bengaluru) to ICD Tughlakabad (New Delhi) via ICD Tondiyarpet (Chennai) for the first time. The service was flagged off by MoS Railways & Jal Shakti, V. Somanna, marking the introduction of this assured transit service in South India. On this Occasion, Somanna said that the service would benefit the industrial and manufacturing sectors by ensuring greater certainty in goods movement. Ajit Kumar Panda, CMD, CONCOR, along with officers from CONCOR, South Western Railway, and Customs, were present on the occasion.

CWC recently hosted 'Abhiuday '26', bringing exporters, importers, freight forwarders, customs brokers, transporters and terminal partners together on one platform to strengthen ties across the Delhi-NCR EXIM ecosystem and gather ground-level feedback to sharpen CWC's services. The event witnessed leading global shipping majors such as CMA CGM, represented by Sassi Nair, President of NISAA, MSC, Maersk, Hapag-Lloyd, ONE, CU Lines and OOCL. Anurag Nagpal of Allcargo, Sipil Sharma, VP, CTL Logistics, and representatives from Console Shipping Services India Pvt. Ltd., TGL, CPW, DCBA, Freightbridge, EMU, GML, Linkers, UFMPL, Vanguard, CSL, GAK Logistics, Pole to Pole Shipping, NTL, Value Freight, Magic Logisys, Eurostar, Econship Tech, Maxicon, Oak Shipping Services, CSC, Vardhman Customs, Bhumika, among several other members of the trade fraternity participated. Addressing the gathering as Guest of Honour, Commander Pawan Kumar, RM, Delhi-Uttarakhand Region, CWC, spotlighted Less than Container Load (LCL) cargo as a critical growth lever — the mechanism that lets MSMEs and smaller shippers plug into global trade.

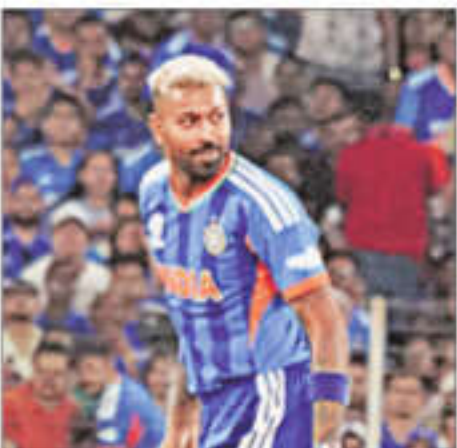
SAIL has reported a strong upward trend in sales performance for August 2026 as well as the April - August 2026 period. August 2026 also marked a milestone on the production front, with the company achieving its best ever August output of hot metal, crude steel and saleable steel. In August, 2026 the crude steel production grew by 8% to 1.68 MT over 1.55 MT in the corresponding period last year, hot metal rose by 9% to 1.78 MT over 1.63 MT, and saleable steel registered a 1% increase to 1.69 MT compared to 1.66 MT in CPLY.

IHM DEHRADUN AND IIM SIRMAUR: The Institute of Hotel Management, Dehradun & the Indian Institute of IIM Sirmaur signed an MoU to strengthen collaboration in hospitality & management education. The MoU was signed in the presence of Prof. Prafulla Y. Agnihotri, Director, IIM Sirmaur, & Dr. Shiv Mohan, Principal, IHM Dehradun. The collaboration will bring together the complementary strengths of both institutions to create greater opportunities for students, faculty & hospitality professionals. The partnership will focus on management education, capacity building, & joint academic programmes. Speaking on the occasion, Prof. Prafulla Y. Agnihotri, Director, IIM Sirmaur, emphasized the importance of integrating strong hospitality skills with modern management capabilities to prepare professionals for the rapidly evolving service industry.

PUBLIC RELATIONS SOCIETY, DELHI launched its inaugural bi-monthly digital newsletter, Srijan Samvad. Conceived as an in-house platform for communication, dialogue and creative applications in line with emerging media platforms to act as thought leadership in PR & Communications. The inaugural issue of Srijan Samvad was released at NTPC Corporate Headquarters, New Delhi, in the presence of distinguished veteran public relations professionals, in presence of GS Bawa, Dr Jyoti Kumar, BP Pandey, Umesh Mehta, Vipin Kharnanda, Ms Rama Vijay, Ms Nisha Sharma and Ms Anita Gupttrishi.

ALIMCO: Ms. Manmeet Kaur Nanda, Additional Secretary, DEPwD, Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment, inaugurated a Pradhan Mantri Divyasha-Vayoshri Kendra at Honda Samajik Vikas Kendra, Naurangpur, Manesar. She appreciated the decade-long partnership between ALIMCO and Honda India Foundation, calling the centre an example of Government-corporate collaboration through CSR. She stressed the importance of partnerships in strengthening last-mile inclusion and building a "Sugamya Viksit Bharat". ALIMCO CMD, Praveen Kumar, reaffirmed the organisation's commitment to expanding access to assistive technology and rehabilitation services. The new centre offers assessment, assistive devices and rehabilitation services under one roof and is expected to support over 15,000 Divyangjan and senior citizens annually.

Pandya returns to India A squad for one-dayers against Aussies



Hardik Pandya is coming back from an injury. EXPRESS PHOTO

Express News Service
Mumbai, September 9

FOR MOST players, three India A games would be a chance to push their case for a place in the senior side. For someone like Hardik Pandya, the matches could mean something different. India already know what he can do. What they need to know is whether his body is ready to do it again.

The 32-year-old was named on Wednesday in the India A squad for three one-day matches against Australia A in Puducherry, on October 6, 9 and 11, subject to fitness clearance. If he plays, it will mark his return to competitive cricket after more than four months.

His last appearance came for Mumbai Indians in the IPL, in May. Since then, a back spasm and a quadriceps injury have kept him out, and a fresh complication ruled him out of the ODI series against Afghanistan after he had initially been selected, subject to fitness. The India A games, then, arrive at an important point for both Pandya and India's ODI plans.

After hosting West Indies later this month, India play a five-match ODI series against New Zealand starting November 4, followed by three-match series against Sri Lanka and Zimbabwe. With the 2027 World Cup approaching, the coming months give India a sustained run of 50-over cricket, and a chance to settle on the combination they want.

India have plenty of specialist batsmen and fast bowlers. What they lack is someone who can bat in the middle order, finish an innings, and give the captain a genuine seam-bowling option too. That's what makes Pandya hard to replace.

INDIA A SQUADS FOR AUSTRALIA A SERIES
MULTI-DAY SQUAD: Aman Mokhade, Ayush Pandey, Devdutt Padikkal [C], Sai Sudharsan [VC], Yash Rathod, Shaik Rasheed, Kumar Kushagra [WK], Shams Mulani, Tanush Kotion, Tushar Deshpande, Anshul Kamboj, Praful Hinge, N Jagadeesan [WK], Nachiket Bhute, V Vyshak*
INDIA A ONE-DAY SQUAD: Priyansh Arya, Sai Sudharsan, Devdutt Padikkal (VC), Ruturaj Gaikwad (C), Rajat Patidar, Kumar Kushagra (WK), Nishant Sindhu, Vipraj Nigam, Arshin Kulkarni, Arshad Khan, Naman Dhir, Hardik Pandya*, Prabhjot Singh (WK), Gurjapneet Singh, Yash Thakur

*SUBJECT TO FITNESS CLEARANCE

Another wrestler tests positive, adds to India's doping menace before Asiad

Express News Service
Mumbai, September 9

WITH JUST 10 days to go for the Asian Games, India's preparations for the continental event have suffered another doping blow, with Greco-Roman wrestler Deepak becoming the latest member of the Nagoya-bound contingent to test positive for a prohibited substance.

The National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA) provisionally suspended Deepak, who was set to compete in the 67kg category, on Wednesday after a positive test. His sample was collected during the Asian Games selection trials in Lucknow on May 31.

Deepak is the third wrestler

to have tested positive after Greco-Roman grappler Deepanshu (130kg) and freestyle competitor Mukul Dahiya (86kg) were suspended. India will now be unrepresented in three wrestling weight categories at the Aichi-Nagoya Games.

The Wrestling Federation of India had named 16 wrestlers for the Asian Games across men's freestyle, Greco-Roman and women's categories. India had won six wrestling medals — one silver and five bronze — at the previous edition in Hangzhou.

The three wrestling cases are part of a much wider doping cloud that has followed Indian athletes from the Com-

According to the World Anti-Doping Agency's (WADA's) testing figures, India recorded 260 adverse findings in 2024

monwealth Games into the Asian Games build-up. There have been almost a dozen athletes caught up in anti-doping cases or proceedings in recent months, across sports including weightlifting, judo, wrestling, athletics, shooting, rowing and wushu.

Not a new problem

The problem was evident

in Glasgow as well.

Four Indian weightlifters selected for the Commonwealth Games were removed from the 16-member squad after failing dope tests, while two judokas were also withdrawn.

Arun Kumar was removed after an adverse analytical finding, while Birmingham 2022 silver medallist Tulika Maan was withdrawn after three whereabouts failures in 12 months.

The cases have continued into the Asian Games build-up. Long-distance runner Abhishek Pal, selected for the 5,000m and 10,000m, was removed from India's athletics squad after receiving a NADA

notice over a suspected anti-doping violation.

Wushu's Surya Bhanupratap Singh, a 2018 Asian Games bronze medallist, was also provisionally suspended after testing positive for a prohibited substance, ruling him out of Nagoya.

Also on Tuesday, a 17-year-old swimmer, who was one of the prospective participants at the 2026 Asian Games, was suspended for 18 months after testing positive for a banned substance.

The swimmer, who cannot be named as he is a minor and whose brother remains a part of the Asian Games squad, has been suspended after his sample showed the

presence of terbutaline, a beta-2 agonist banned under anti-doping rules.

The latest cases come against the backdrop of India's wider anti-doping record. According to the World Anti-Doping Agency's (WADA's) testing figures, India recorded 260 adverse findings in 2024. It was the third consecutive year that the country earned the dubious distinction of topping the global list.

During his visit to New Delhi earlier this year, WADA president Witold Banka held meetings with the Central Bureau of Investigation to try and eliminate the initial supply chain of racketeers and agents who supply drugs to athletes.

Athletes evacuated after flood in Nagoya

HUNDREDS of athletes and officials were briefly evacuated after heavy rain battered Nagoya, but the city's mayor on Wednesday ruled out any disruption to the Asian Games. Torrential rain flooded roads and water entered some of the venues for the multi-sport event, scheduled to begin on September 19. Around 400 people, had to be evacuated due to the heavy rain, but they later returned and no injuries were reported, an Asian Games official told Reuters. REUTERS

DULEEP TROPHY FINAL DAY 4

With gritty 99 against East, Tilak strengthens case for Test call-up

'I want to play red-ball cricket for India,' he says, backing it with a growing list of unbeaten tons

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, September 9

IN T20IS, Tilak Varma is indispensable. In ODIs, he's knocking on the door. But it's in Test cricket that he wants to make himself a permanent fixture. On a day East Zone took a massive 372-run lead, putting almost both hands on their first Duleep Trophy title since 2012 with only formalities left going into the fifth and final day on Thursday, Tilak's 99 off 211 balls showed why, among the next generation of batsmen, he stands a genuine chance of becoming an all-format player.

From the moment East Zone reached 708, South Zone's chances of winning were effectively gone. The only realistic hope was stretching the match, keeping the first innings incomplete. Even that looked thin by the end of Day 3, South at 242 for 6, Tilak wagging what already felt like a lost cause alone. Yet when he walked out to resume on Wednesday, the South Zone captain made clear he was prepared to grind it down, and did, falling last, one short of a century he thoroughly deserved.

Being on the road with India's white-ball set-up leaves him little room for multi-day cricket. But when the chance comes, Tilak has shown real appetite for the format. More than the runs themselves, it's how he goes about scoring them that should encourage the national selectors, at a time when India's newer batsmen tend to run short on patience and batting time. Against North Zone in the quarter-final in Bengaluru last week, he made 116 and 51, both



Tilak Varma said that red-ball cricket remains his favourite format, even though he has not made the cut for India yet. PTI

He may still become some way from genuine Test selection, but these are the kind of knocks that could move him up the queue

Unbeaten. Here, he again looked close to immovable.

Having played plenty of white-ball cricket, T20s especially, in the run-up to the Duleep Trophy, Tilak adapted to red-ball demands quickly. With time at the crease the priority, he avoided expansive shots that invited risk, often not even completing his strokes, holding back his hands rather than extending fully into them. He may still be some way from genuine Test selection, but these are exactly the kind of innings that could move him up the queue.

"Honestly, it's an important knock, but at the same point I was only focused on what the team needed," Tilak said, on what the innings means for his Test ambitions. "I could have taken more chances before myself, but the plan was simply to take it session by session. Cricket is a funny game, if you can bat out a session and if some other batsman stays with me, I was confident that if we batted through to the end of the

256 deliveries for 112.

His unbeaten 116 last week took 250 balls. A century against Essex took 241. There's also 111 not out off 193, and 121 off 183, both from different positions in the order, No. 3 to No. 6. It's evidence of a batsman who bats time, which is exactly what makes him worth investing in for Test cricket.

"I wouldn't necessarily say it comes naturally. But I began my professional journey in red-ball cricket and played it for many years with the red ball. Over the past few seasons, I've played white-ball cricket a lot, but red-ball remains my favourite format, it's my A game. But in the last five, six years I've been really good with the white ball," he said.

Why India hasn't considered Tilak an option while the Test side goes through its own transition remains an open question. At the level he's played, he's shown a strong back-foot game against pace, and against spin, a willingness to work the ball square

with cuts and sweeps as part of his regular game. He's under no illusions about what he wants. And crucially, when East's pacers had their tails up, he showed the maturity to see the phase out safely rather than take the game on, a trait rare among India's white-ball-raised batsmen. "I always say to everyone that I want to play red-ball cricket for India.

"That's my biggest goal because I really love playing red-ball cricket. I thought as a kid I'll be playing Test cricket first and after that only white-ball cricket. I'm really keen to play red-ball cricket and let's see how it goes," he added.

After Tilak fell, East, despite the huge lead, chose not to enforce the follow-on, ending Day 4 on 212 for 5, Ishan Kishan top-scoring with 80. **BRIEF SCORES: East Zone 708 & 212 for 5 (Ishan Kishan 80, Shikhar Mohan 52) lead South Zone 336 (Tilak Varma 99, Chama Milind 43; Mukesh Kumar 3/62) by 584 runs.**

India big favourites in Women's Asia Cup semis vs Bangladesh

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, September 9

A LOT has changed since 2018. Eight summers ago, India and Bangladesh lined up in Kuala Lumpur for the Women's Asia Cup final and 240 deliveries later, it was the underdogs who reached the summit, claiming their maiden — and still only — continental title.

India had hit the depths and in the days that followed, this newspaper reported a rift between the players and coach Tushar Arothe, one that ended in his resignation.

The India that Bangladesh will face in the semifinals of the 2026 Asia Cup in Dubai on Thursday bears little resemblance to the team from 2018, save for its three surviving pillars — captain Harmanpreet Kaur, deputy Smriti Mandhana, and Deepti Sharma. Bangladesh will not meet a team without an ICC trophy to its name but the reigning 50-over world champions.

What remains unchanged is Bangladesh's thinking going into the match. After the 2018 final, then-captain Salma Khatun had said: "We did not have anything to lose. We could only gain. But India had a lot to lose."

India go into Thursday's fixture on the back of three victories so convincing that the tournament has the complexion of a heavyweight being tossed into a ring of bantams. Pakistan were slayed, and not a drop of sweat was shed. Thailand and Hong Kong were never expected to be competitive anyway.

Cracks remain

Yet for those who know where to look, cracks remain. At the T20 World Cup earlier this year, the opening partnership between Mandhana and Shafali Verma accounted for 45.4 percent of India's runs. At this Asia Cup, that percentage has swollen to 62.6. Since the start of the year, Bharti Fulmali, Richa Ghosh and Deepti have combined for just 477 T20I runs across 40 innings — fewer, collectively, than Shafali's 543 from 19 innings alone.



Shafali Verma scored 53 in her last T20I vs Bangladesh. CREIMAS

A question on the middle order's fragility in the pre-match press conference was warranted. Shafali acknowledged the concerns, but affirmed the trio will come good. "There have been a few bad days, but they are all very good players. Bharti and Richa are great finishers who have done really good things in the middle order. I'm sure they will do well."

One of India's openers has scored a half-century in the last two T20Is against Bangladesh, and they would prefer the streak to continue. Bowling, meanwhile, is the least of India's worries — no side has found an answer for their spin trio, who have claimed 20 wickets for a combined 79 runs.

With their batting being found out by the United Arab Emirates, Bangladesh would have to produce a significantly improved display to pose any challenge to India. Sharmin Akhter, highest scorer against UAE, sounded confident. "If you think this is a pressure game, you will feel pressure. The way I look at it, it is a pleasure to get to play against India, because to be champions, you have to beat top teams."

Should she back her words, she would be the first player to do so. If not, she will join a long list of cricketers who promised to do their best against India before discovering that the best was not good enough. Either way, she, and Bangladesh, don't have anything to lose. India do.

INDIA VS BANGLADESH: Live from 8 pm on Sony Sports Network

● GOTTA BE LIT-HUANIAN

From amateur football to Champions League, Dambrauskas comes full circle

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, September 9

THE JURY is hung at London Tigers FC. To the uninitiated, a team in the Middlesex County League Division Two — ninth tier of English football — fretting over a UEFA Champions League fixture sounds like self-parody. Insolvents, after all, do not typically lose sleep over stock market fluctuations.

And yet, for the club nestled in the multicultural sprawl of West London, Manchester United's meeting with Azerbaijan's Sabah FK has created a genuine dilemma. Many of London Tigers' players grew up on a diet of Ronaldos and Rooneys, Scholeses and Giggeses. Their allegiance to United is beyond question.

But in the away dugout sits Sabah coach Valdas Dambrauskas — who, not so long ago, sat in theirs. "It is a bit of a crossroads for some of our boys,"

Ridhwan Ahmed, the team's manager, tells *The Indian Express* from London. "Do you support your own club, or the manager who came through these exact doors? But listen, not everyone gets to say that a manager who is now at the Champions League was once our manager. It is an amazing feeling to get to say that."

"It is so unreal. We were looking back at the time that Valdas spent with us. Imagine a guy going from the ninth division to managing a team in the Champions League against Manchester United. Absolutely surreal."

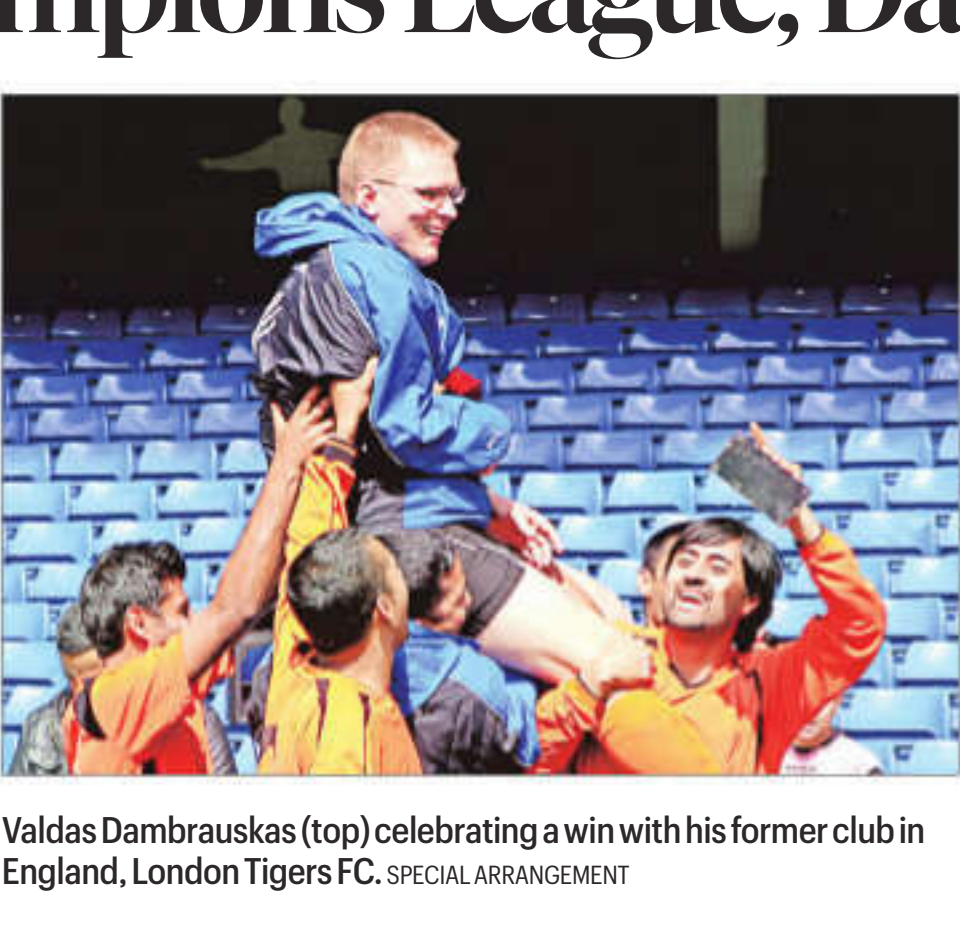
Sabah are strangers to Europe's elite competition — the club turned nine only last Tuesday. England, though, is not a stranger to Valdas. He first arrived in Britain in 2003. Born in the Soviet Union, Valdas spent the first half of his twenties working for a flooring company while studying philosophy and social sciences by

correspondence at Šiauliai University. When he was not doing either of the two, he read. Voraciously.

Dambrauskas auditioned for *Šeši nuliai – milijonas*, the Lithuanian edition of Who Wants to Be a Millionaire? — the show Indian audiences know as *Kaun Banega Crorepati*. Asked to name the Scandinavian god of thunder, he had no Chris Hemsworth to summon — the film would be made years later. But he had read about Thor.

He won 4,000 litas. The money helped finance his move to London with his girlfriend, where he enrolled in a sports science and coaching course at London Metropolitan University. To make ends meet, he would pick up odd jobs — gardening, floor-cleaning, handyman work, delivering newspapers.

Coaching opportunities came through the university course, including work with



Valdas Dambrauskas (top) celebrating a win with his former club in England, London Tigers FC. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Manchester United Soccer Schools and part-time roles at Fulham and Brentford. A full-time opportunity, though, would never arrive.

First Break

That was until he applied for a role at London Tigers in

2007. "We were looking for a coach at the time, and Valdas was also desperately looking for an opportunity, so it worked for both parties. At the time, no one had heard of him. He didn't have any coaching experience when he came to us," recalls Ridhwan.

"He wasn't just our manager, though. We are primarily a charity, working for the BAME (Black, Asian, Minority, Ethnic) communities of London. Besides coaching the boys, he would also volunteer in our charity work. That tells a lot about the person that he is." Ridhwan won't pretend he foresaw the Champions League. But he never doubted Dambrauskas would outgrow non-league obscurity.

"He had this fuel in him that got him to where he is. When he arrived here, we were playing amateur football. But Valdas was determined to take us to the semi-professional level, and he did that. We achieved things with him that we never thought we would."

In that same year, however, he left England to move back to Lithuania.

"I understood that to be a professional football coach in England and move up, to be a head coach or manager, was

impossible. With my Lithuanian passport, with the country's name that nobody can pronounce, with my surname that nobody can pronounce and, on top of that, I was never a professional player. My dream was so big that I packed my stuff into one minibus, put my two boys and my wife in, and we went back to Lithuania," the coach told his former club, Brentford.

He is back in England now, at the very top of the game. So too are Justinas Gasiunas and Eddie Cardoso, once his lieutenants at London Tigers, now his lieutenants at Sabah.

"Valdas didn't forget his roots," Ridhwan says. "He didn't go chasing big names for his staff. He took the same guys he worked with at our club." There are no prizes, come Thursday, for guessing where Ridhwan's allegiance will lie. "We have a new saying at our club: We were coached by the best."

Madrid, City and Dortmund win on opening night

REAL MADRID punished two costly Inter Milan mistakes to win their Champions League opener 2-0 on Tuesday, with Kylian Mbappe and Federico Valverde scoring and goalkeeper Thibaut Courtois keeping the visitors at bay at the Santiago Bernabeu in Madrid.

Erling Haaland struck twice after halftime as Manchester City won 2-0 at Porto, extending coach Enzo Maresca's winning start following three successive Premier League victories.

Serhou Guirassy's late double secured Borussia Dortmund a 3-2 home victory over Villarreal after the Spanish side had cancelled out Renato Veiga's own goal. REUTERS

US OPEN

Shelton dethrones Alcaraz with superior service game

American survives 4-hour, 28-minute rollercoaster to advance to semis

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, September 9

SEPTEMBER 8, 2022. US Open quarterfinal. Alcaraz faces Jannik Sinner, who is serving for the match at 5-4 in the fourth set. Sinner serves wide, Alcaraz slugs a crosscourt backhand, Sinner errs on return. Match point saved. The Spaniard comes roaring back to take the set and match at 2:50 am. He goes on to win his maiden Grand Slam.

September 9, 2026. US Open quarterfinal. Alcaraz now faces Ben Shelton, who's serving for the match in the fifth-set tiebreak. Shelton serves wide, big and fast at 146 miles per hour. Alcaraz fails to touch it. Shelton ends Alcaraz's title defence, and his 18-match winning streak at Majors, at 3:33 am.

The service made the difference for Shelton, not just on match point but throughout the four hour, 28-minute rollercoaster. It put him in front after Set 3 and kept him alive in the decider. It seemed to get bigger and bigger as the Flushing Meadows crowd spurred on its home hope, undeterred by the ungodly hour. He responded with his first career victory over a top-three player.

Shelton thanked his audience later, calling Arthur Ashe "the greatest stadium in the world". Asked court



Shelton sealed a 6-7(5), 6-1, 6-3, 1-6, 7-6 (10-7) win over Alcaraz . AP

side about how he summoned the resolve, the Floridian said: "For me, it's always about the people in the crowd - whether it's my coaches and my team, all of my family and friends.

"Or the city of New York that showed up till 3 am, with the USA chants until the very end. That's what kept me going and got me this win."

The seeds for the latest finish in tournament history were sown before the duel began. All three preceding matches on court went the distance — Frances Tiafoe's thrilling win against compatriot Alex Michelsen took four hours and 39 minutes. And so Alcaraz vs Shelton started after 11 pm local time. Nobody complained.

Not even Alcaraz, who smiled genially while congratulating Shelton, packing his bags and leaving the court. He had given it his all; the result was a byproduct.

"It was close. So I'm not going to be disappointed about not getting the win at the end," Alcaraz told reporters. "I'm just proud about myself, about how I fought. I leave the court

with a smile, healthy, and this is what I needed."

His pride stemmed from the way he competed. His movement, serving and groundstroke-making were all impressive upon return from an arduous wrist injury. The clinical wins in the first four rounds seemed to suggest Alcaraz was never away. He started off the same way in the quarterfinal.

After an even 10 games in the first set, Alcaraz broke Shelton's serve on love to inch ahead at 6-5. The American returned the favour immediately. The tone for the rest of the match was set with a see-saw tiebreak, which Alcaraz edged to draw first blood.

Tournament stamina

But the lack of tournament stamina had perhaps caught up with the second seed by then. Unforced errors crept up off his forehand and Shelton pounced on the opportunity. From 1-1 in the second set, Alcaraz lost nine straight games to look down and out by the end of the third.

He refused to capitulate. The fourth set saw a renewed

push from the seven-time Slam winner as he saved two break points and then broke Shelton's serve twice. He vomited into his towel during a changeover in between. The strain was getting to him, but he stayed locked in nevertheless.

Alcaraz was resolute on serve and valiant when returning in the fifth set. It took all of the eighth seed's big-serving capabilities to ward off the threat. The subsequent tiebreak saw momentum exchanging hands before Shelton closed it out with a booming ace. "That was a war, an epic match, so physical. Carlos is one of the greatest champions in our sport already at 23 years old," said Shelton, also 23. "It's always fun being on the court against him. It's ridiculous some of the stuff he comes up with sometimes. The most enjoyable match that I've had in my career, for sure."

Hewent on, "Obviously the level of tennis, how long the match was going, the fight that it was, how even of a match it was back and forth throughout, I think that that's something that we can appreciate. Win or lose, we would have a smile on our face."

Alcaraz returned the compliment and agreed: "I was playing against one of the best - he is a beast. Shelton is an unbelievable player, powerful. He just managed how to play really, really well in every situation, so credit to him."

The man from Murcia ends his campaign with his head held high. As for Shelton, the biggest win of his career will be followed by a stern semi-final test from Tiafoe. The crowd was firmly by his side against Alcaraz. That may not be the case on Saturday.

Sable comeback headlines Indian Athletics Series finale

Prithish Raj
New Delhi, September 9

AVINASH SABLE ran one round of the Mondo track at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium while 100m national record holder Gurindervir Singh signed a few autographs for the kids practising nearby before doing some resistance training on the starting blocks.

"The track feels good. I have competed on Mondo tracks only outside of India. It is good to have a world-class track here. It is speedy and a little bumpy when it comes to running, but I am happy to make a comeback tomorrow," Sable, who is coming from a long injury layoff and will feature for the first time in a national competition since last year, told *The Indian Express*.

Similarly, Pole Vault NR holders Dev Meena and Sindhusree G gauged the runway with a few short runs towards the jumping pit.

"Mondo tracks are different everywhere, and I just wanted to check how the track feels when I start my run-up with the pole," he said.

His coach Ghanshyam Yadav said the event serves as a perfect warm-up.

"It will be a good competition, and the timing is apt given the Asian Games are near now. I think it serves as a perfect warm-up for the Asian Games, and the prize money adds more value to the story," he added.

The who's who of Indian athletics, barring long jumper Sreeshankar Murali, high jumper Sarvesh Kushare, and triple jumper Praveen Chithravel, gathered at the JLN Stadium in New Delhi for the one-day meet called Indian Athletics Series Final.

Prize money bonanza

The event is a new addition to the calendar and will have a total prize money pool of 65 lakhs, with top six athletes in 30



Avinash Sable's last 3000m steeplechase was at the Monaco Diamond League last July. He will compete at the Asiad. EXPRESS

The event is a new addition to the calendar and will have a total prize money pool of 65 lakhs, with top six athletes in 30 disciplines getting cash rewards.

disciplines getting cash rewards each. The long-distance events and combined events are not part of the event.

The event is an invite only where the top performers across the season will be participating in the event.

The winner in each of the 30 events will pocket Rs one lakh.

The second-place finishers will receive Rs 50,000 each, while the athletes who finished third, fourth, fifth and sixth will get Rs 25,000, Rs 20,000, Rs 15,000 and Rs 10,000, respectively.

"The idea is to keep the athletes motivated, and we wanted it to be the season-ender for the newly incorporated Athletics series. The prize money adds

Sindarov shines again as Gambits claim top spot

Mayank Chaudhary
Bengaluru, September 9

JAVOKHIR SINDAROV has played across every board category in the Global Chess League. Starting on the Prodigy board, he climbed to Superstar Men and finally to the Icon board, completing the progression in four seasons.

Ahead of the ongoing edition, the Uzbek grandmaster made it clear he was here to win and not necessarily for fun, and across the five days of action, he backed up his words. For a second consecutive day, Sindarov steered the Fyers American Gambits across the finish line with his individual brilliance.

While a time-scramble blunder from Viswanathan Anand handed him victory on Tuesday, Sindarov left nothing to chance on Wednesday.

Clinical from start to finish, he took down Alireza Firouzja on the top board to secure a hard-fought win over Triveni Continental Kings, propelling the Gambits back to the top of the table ahead of the Alpine APL Pipers.

With every other board ending in a draw, his solitary victory proved decisive in a tight, low-scoring contest.

Earlier in the day, the Pipers secured three match points with an 11-6 win over the CheQ Mumba Masters. Magnus Carlsen, Anish Giri, and Volodar Murzin all converted their games with the white pieces, handing Pipers a comfortable win. Harika Dronavalli was a lone bright spot for Mumba, defeating Divya Deshmukh, while Shakhriyar Mamedyarov and Carissa Yip settled for draws.

It proved to be a miserable Wednesday for the Mumba Masters, who dropped both their fixtures.

Following their defeat to the Pipers, they suffered another 11-6 loss to Viswanathan Anand's PBG Alaskan Knights.

The writer is in Bengaluru on the invitation of the GCL

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